Microsoft 365 Copilot Masterclass for Professionals

Complete Course Script Handout

AI Powered Productivity, Across Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams and AI

Complete Training Handout

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Table of Contents

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

- Lecture 1: Introduction — What This Course Will Teach You and How to Get the Most From It
- Lecture 2: The Birth of AI Copilots and Why Microsoft 365 Copilot Changes Everything
- Lecture 3: What Is Microsoft 365 Copilot and Why It Is Different From Every Other AI Tool
- Lecture 4: Meet Pashun Sports — The Real Business You Will Use for Every Demo in This Course
- Lecture 5: DOWNLOAD: Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout (including the Everyday Prompt Pack)

SECTION 2: UNDERSTANDING MICROSOFT 365 COPILOT

- Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks
- Lecture 7: How to Set Up and Activate Microsoft 365 Copilot for Yourself or Your Business
- Lecture 8: How to Navigate the Microsoft 365 Copilot App — Your AI Command Centre
- Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files
- Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document
- Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See

SECTION 3: PROMPTING — THE SKILL THAT UNLOCKS EVERYTHING

- Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim
- Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results
- Lecture 14: How to Refine and Iterate an Output From Rough First Draft to Finished Deliverable
- Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library
- Lecture 16: How to Give Copilot a House Style So Every Output Sounds Like Your Business
- Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice

SECTION 4: COPILOT IN OUTLOOK — YOUR INBOX, HANDLED

- Lecture 18: How to Summarise a Long Email Thread and Know What Actually Needs a Reply
- Lecture 19: How to Draft Customer and Supplier Emails in Seconds From a Single Sentence
- Lecture 20: How to Use Coaching by Copilot to Get the Tone Right on a Difficult Message
- Lecture 21: How to Handle a Complaint Email — Apology, Resolution and Follow-Up in One Pass
- Lecture 22: How to Triage a Full Inbox With Copilot Priority and Daily Catch-Up Summaries
- Lecture 23: How to Prepare for Any Meeting in Under a Minute With Meeting Preparation Summaries

SECTION 5: COPILOT IN WORD — DOCUMENTS AND WRITING

- Lecture 24: How to Draft a Document From Scratch With a Prompt and a Reference File
- Lecture 25: How to Summarise Long Documents and Ask Questions About Their Contents
- Lecture 26: How to Rewrite and Transform Existing Text for a New Audience or Purpose
- Lecture 27: How to Generate Tables for Price Lists, Stock Records and Comparison Charts
- Lecture 28: How to Write Website and Product Page Copy That Matches Your Brand Voice
- Lecture 29: How to Turn a Word Document Into a Presentation, Email or Summary in One Click
- Lecture 30: How to Review, Track Changes and Tidy a Document You Did Not Write

SECTION 6: COPILOT IN EXCEL — DATA WITHOUT THE FEAR

- Lecture 31: How to Clean Up a Messy Spreadsheet So Copilot Can Actually Work With It
- Lecture 32: How to Ask Plain-English Questions About a Spreadsheet and Get Real Answers
- Lecture 33: How to Create Formulas and Calculated Columns Without Knowing Any Formula Syntax
- Lecture 34: How to Highlight, Sort and Filter to Reveal Patterns in Your Sales Data
- Lecture 35: How to Generate Charts, PivotTables and Visual Summaries Instantly
- Lecture 36: How to Use Copilot for Data Analysis (Advanced Analysis) on Messy Real-World Data
- Lecture 37: How to Build a Monthly Sales Report Your Boss Will Actually Read

SECTION 7: COPILOT IN POWERPOINT — PRESENTATIONS IN MINUTES

Lecture 38: How to Create a Full Presentation From a Prompt, a Word Document or a PDF
Lecture 39: How to Apply Your Brand Template So Every Deck Looks Like Your Business
Lecture 40: How to Add, Reorganise and Rewrite Slides With Copilot
Lecture 41: How to Generate Speaker Notes and Rehearse Your Delivery
Lecture 42: How to Summarise a Long Deck Someone Else Sent You

SECTION 8: COPILOT IN TEAMS AND MEETINGS

Lecture 43: How to Set Up Transcription and Recording So Copilot Can Do Its Job
Lecture 44: How to Get Help During and After a Meeting, and in Busy Chats and Channels
Lecture 48: How to Turn Meeting Actions Into Tasks, Emails and Follow-Ups

SECTION 9: COPILOT ACROSS THE REST OF MICROSOFT 365

SECTION 10: COPILOT AGENTS — YOUR AI TEAMMATES

Lecture 54: What a Copilot Agent Is and When You Should Build One Instead of Prompting
Lecture 55: How to Use the Ready-Made Agents Microsoft Gives You
Lecture 56: How to Build Your First Agent With No Code Using Agent Builder
Lecture 57: How to Ground an Agent in Your Own Files, Site or Knowledge Base
Lecture 58: How to Build a Customer Service Agent for Pashun Sports
Lecture 59: How to Build a Sales Reporting Agent That Answers Questions About Your Numbers
Lecture 60: How to Share, Test, Monitor and Improve an Agent Over Time

SECTION 11: SECURITY, GOVERNANCE AND RESPONSIBLE USE

Lecture 61: How Copilot Handles Your Data, Permissions and Privacy — Explained Simply
Lecture 62: How to Avoid Oversharing and Fix Permission Problems Before They Bite
Lecture 63: How to Write a Simple AI Usage Policy for a Small Team
Lecture 64: How to Stay Compliant, Ethical and Accurate When AI Writes on Your Behalf

SECTION 1: INTRODUCTION

Lecture 1: Introduction — What This Course Will Teach You and How to Get the Most From It

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This opening lecture sets out exactly what Microsoft 365 Copilot will let you do across your working day, how this course is structured to get you there, and the handful of habits that separate people who get real value from Copilot from people who try it twice and give up. By the end you will know what you are learning, in what order, and how to study it so the skills stick.

💬 Core Concepts

What this course actually teaches you

This is not a tour of buttons. It is a course about running a real working day — email, documents, spreadsheets, decks, meetings, shared pages and agents — with an AI assistant that can see your own business content.

- **Copilot is grounded in your work, not just the web.** "Grounded" simply means the answer is built from real content rather than invented. Microsoft 365 Copilot can read the emails, files, chats, meetings and lists your own account already has permission to open. That is what makes the output usable rather than generic.
- **Prompting is the skill, not the app.** The apps change every few months. The way you structure a request — Role, Task, Context, Aim — does not. Section 3 is the section that makes every later section work.
- **Permissions are the guardrail.** Copilot can only surface what your account can already open. Understanding that single rule removes most of the fear and most of the false expectations.
- **Verification is part of the workflow.** Copilot drafts; you decide. Every professional workflow in this course ends with a check step, not a copy-paste.

Where we work, and on what plan

- Everything in this course is demonstrated at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** — the Microsoft 365 Copilot app you sign into with your work account. That is our home base for all 70 lectures.
- The plan used throughout is **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, taken on a free trial at the start. We look at every plan option, and the reasoning behind this choice, in **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks**.
- You may also have seen **copilot.microsoft.com**. That is Microsoft's consumer Copilot, signed into with a personal Microsoft account. It is a capable general assistant for personal use, but it does not connect to your work email, files or meetings — so it is not where we work in this course.
- On our plan, work content reaches Copilot Chat through **Work IQ**, Microsoft's work-intelligence layer. When it is on, Copilot Chat can draw on your permitted work files, mail and meetings. Older versions of the interface showed separate **Work** and **Web** toggle buttons; those buttons are not present on our plan, and you do not need them. We cover Work IQ properly in **Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files**.

A quick reassurance about the interface

Microsoft is an AI company shipping AI products, so the Copilot interface moves quickly — buttons get renamed, panels move, new options appear. Everything here reflects the interface as it stands today. If your screen looks slightly different from mine, do not panic: the **capability** and the **prompting method** are what you are learning, and those are stable. Look for the same idea in a slightly different place, and you will find it.

How the course is structured

Part of the course	What it covers	What you can do afterwards
Sections 1–2	Plans and versions, setup, the Copilot app, Copilot Chat, Copilot Pages, data protection	Find your Copilot, ask it about your own files safely
Section 3	Prompting with RTCA, grounding, iteration, house style, fact-checking	Get first-time-right output instead of vague waffle
Sections 4–7	Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint	Clear a mailbox, draft agreements, analyse sales, build decks

Sections 8–9	Teams, meetings, Loop	Catch up on a meeting you missed, run shared collaborative pages
Sections 10–11	Agents and governance	Build a no-code agent and deploy it responsibly

How to get the most from this course

- **Follow along in your own Microsoft 365 account.** Watching is not learning. Pause, run the prompt, compare your result with mine.
- **Use your own data where you can.** The Pashun Sports T-Shirts demos are real files in a real Microsoft 365 account — mirror them with your own supplier, your own sales sheet, your own mailbox.
- **Allow a little time for new content to appear.** Newly created files, calendar events and user profiles take a while to become visible to Copilot. If a prompt returns nothing, wait a short while and try again before assuming you did it wrong. I will flag this in every lecture where it matters.
- **Build your prompt library as you go.** Every prompt in this course is in the handout pack. Save the ones that work for you.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul walks through the course from the inside, using the live Pashun Sports T-Shirts account on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, so you can see exactly where you are heading:

1. Opens the **Microsoft 365 Copilot app** at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and runs one grounded prompt — *"Summarise everything I know about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch from my emails, files and meetings this month"* — showing Copilot pull together the fabric quote thread with Jamie Jordan (Project Manager), the sales and invoice thread with Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance), the **Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx**, and the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** calendar entry into a single answer with clickable references.
2. Shows the same question asked vaguely — *"tell me about the t-shirt thing"* — to demonstrate why Section 3 exists.
3. Points out that this answer is possible because **Work IQ** is giving Copilot Chat access to permitted work content on this plan — there is no Work/Web toggle to switch on.
4. Previews three destination skills you will own by the end: summarising a long supplier thread in **Outlook**, analysing US sales by state in the **Pashun Sports – US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** workbook, and building a returns-policy agent with no code.
5. Points out a practical detail you will meet later: contacts typed manually into Outlook are not recognised by Copilot as "people" — only real directory users such as Paul, Jamie and Morgan are. This is the kind of hands-on reality the course is built around.

✅ Summary

- This course teaches you to run a full working day with Copilot — email, documents, spreadsheets, decks, meetings, shared pages and agents.
- We work throughout at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**; the consumer app at copilot.microsoft.com is a separate, personal-use product.

- Copilot's advantage over generic AI is **grounding**: with **Work IQ** switched on, it reads your own permitted business content.
- **Prompting (Section 3) is the highest-leverage skill** in the entire course; everything after it depends on it.
- Every demo follows one realistic business, Pashun Sports T-Shirts, so the workflows transfer straight to your own job.
- The interface will keep evolving — the skills you learn here will still apply.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** with your work account and confirm you can reach the Microsoft 365 Copilot app.
2. Note which Copilot experience you have — the included Copilot Chat, or a licensed plan such as **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**. You will confirm this properly in **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks**.
3. Run this prompt exactly: *"Summarise the key themes across my emails from the last seven days and list the three things most likely to need my attention."*
4. Write down one recurring task in your week — a weekly report, a supplier follow-up, a status update — that you would like Copilot to take off your hands by the end of this course. Keep it visible; you will build it for real in Sections 4–10.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 1: Introduction — What This Course Will Teach You and How to Get the Most From It** and use the **Course Roadmap & Setup Checklist**, then download the full **Everyday Prompt Pack** from **Lecture 5: DOWNLOAD: Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout (including the Everyday Prompt Pack)** before you start Section 2.

Lecture 2: The Birth of AI Copilots and Why Microsoft 365 Copilot Changes Everything

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This lecture gives you the short, practical history of how AI assistants became "copilots" — and why Microsoft 365 Copilot is a genuinely different category of tool from ChatGPT, Gemini or any standalone chatbot. By the end you will be able to explain, in one sentence to a colleague or a client, exactly what makes Copilot worth paying for.

Throughout this course we work at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan (we started on a free trial). That is the same address and the same plan you will see in every demo.

💬 Core Concepts

The four waves that got us here

- **Wave 1 — Rules-based assistants (1995–2015).** Clippy, autocorrect, Outlook rules. These followed instructions someone wrote in advance. They could not understand meaning, only triggers.
- **Wave 2 — Voice assistants (2011–2020).** Siri, Alexa, Cortana. Better at hearing you, still narrow: set a timer, play a song, check the weather. They had no access to your work.
- **Wave 3 — Large language models (2020–2022).** A large language model is simply an AI trained on huge amounts of text so it can write and answer in natural language. GPT-3, then ChatGPT in November 2022. Suddenly a machine could write a decent email, summarise a document and answer in plain English — but it knew nothing about *your* business. You had to paste your content in.
- **Wave 4 — Copilots (2023–present).** Microsoft announced Microsoft 365 Copilot in March 2023, with general availability for enterprise from November 2023 and for small business plans such as Business Standard and Business Premium from January 2024. The breakthrough was not a smarter model. It was **grounding** — a plain-English way of saying the AI is connected to your actual work, so its answers come from your real emails, files and meetings.

What "copilot" actually means

The name is deliberate. A copilot does not fly the plane. You remain the pilot: you set the destination, you check the instruments, you sign off the result. Copilot handles the workload — drafting, summarising, searching, calculating — and you stay accountable for what leaves your outbox. This distinction matters legally and professionally, and we return to it in **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice**.

Microsoft 365 vs Microsoft 365 Copilot — the difference in one line

Microsoft 365 is the productivity suite you already know: Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, OneDrive, SharePoint. **Microsoft 365 Copilot** is the AI layer that sits on top of that suite and is allowed to read the work you already have permission to see. Our plan, **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, gives us both in one licence. We compare all the available plans, what each one costs and exactly why we chose this one in **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks**.

The three ingredients that make Copilot different

1. **The language model** — the reasoning and writing engine, running inside Microsoft's own infrastructure.
2. **Your work data** — your emails, files, chats, meetings, calendar, contacts, SharePoint sites and Teams channels, reached through **Work IQ**, the work-intelligence layer in our plan that lets Copilot Chat see your business content.
3. **The Microsoft 365 apps** — Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, Loop, OneNote, Planner — where the work actually happens.

Copilot sits in the middle of those three. A public chatbot only has ingredient one.

A quick word on Work IQ (and "Work and Web" buttons)

On some older or different versions of the Copilot interface you may have seen two toggle buttons labelled **Work** and **Web**, where you chose whether Copilot answered from your company content or

from the public internet. Our interface at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** does not have those buttons. Instead, **Work IQ** is switched on for the plan, and Copilot Chat can draw on your work files, emails and meetings alongside the web without you flipping a switch. If you read an older article or watch an older video mentioning Work/Web mode, you now know exactly what it was and why you will not see it here.

A note on copilot.microsoft.com

You may also come across **copilot.microsoft.com**. That is the free, consumer version of Copilot — great for general questions, images and everyday personal tasks, and it is where a personal Microsoft account signs in. It is not connected to your business content and it is not where we work in this course. Everything we do runs at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** signed in with a work account.

Standalone AI vs Microsoft 365 Copilot

Capability	ChatGPT / Gemini / consumer Copilot	Microsoft 365 Copilot (our plan)
Understands natural language	Yes	Yes
Knows your emails, files and meetings	No — you must paste content in	Yes, through Work IQ
Respects your existing file permissions	No	Yes — it can only see what you can already open
Works inside Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams	No	Yes, natively
Can summarise a meeting you missed	No	Yes, from the Teams recording and transcript
Your prompts train the public model	Often, by default	No — commercial data protection applies
Produces a shareable working document	Copy and paste	Yes — Copilot Pages

The permissions point — the one most people miss

Copilot inherits your identity. It cannot show you a payroll spreadsheet you were never given access to. At Pashun Sports T-Shirts, when Paul Ashun (Founder & Director) asks Copilot about margin per unit, it can reach Morgan Reyes' shared finance workbook because Paul has been granted access to it. Ask the same question from an account without that access and Copilot simply will not find it. This is why the security question in most organisations is not "is Copilot safe?" but "are our SharePoint permissions already tidy?" — covered in **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See**.

Why this changes the working day

The value is not that Copilot writes a nicer paragraph. It is that the eight minutes you spend looking for the fabric quote Jamie Jordan sent three weeks ago becomes a fifteen-second question. Multiply that across email triage, meeting catch-up, spreadsheet analysis and deck building, and you are reclaiming hours, not seconds.

One reassurance before we go further

Microsoft is an AI company shipping updates constantly, so buttons move, panels get renamed and new options appear. If your screen looks slightly different from mine, you are not doing anything wrong. Focus on *what* we are asking Copilot to do — that stays stable even when the layout shifts, and you will always find the same feature within a click or two.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates the difference live at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, using the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant and the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch.

1. **The chatbot attempt.** Paul opens a public AI chatbot and asks: *"What price did our fabric supplier quote us for the performance blend?"* The chatbot has no idea — it offers to help if Paul pastes the email in. That is the whole limitation in one screen.
2. **The Copilot attempt.** Paul signs in with his work account at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and asks the same question in plain English: *"What price did Ridgeline Apparel Supply quote for the performance blend fabric, and who sent it?"* Copilot returns the figure, names Jamie Jordan as the sender, gives the date, and shows a numbered citation linking straight back to the original email thread.
3. **Following the citation.** Paul clicks the citation to confirm the answer came from a real message in the tenant, not from a guess. This citation-checking habit is the single most valuable behaviour in the entire course.
4. **The permissions proof.** Paul asks Copilot for content from a file he has not been granted access to. Copilot returns nothing. Access is bounded by identity, not by good intentions.
5. **Cross-app grounding.** Finally, Paul asks: *"Summarise everything about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch from the last two weeks."* Copilot draws on the email threads, the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** calendar event, the Teams *Production* channel and the **Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx** document — four sources, one answer, in a few seconds.

A realistic note Paul flags on screen: Copilot needs a little time to index new content, and mail, calendar, files and people profiles are each indexed on their own schedule. A document saved five minutes ago may not be findable yet. If Copilot says it cannot find something you know exists, wait and retry before assuming the tool is broken.

✅ Summary

- AI assistants evolved through four waves: rules-based, voice, large language models, and now copilots — the leap was grounding in your own work, not raw intelligence.
- Microsoft 365 is the app suite; **Microsoft 365 Copilot** is the AI layer on top of it. Our plan, **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, includes both.
- Copilot combines a language model, your work data through **Work IQ**, and the Microsoft 365 apps. Consumer chatbots only have the first of the three.
- Copilot can only access what your own account can already access — it inherits your permissions, it does not bypass them.
- The "copilot" name is literal: you stay the pilot, accountable for checking and approving every output before it goes anywhere.
- Real-world value comes from removing search and drafting time across the whole working day, not from any single clever answer.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and sign in with your **work** account, not a personal one.
2. Ask Copilot a question about your own organisation — for example: *"What were the main points from my emails with [colleague's name] in the last two weeks?"*
3. Look for the numbered **citations** in the answer. Click one and confirm it opens the real email or file it came from.
4. Now ask a public AI chatbot the exact same question and note the response. Write down, in one sentence, the practical difference you just observed — you will use this framing when you make the case for Copilot to a manager or client.
5. If Copilot returns nothing, check whether the content is only a few days old; very recent items may not be indexed yet. Retry a little later rather than concluding it does not work.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the numbered folder for **Lecture 2: The Birth of AI Copilots and Why Microsoft 365 Copilot Changes Everything** and use the **AI Copilot Evolution Timeline** one-pager together with the **Standalone AI vs Microsoft 365 Copilot comparison table** — both are designed to be forwarded directly to a colleague or decision-maker who needs the business case in under two minutes.

Lecture 3: What Is Microsoft 365 Copilot and Why It Is Different From Every Other AI Tool

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn exactly what Microsoft 365 Copilot *is* — not the marketing description, but the working definition — and why it behaves fundamentally differently from ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude or any other chatbot you have used. By the end you will be able to explain, in one sentence, the single difference that makes Copilot genuinely useful for real business work.

Everything in this course is demonstrated at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan — the same plan the Pashun Sports T-Shirts business runs on. One friendly warning before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface constantly, so a button may sit somewhere slightly different by the time you watch this. That is completely normal, nothing is broken, and the ideas in this lecture stay true whatever the buttons look like.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot is an AI assistant plugged into your organisation's own content.** The AI model is only half of it. The other half is **Microsoft Graph** — simply Microsoft's index of your emails, calendar, files, chats, meetings and SharePoint sites. Copilot answers using both.
- **"Grounding" is the key word.** Grounding just means Copilot first goes and finds relevant content from your own account, then answers *using that content*. This is why it can tell you what

Ridgeline Apparel Supply quoted per unit for the Pashun Pro Tee fabric, when a public chatbot cannot.

- **Work IQ is what switches that on in our plan.** On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, Copilot Chat reaches your work files, emails, meetings and chats through a capability called **Work IQ**. Older write-ups and older videos talk about clicking a **Work** or **Web** toggle above the chat box — those buttons are not in the version we are using, and you do not need them. If you have seen them elsewhere, they were simply the earlier way of choosing between work content and the open web.
- **It inherits your permissions, not the company's.** Copilot can only see what your own account can already open. It does not grant new access. It also does not *tighten* existing access — which is why oversharing deserves attention, covered in **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See**.
- **It lives inside the apps as well as in the hub.** There is Copilot in Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams and Loop, plus the standalone hub at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. Same brain, different context.
- **copilot.microsoft.com is a different product.** That address is the free consumer Copilot — great for general questions, holiday planning and image generation with a personal Microsoft account. It is not where business work happens, it does not see your company content, and we will not be working there at any point in this course.
- **Your prompts and company content are not used to train the public model.** Business data stays inside the Microsoft 365 service boundary under your existing compliance commitments.
- **It is not a search engine and not a database.** It summarises, drafts, compares and rewrites. It can still be wrong, and you remain the editor.

	Public AI chatbot	**Microsoft 365 Copilot**
Knows your email	No	Yes — your mailbox, via Microsoft Graph
Knows your files	Only what you paste or upload	Your OneDrive, SharePoint and Teams files
Knows your meetings	No	Transcripts, recordings, chat, attendees
Security model	Separate account, outside your organisation	Your work sign-in and existing permissions
Where you use it	A browser tab	m365.cloud.microsoft plus Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams
Who it thinks you are	Anonymous user	Paul Ashun, Founder & Director, Pashun Sports T-Shirts
Data used for training	Often, by default	No
Best at	General knowledge, brainstorming	Your actual work, in your actual context

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates the difference with one identical question asked in two places, using the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** setup.

1. In a public chatbot, Paul asks: *"What price did Ridgeline Apparel Supply quote for the Pashun Pro Tee fabric, and when do we need to confirm the order?"* The answer comes back confident and entirely invented — no supplier, no price, no deadline. This is the failure mode every professional should learn to recognise.
2. Paul signs in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and asks Copilot Chat the same question. Because **Work IQ** is available on this plan, Copilot retrieves the fabric quote email thread between Paul and **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)**, returns the quoted price and confirmation date, and shows **numbered citations** linking straight back to the source messages.
3. Paul clicks a citation to prove the point: the answer came from a real email in the business, not from the model's imagination. **Always click at least one citation.**
4. Paul then shows Copilot reading across several sources at once — combining the Ridgeline quote thread with the **Pashun Sports – US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** workbook and the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** calendar event to answer: *"Are we on track to confirm fabric before the next production catch-up?"*
5. Finally, Paul shows a helpful limitation: asking about a document that has only just been created and has not finished being indexed yet. Copilot answers vaguely or says it cannot find it. **Grounding is not instant** — brand new or newly shared content can take a while to appear, and knowing that in advance saves you hours of unnecessary troubleshooting.

✅ Summary

- Microsoft 365 Copilot = an AI model **plus** your organisation's own content, joined together by Microsoft Graph.
- The technical term for that joining-up is **grounding**, and it is the entire reason Copilot is different from a public chatbot.
- On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, access to your work content comes through **Work IQ** — there is no Work/Web toggle to press in this version of the interface.
- **copilot.microsoft.com** is the free consumer Copilot and is not where business work happens; we work at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**.
- Copilot sees exactly what your account can already see — no more, no less.
- Citations are your proof of grounding; if an answer has no citation, treat it as general model knowledge rather than business fact.
- Copilot is a drafting and summarising partner, not an authority. You stay accountable for the output.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** with your work account and open Copilot Chat.
2. Ask a question that could **only** be answered from your own content, such as: *"Summarise the last email thread I had about supplier pricing and tell me what I still owe a reply on."*
3. Click at least one citation in the answer and check it points to a real message or file.
4. Ask the same question in a public AI chatbot that has no access to your work account, and notice how the answer changes.
5. Write one sentence in your own notes finishing this line: *"The difference between Copilot and a public chatbot is…"* — you will reuse this when you explain Copilot to colleagues.

If your first attempt returns little or nothing, stay relaxed — that usually means indexing is still catching up rather than anything being wrong, and **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks** helps you confirm exactly what your plan includes.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the numbered folder for **Lecture 3: What Is Microsoft 365 Copilot and Why It Is Different From Every Other AI Tool** and use the **Copilot vs Public AI Comparison Sheet** together with the **Grounding Test Prompts** card, which gives you five ready-made questions for checking whether Copilot is genuinely reading your own content.

Lecture 4: Meet Pashun Sports — The Real Business You Will Use for Every Demo in This Course

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Every demo in this course runs on one real Microsoft 365 tenant belonging to one fictional business — **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** — so you are never watching toy examples with invented data. In this lecture you will meet the business, the people, the launch project and the actual files we will point Copilot at for the next ten sections.

💬 Core Concepts

The business. Pashun Sports T-Shirts is a small US sports-apparel brand. It sells generic performance t-shirts the world will love, starting with the American market. It has a website, a handful of staff, one fabric supplier, and far too many spreadsheets. You play the role of the non-technical person who keeps it all moving.

The project. Everything in this course revolves around one live piece of work: the launch of the **Pashun Pro Tee**, a new performance-blend t-shirt line for the US market. That launch generates exactly the kind of work Copilot is good at — supplier email threads, a range brief, a sales forecast, a pitch deck, production meetings and a launch checklist.

Where we work. Every demo is filmed in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. That is the business version of Copilot — the one that can see your own work content. The free consumer chatbot at copilot.microsoft.com is a different product aimed at personal use, and it has no view of your business files, mail or meetings, so we do not use it anywhere in this course. We compare the plans properly in **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks**.

The people. Copilot behaves very differently when you ask it about a *real* person in your organisation versus a name typed into a contact card. All three people below are real licensed users in the tenant with real mailboxes, calendars and Teams activity — which is why Copilot can answer questions like "what did Jamie send me about the fabric quote?"

Person	Role	Licence	Why they matter

Paul Ashun	Founder & Director	Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot	The account you watch throughout — the only one with Copilot
Jamie Jordan	Project Manager	Business Basic	Owns production timelines, supplier follow-ups, Planner tasks
Morgan Reyes	Head of Finance	Business Basic	Owns sales numbers, margins, invoices, the US forecast
Ridgeline Apparel Supply	Fabric supplier (Georgia, USA)	External	The source of quotes, lead times and the supplier agreement

The assets already in the tenant. These are the files Copilot will be grounded in — grounding simply means Copilot reads your actual content before answering, instead of guessing. Recognise them now — you will see them again and again:

- **Outlook** — a fabric quote thread between Paul and Jamie, and a sales & invoice thread between Paul and Morgan
- **Calendar** — *Weekly Production Catch-Up* and *Monthly US Sales Review* recurring meetings
- **Word** — `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`
- **Excel** — `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx` (US Forecast and Sales Summary tabs)
- **PowerPoint** — `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx`
- **Teams** — the *Pashun Sports T-Shirts* team, Production channel, plus 1:1 chat history
- **Planner** — *Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch*, including an assigned task for Jamie
- **OneNote** — *Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch Checklist*
- **SharePoint list** — *Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts* (three supplier rows), which lives on the team's own SharePoint site rather than in personal OneDrive

One thing to understand early. Copilot only reaches content you already have permission to see, and only content Microsoft has indexed. On our plan, that access to work content is provided by **Work IQ** — Microsoft's work-intelligence layer that lets Copilot Chat draw on your files, mail, meetings and chats. You may have seen older screenshots or videos with separate **Work** and **Web** toggle buttons above the chat box; those buttons are not part of the interface we are using. With Work IQ switched on, Copilot simply looks at your work content and the web together. This is also why the cast are real licensed users rather than typed-in contacts, and why a brand-new file may not be answerable for a short while. We cover exactly what Copilot can and cannot see in **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See**.

A quick reassurance. Microsoft ships changes to this interface constantly — it is an AI company, so buttons move, panes get renamed and new features appear mid-course. If your screen does not match a screenshot exactly, do not worry: the skills and prompts in this course are what matter, and they carry over. Whenever a name changes, look for the nearest equivalent wording on screen.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul signs in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on the live Pashun Consulting tenant and takes a guided tour of the business rather than the software:

1. Opens **Outlook** and scrolls the Paul ↔ Jamie fabric quote thread with Ridgeline Apparel Supply, pointing out the lead-time and price-per-unit details we will later ask Copilot to summarise in Section 4.
2. Opens **`Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`** and shows the US Forecast and Sales Summary tabs — the raw material for the Excel work in Section 6.
3. Opens **`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`** in Word and shows the sizing, colourway and fabric sections we will expand, rewrite and repurpose in Section 5.
4. Opens the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team in Teams, shows the Production channel and the *Weekly Production Catch-Up* series in the calendar — the meetings we will have Copilot recap in Section 8.
5. Returns to the Copilot app and runs one first prompt in Copilot Chat to prove the grounding is real: **"Summarise the latest email thread between me and Jamie Jordan about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote, and list any dates or prices mentioned."**
6. Points out where the answer's citations come from, so you can see Copilot is reading the actual mailbox — not inventing a plausible supplier story.

✅ Summary

- Every demo in this course runs on one real tenant and one real business — **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** — so the techniques transfer straight to your own work.
- We work in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan, not the consumer chatbot at copilot.microsoft.com.
- The running project is the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch, supplied by **Ridgeline Apparel Supply** in Georgia, USA.
- **Paul Ashun** (Founder, Copilot-licensed), **Jamie Jordan** (Project Manager) and **Morgan Reyes** (Head of Finance) are real users with real mail, calendar and Teams activity.
- Copilot reaches your work content through **Work IQ**, and only content that is genuinely indexed and that you have permission to see — real users and real files matter more than realistic-looking names.
- Learn the file names now: the range brief, the US sales and stock forecast, the Pro Tee pitch deck and the US Launch Checklist recur in almost every section.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Write down the equivalent of Pashun Sports in your own organisation: one live project you are currently working on.
2. List the three people you exchange the most email and meetings with on that project — these are your Jamie and Morgan.
3. Identify one document, one spreadsheet and one recurring meeting attached to that project, and note their exact file names.
4. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, open Copilot Chat and run this prompt, substituting your own names: **"Summarise the latest email thread between me and [name] about [project], and list any dates, prices or commitments mentioned."**
5. Note whether Copilot found it, and whether the citations point at the right messages — that is your personal baseline before Section 2 begins.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 4: Meet Pashun Sports — The Real Business You Will Use for Every Demo in This Course** and use the **Pashun Sports Business Brief & Cast Sheet**, which lists every person, role, licence, supplier detail and file name referenced across the whole course — keep it open beside you as you work.

Lecture 5: DOWNLOAD: Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout (including the Everyday Prompt Pack)

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This lecture hands you the single most useful download in the course: the **Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout**, which includes the **Everyday Prompt Pack** — a set of ready-to-paste prompts built around the Pashun Sports T-Shirts scenario. By the end you'll have the pack downloaded, saved somewhere you'll actually find it again, and one prompt already tested inside Copilot.

💬 Core Concepts

The handout is not a transcript. It's a working reference you keep open on a second screen while you use Copilot at your desk. It contains four distinct parts, and they're used at different moments:

Part of the pack	What's inside	When you use it
Lecture Handouts	One short write-up per lecture — concepts, demo steps, summary, exercise. The folders are numbered by lecture, so Lecture 5 has its own folder, Lecture 6 has its own, and so on	Before or after watching a lecture, to revise without rewatching
The Everyday Prompt Pack	60+ copy-paste prompts grouped by app: Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, and Copilot Chat in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/	Live, at your desk, when you need a result now
The RTCA Prompt Template	The blank Role–Task–Context–Aim skeleton used in Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim	When no stock prompt fits and you're writing your own

Demo Asset List	The Pashun Sports files referenced on screen — the Pashun Pro Tee US Range Brief, the US Sales and Stock Forecast workbook, the Pashun Pro Tee Pitch deck	When you want to rebuild the demo in your own Microsoft 365 account

A few things worth understanding about how the prompts are written:

- **Every prompt is written in RTCA order.** Role, then Task, then Context, then Aim. You'll recognise the shape immediately once you reach Section 3, and it means the prompts are editable rather than magic spells.
- **Placeholders are in square brackets.** Where you see `[supplier name]` or `[quarter]`, swap in your own detail before sending. A prompt sent with the brackets still in it will produce vague output.
- **Grounding references are explicit.** "Grounding" simply means pointing Copilot at a specific file or email rather than hoping it finds the right one. So prompts that need a file name it — for example `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx` — because Copilot gives noticeably better answers when you tell it exactly what to read.
- **Prompts are labelled by plan.** Some work in the free Copilot Chat experience; others need a paid Copilot plan that can read your work files, emails and meetings. Throughout this course we are working on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** (we started on a free trial), which is why the demos can reach real Pashun Sports content. The plan labels match the plans explained in Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks.
- **It is a living document.** Microsoft ships Copilot changes constantly — buttons move, panels get renamed, new features appear. That's normal for an AI company, and it's a good sign rather than a worry: the skills in this pack are about how you ask, not about where a button sits this month. The pack is versioned with a date on the cover page, and when a lecture is re-recorded the pack is re-uploaded.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul downloads the pack live and shows you exactly what to do with it:

1. Downloads the handout ZIP from the Resources panel attached to this lecture and extracts it — not into Downloads, but into OneDrive, so Copilot itself can read it later.
2. Opens the **Everyday Prompt Pack** and scrolls to the Outlook section, highlighting the supplier-thread prompt: *"You are a project manager. Summarise the email thread with Ridgeline Apparel Supply about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote. Pull out agreed price per unit, lead time, and any open questions. Aim: a three-bullet update I can send to Morgan Reyes in Finance."*
3. Pastes that prompt straight into Copilot in Outlook against the real fabric quote thread between Paul Ashun and Jamie Jordan, and shows the result — then shows what happens when the supplier name is left as `[supplier name]`, so you can see why replacing the placeholders matters.
4. Opens the **RTCA Prompt Template** page and shows how the Outlook prompt maps onto it line by line, so you can see the pack isn't a list of tricks — it's one repeatable pattern applied 60 times.
5. Pins the pack as a **favourite in OneDrive** so it's one click away from any Microsoft 365 app on any device.

✅ Summary

- The handout pack contains lecture write-ups in numbered lecture folders, the Everyday Prompt Pack, the RTCA template and the Pashun Sports demo asset list.
- Every prompt is built on the RTCA structure, so you can edit and extend them rather than only copying them.
- Square-bracket placeholders must be replaced before sending; naming the exact file dramatically improves the accuracy of the answer.
- Prompts are labelled by plan — check yours against Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks before assuming a prompt will run. This course runs on Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot.
- Save the pack into OneDrive, not Downloads, so Copilot can reference it and so it follows you across devices.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Download the handout pack from the Resources panel on this lecture and extract it into a OneDrive folder called **Copilot Course**.
2. Open the **Everyday Prompt Pack** and read only the Outlook section — roughly two pages.
3. Choose one Outlook prompt, replace every square-bracket placeholder with a real detail from your own inbox (a real supplier, a real colleague, a real date range).
4. Run it in Copilot in Outlook and read the output critically: is it usable as-is, or does it need one more instruction?
5. Write that extra instruction into the pack as your own note. You have now started customising it — which is the point.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the numbered folder for **Lecture 5: DOWNLOAD: Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout (including the Everyday Prompt Pack)** and start with the **Everyday Prompt Pack (Outlook section)** and the **RTCA Prompt Template** — those two files carry you through the rest of the course.

Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Before you write a single prompt, you need to know exactly which Copilot is sitting behind your account — because "Copilot" is a brand name stretched across several different products with very different capabilities. In this lecture you will identify your own plan in under two minutes, understand which features it unlocks, and see which paid plans you can choose from — including the one this whole course is built on.

One reassurance before we start. Microsoft is an AI company shipping updates constantly, so buttons move, panels get renamed and new options appear. If your screen doesn't match mine pixel for pixel, don't panic — the *checks* in this lecture are designed to survive redesigns, and I'll always tell you what a feature does, not just where it lives today.

💬 Core Concepts

The confusion almost every professional arrives with is this: the word **Copilot** appears in Windows, in Edge, in Teams, in GitHub and in Microsoft 365 — and they are not the same product. What matters for this course is one question only: **can your Copilot see your organisation's work content?**

Here's the landscape, in plain language.

- **Microsoft Copilot (free consumer app, at copilot.microsoft.com)** — the public chat experience, signed in with a personal Microsoft account. It answers from the open web and can work with files you upload in the moment. It has never seen your work email, your work files or your meetings. It's genuinely useful for personal research and drafting, but it is not a business tool and **it is not where we work in this course**. I mention it only so you can recognise it and move on.
- **Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat (included with most work accounts, no extra payment)** — this is the chat you get at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** when you sign in with a work account that has no Copilot added. It answers from the web with *enterprise data protection* — meaning your prompts stay inside your organisation's boundary and aren't used to train Microsoft's models. You can upload a file and ask questions about it, and you can use some agents. What it can't do on its own is reach into your mailbox, your Teams conversations or your SharePoint library.
- **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** — this is our plan, and the exact name matters when you're buying. It's the familiar Business Standard package (Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive) with full Microsoft 365 Copilot included. This is what switches on the Copilot buttons *inside* Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook, and what lets Copilot Chat answer from your own work content.
- **Copilot Studio** — a separate paid product for building custom agents at larger scale. We reference it later in the course, but you do not need it to complete this course.

What actually unlocks your work content: Work IQ

In the current interface there is no **Work / Web** toggle. You may still see older tutorials and blog posts showing two buttons labelled *Work* and *Web* above the prompt box — that was an earlier design, where you manually told Copilot whether to search your organisation or the internet. **Our plan doesn't have those buttons, and doesn't need them.**

Instead, our version uses **Work IQ** — Microsoft's name for the layer that gives Copilot secure access to your work intelligence: your emails, meetings, chats, documents and the working relationships between them. When Work IQ is switched on, Copilot Chat simply decides for itself whether the answer lives on the web, in your work content, or both. You ask the question in normal English and it handles the rest.

So the modern test isn't "do I have a Work button?" — it's "**does Copilot answer questions about my own emails and files?**"

The comparison you should hold in your head

Capability	Consumer Copilot (personal account)	Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat (work account, no Copilot)	Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot
Web-grounded answers	Yes	Yes	Yes
Enterprise data protection	No	Yes	Yes
Ask about your email and calendar	No	No	Yes
Ask about your SharePoint / OneDrive files	No	Uploaded files only	Yes
Work IQ access to work content	No	No	Yes
Copilot button inside Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook	No	No	Yes
Teams meeting recap and transcript questions	No	No	Yes
Copilot Pages	Limited	Yes	Yes
Build your own agents	No	Yes (limited)	Yes
Refer to a colleague by name ("what did Jamie send me?")	No	No	Yes

Which plans can you choose from?

For a small business or a solo professional, the realistic choices are:

1. **Microsoft 365 Business Basic** — web and mobile apps, email, Teams, OneDrive. No desktop Office apps, no Copilot. This is what Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes are on in our demo tenant.
2. **Microsoft 365 Business Standard** — everything in Basic plus the full desktop apps.

3. **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** — Business Standard with Microsoft 365 Copilot included. **This is our plan.**
4. **Microsoft 365 Business Premium** — Standard plus advanced security and device management; Copilot can be added here too.
5. **Microsoft 365 Copilot as a standalone addition** — for organisations already on an enterprise plan who just want Copilot layered on top.

We chose **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** for three reasons: it's the smallest plan that gives you the complete Copilot experience across Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Teams; it's the plan most small businesses and independent professionals will realistically land on; and it was available to start on a **free trial**, which is exactly how the Pashun Sports tenant began. If you're following along and don't yet have Copilot, start there — you can explore the whole course on a trial before committing.

A quick word on credits

Alongside licensed plans, Microsoft also offers **Copilot Credits** — a pay-as-you-go pool that lets people *without* a full licence use certain Copilot features a limited number of times, and lets licensed users tap into heavier agent-driven work. Think of credits as metered top-ups rather than a plan. You don't need them for this course — our plan covers everything we do — but if you ever see a message about credits running low, that's what it's referring to. We'll return to credits when we build agents in **Section 10: AGENTS**.

Two realities worth knowing before you troubleshoot

- **Having the plan is not the same as everything being ready.** A newly added Copilot can take a few hours to appear, and Copilot's indexing of mail, files and people profiles happens on separate timelines. It's completely normal for email questions to work before questions about a named colleague do. Give it time before assuming something is broken.
- **Copilot only sees what you can already see.** It respects your existing Microsoft 365 permissions and grants no new access. It does, however, make poorly-shared content much easier to find — which is exactly why **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See** exists.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates the identification process live on the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** tenant, using the real accounts behind the course:

1. **Paul Ashun (Founder & Director)** — Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot.
2. **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** and **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)** — Microsoft 365 Business Basic, no Copilot.

The demo runs three checks side by side.

- **Check 1 — the account page.** Go to **portal.office.com** → **View account** → **Subscriptions**. Paul's list shows **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**. Jamie's shows **Microsoft 365 Business Basic**. If you're the administrator, the same information lives in the Microsoft 365 admin centre under **Billing** → **Licences**, where you can also see who in your organisation has Copilot and who doesn't.

- **Check 2 — the functional test, and the one Paul trusts most.** Open **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** signed in as Paul, go to Copilot Chat, and ask in plain English: *"Summarise the email thread between me and Jamie Jordan about the Ridgeline Apparel fabric quote for the Pashun Pro Tee."* With Work IQ active, Copilot returns a real summary of that quote thread, with links back to the source messages. On an account without Copilot, the same question gets a polite explanation that it can't reach your mailbox, and an offer to help with something general instead. If you get a partial or empty answer on an account you *know* has Copilot, that's an indexing delay, not a plan problem — try again later in the day.
- **Check 3 — inside the apps.** Paul opens **'Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx'** in Word and points to the Copilot icon in the ribbon. He then opens the same file from Jamie's Business Basic account, where that icon is simply absent. Same file, same tenant, different plan — and you can now tell the difference at a glance. The same holds true in Excel with **'Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx'** and in PowerPoint with **'Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx'**.

Paul also points out what you will *not* see in this interface: there are no **Work** and **Web** buttons above the prompt box. If a tutorial tells you to click "Work mode" first and you can't find it, you're looking at an older build. In our version, Work IQ handles that decision for you.

A practical note from building this tenant: when Paul first tested questions about colleagues, contacts that had been **typed manually into Outlook** were invisible to Copilot. Copilot recognises real directory users in your organisation — people with an actual account and mailbox — not free-typed address-book entries. If you ask about a colleague and get nothing back, confirm they exist as a real user in your tenant before you blame the product.

✅ Summary

- **"Copilot" covers several different products**; the one that reads your work content is Microsoft 365 Copilot, included in our plan, **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**.
- **We work at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/ with a work account** — copilot.microsoft.com is the consumer app and is not used in this course.
- **Work IQ**, not a Work/Web toggle, is what gives Copilot Chat access to your emails, meetings, chats and files in this version of the interface.
- **The Subscriptions page confirms your plan**, and **the Copilot icon inside Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Outlook** is your fastest at-a-glance proof.
- **Plan is not the same as readiness**: mail, files and people profiles are indexed on separate timelines, and only real users in your organisation can be referred to by name.
- **The interface will keep evolving** — learn the checks and the concepts, and a redesign won't throw you.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in to your work account and go to **portal.office.com** → **View account** → **Subscriptions**. Write down every licence listed and note the exact plan name.
2. Open **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and confirm Copilot Chat loads for your work account.
3. Run the functional test with your own content: *"Summarise the most recent email thread between me and [a named colleague in your organisation] about [a real project]."*
4. Open any document in Word and check whether the **Copilot** icon appears in the ribbon.
5. Record your result in one line — *consumer Copilot*, *Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat with enterprise data protection*, or *a plan that includes Microsoft 365 Copilot* — because every remaining lecture assumes you know which one you're working with.

6. If you don't yet have Copilot, look at the plan list in this lecture and consider starting a free trial of **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, as we did, so you can follow every demo hands-on.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks** and use the **Copilot Plan Identification Checklist** and the **Copilot Plan Comparison Table (Consumer vs Copilot Chat vs Business Standard with Copilot)** to record and confirm your own result before moving on.

Lecture 7: How to Set Up and Activate Microsoft 365 Copilot for Yourself or Your Business

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will go from "I think we have Copilot somewhere" to a working, correctly-licensed Microsoft 365 Copilot on your own account — or on every account in your business. We will use the real Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant to walk through choosing a plan, starting a trial, assigning licences, waiting for indexing, and running the first-run checks that tell you Copilot is genuinely live rather than just visible.

One promise before we start: everything in this course is demonstrated on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, working from the Copilot app at `m365.cloud.microsoft`. That is the exact plan and the exact place we work from, start to finish.

A quick word about the interface. Microsoft is an AI company shipping AI products, so buttons move, panels get renamed and new features appear regularly. If your screen does not match mine pixel-for-pixel, you have not done anything wrong. The names of things change far more often than the ideas behind them, and the ideas are what this course teaches. Where something has recently moved, I will say so.

💬 Core Concepts

Microsoft 365 is not the same thing as Microsoft 365 Copilot

This trips up almost everyone, so let's settle it first.

- **Microsoft 365** is the subscription that gives you Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams, OneDrive and SharePoint.
- **Microsoft 365 Copilot** is the AI layer that sits on top of that subscription and can read your own work content — your files, email, meetings and chats — and then write, summarise and analyse using it.

You need the first to have the second. Copilot is not a separate app you buy in isolation; it is an upgrade to a working Microsoft 365 account.

Activation is not one switch

Four things must all be true before Copilot can do useful work on your business data.

- **A qualifying base subscription.** Copilot rides on top of Microsoft 365 — Business Standard, Business Premium, E3 or E5. On the Pashun Sports tenant, Paul Ashun (Founder & Director) runs **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**. Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) run Business Basic with no Copilot — they are there so we can demonstrate real email, calendar and Teams activity between real people.
- **The Copilot entitlement, purchased and assigned.** Buying seats in the Microsoft 365 admin centre is step one. Assigning a seat to a named person is a separate, easily-forgotten step two. An unassigned seat does nothing at all.
- **Content indexing.** Copilot reads your organisation through the Microsoft Graph and what Microsoft calls the semantic index — in plain English, a searchable map of your organisation's content and who is connected to what. Mail, calendar, files and people profiles do **not** all become available on the same timeline. A brand-new user can have Copilot answering questions about their mailbox within an hour but still fail to recognise their own colleagues as people for a day or more.
- **Real user accounts.** This is the most common setup failure. A contact you typed by hand into Outlook is just text, not a person. Copilot will not answer "summarise Jamie's emails about the fabric quote" unless Jamie Jordan exists as a genuine licensed user in your directory with a real mailbox. That is exactly why the Pashun Sports tenant has real accounts for Jamie and Morgan rather than typed-in contacts.

Work IQ — how Copilot Chat reaches your work content on our plan

On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, the piece that gives Copilot Chat access to your work content is called **Work IQ**. Think of it as Copilot's working knowledge of your organisation: who your colleagues are, which files you have touched recently, what was said in your meetings and what is sitting in your inbox.

When Work IQ is active, you can simply ask a question in Copilot Chat and it will draw on your own work content alongside the web — no mode switch, no toggle.

You may have seen older videos and articles showing **Work** and **Web** buttons above the chat box, where you had to pick which world Copilot was allowed to look at. Those buttons belong to an earlier version of the interface. **They are not in the version we use.** If you are following along on our plan and cannot find them, that is expected and correct — there is nothing to switch on.

A note on `copilot.microsoft.com`

There is a consumer Copilot at `copilot.microsoft.com`. It is a genuinely good general-purpose AI assistant for personal use — everyday questions, drafting, image generation, general research from the web. What it is **not** is the place to do business work. It is not grounded in your company files, mail or meetings, and it does not carry the same enterprise data protections. Everything in this course happens at **`m365.cloud.microsoft`**. Bookmark that address now.

Which route applies to you

Your situation	Where you activate	What you get
Individual, personal Microsoft account	A Microsoft 365 Personal or Family subscription	Copilot in the Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and OneNote you use personally — no work content
Solo professional or freelancer on a business tenant	Microsoft 365 admin centre → Billing → Purchase services	Full Microsoft 365 Copilot, grounded in your own OneDrive, mail and calendar
Small business (Pashun Sports scale)	Admin centre → choose a plan that includes Copilot → assign per person	Full Copilot grounded across SharePoint, Teams, Planner and Loop
Larger organisation on E3 or E5	Admin-led rollout, usually with a pilot group and a governance policy first	Full Copilot plus admin controls, search restrictions and audit logs

Which plans can you actually pick from?

There are three practical routes for a business, and it is worth understanding all three before you spend anything.

Option	What it costs you	What it can see
Copilot Chat — included at no extra cost with most Microsoft 365 business subscriptions	Nothing extra	The web, with enterprise data protection. Limited or no access to your own files, mail and meetings
Microsoft 365 Copilot added to an existing subscription	A fixed price per person per month, usually on an annual commitment	Everything: your files, mail, calendar, meetings, Teams chats, plus Copilot inside the Office apps
A bundled plan such as Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot	One combined price per person per month covering both the Microsoft 365 apps and Copilot	The same full access as above, bought as a single product rather than two

How we chose our plan, and why

For Pashun Sports we picked **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, and started on a **free trial** before committing. The reasoning was straightforward:

- **Business Standard includes the desktop apps.** Business Basic is web-only, so Copilot inside desktop Word, Excel and PowerPoint would simply not be there. Since Sections 5, 6 and 7 of this course live inside those apps, Standard was the floor.
- **Business Premium adds security and device-management tooling** that a small apparel brand with a handful of staff does not yet need. Paying for it would have added cost without adding anything you would see in these lectures.
- **E3 and E5 are enterprise plans** sold with enterprise commitments and administration. Overkill here.
- **Buying it bundled is simpler than buying it separately.** One product, one line on the bill, one thing to assign — and no risk of holding a Copilot seat that was never attached to anyone.

- **The trial removed the risk.** A free trial let us prove that grounding actually worked on our own content before any commitment. I would recommend exactly the same sequence to you: trial first, verify grounding, then commit.

Credits and usage

Copilot usage on a paid seat is generous and, for normal working-day use, you are very unlikely to run into a wall. Where you may meet a limit is in the newer, heavier generative features — image generation, video generation and some agent actions — which draw on a pool of **AI credits** attached to your account, topped up on a recurring basis. Free Copilot Chat users get a much smaller allowance of premium responses per day before being moved to a standard model.

In practice: write, summarise, analyse and ask as much as you like. Just be aware that if a video or image tool tells you that you are out of credits, that is a quota, not a fault — and it refreshes.

If your organisation has not paid for Copilot, most of Sections 4 to 10 of this course will not work on your own data. Confirm this before you go further.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates the full activation path on the live Pashun Consulting tenant hosting Pashun Sports T-Shirts.

1. **Check what already exists.** From `admin.microsoft.com`, Paul opens **Billing → Your products** and shows the current subscriptions on the tenant — **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** for Paul Ashun, and Business Basic for Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes. He points out that Copilot is clearly named in the product title, so there is no guesswork about whether it is included.
2. **Show how to buy or trial it.** Paul walks through **Billing → Purchase services → search "Copilot"**, showing the options side by side: Copilot Chat included at no cost, Microsoft 365 Copilot as an addition to an existing subscription, and the bundled **Business Standard with Copilot** plan we chose. He shows where the free trial is offered, the per-person monthly price, and the commitment term — flagging explicitly that the annual option is not cancel-anytime.
3. **Assign the licence to a named person.** Paul goes to **Users → Active users → Paul Ashun → Licences and apps**, shows **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** ticked, and saves. He then opens **Jamie Jordan**, who sits on Business Basic, and explains what Jamie would gain if the business upgraded him — and what he would still be missing on a web-only plan.
4. **Verify activation in the apps.** Paul opens the desktop version of Word with **Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx**, showing the Copilot icon in the ribbon and the draft-with-Copilot prompt on an empty line. He then opens **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** in Excel to show the Copilot button on the Home tab, noting that it becomes genuinely useful once the data is formatted as a proper table — which we sort out in Section 6.
5. **Verify grounding, not just presence.** This is the step most people skip. Paul opens `m365.cloud.microsoft` and runs a live test against mail: *"Summarise the email thread between me and Jamie Jordan about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote."* He then runs a second test against a file: *"What sizes and colourways are listed in the Pashun Pro Tee US Range Brief?"* If either test comes back with "I couldn't find that", the icons are present but the content is not yet indexed.
6. **Confirm Work IQ is doing its job.** Paul points out that there are no **Work** or **Web** buttons above the chat box on this plan — Copilot simply reaches your work content when the question calls for it. He shows the answer citing the actual source file or email underneath the response, which is your proof that Copilot really did read your content rather than guess.

7. **Show the failure mode honestly.** Paul asks Copilot about a supplier contact that exists only as a manually-typed Outlook entry and shows it return nothing useful — then asks the same style of question about **Morgan Reyes**, a real user account, and gets a properly grounded answer. He also opens the **Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts** list, showing that it lives on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team's own SharePoint site rather than in personal OneDrive, and explains why that changes what Copilot can reach.
8. **Set expectations on timing.** Paul explains the realistic wait: Copilot icons appear in the apps within minutes to a few hours of licence assignment; mail and calendar grounding typically within hours; recognising colleagues as people and fully indexing files can take considerably longer. Day one quiet does not mean the setup is broken.

✅ Summary

- **Microsoft 365** gives you the apps; **Microsoft 365 Copilot** is the AI layer that can read your own work content. You need both.
- Our plan throughout this course is **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, started on a free trial, and we work from `m365.cloud.microsoft`.
- Three routes exist: free Copilot Chat, Copilot added to an existing subscription, or a bundled plan like ours — bundled is simplest for a small business.
- Buying seats and assigning seats are two separate actions. An unassigned seat does nothing.
- **Work IQ** is what lets Copilot Chat reach your work content on our plan. The old **Work** and **Web** buttons are not in this version, and nothing needs switching on.
- `copilot.microsoft.com` is a fine personal assistant, but it is not where business work happens and it cannot see your company content.
- Copilot only recognises **real user accounts** as people; manually-typed Outlook contacts will quietly fail to resolve.
- Mail, calendar, files and people profiles become available on different timelines — always verify with a real grounding question rather than trusting the presence of an icon.
- Everyday chat use is effectively unlimited; **AI credits** apply mainly to image, video and some agent features, and they refresh.
- The interface will keep evolving. Learn the ideas, and moved buttons will never throw you.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at `admin.microsoft.com` — or ask your IT admin to confirm on your behalf — and check **Billing** → **Your products** for a product name containing the word Copilot.
2. Open **Users** → **Active users** → **[your name]** → **Licences and apps** and confirm your Copilot-enabled plan is ticked against your account.
3. If you do not have Copilot yet, open **Billing** → **Purchase services**, search for Copilot, and compare the options in the pricing table above. Start a free trial rather than committing straight away.
4. Open Word on the desktop with any real business document. Confirm the Copilot icon is in the ribbon and that "Draft with Copilot" appears on an empty paragraph.
5. Go to `m365.cloud.microsoft` and run a grounding test on your own content — for example: *"Summarise the most recent email thread between me and [a real colleague's name] about [a real project]."*
6. Run a second grounding test against a file: *"What are the key points in [name of a real document in your OneDrive or SharePoint]?"*
7. Check that each answer shows a citation or source link underneath. That is your evidence that Work IQ reached your real content.

8. Note which of the two tests worked. If mail works but files do not — or the other way round — that is entirely normal on a new tenant. Record the date and re-test in 24 to 48 hours before raising a support ticket.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 7: How to Set Up and Activate Microsoft 365 Copilot for Yourself or Your Business** and use the **Copilot Plan Comparison & Activation Checklist** — which covers the plan options, the free trial route, the admin centre click path and the grounding tests — alongside the **Copilot Troubleshooting Sheet** for what to do when the icon appears but the answers do not. Then move on to **Lecture 8: How to Navigate the Microsoft 365 Copilot App — Your AI Command Centre**, where we tour the Copilot app at `m365.cloud.microsoft` panel by panel.

Lecture 8: How to Navigate the Microsoft 365 Copilot App — Your AI Command Centre

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn your way around the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at `m365.cloud.microsoft` — the single hub that sits above Word, Excel, Outlook, Teams and PowerPoint and gives you one place to chat, search, create and reuse work. By the end you will be able to find every part of the interface by name and know which part to reach for when you have a real job to do at Pashun Sports T-Shirts.

Everything here is shown on the exact plan we are using on the Pashun Consulting Ltd tenant: **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, signed in as Paul Ashun, Founder & Director.

One reassurance before we start. Microsoft ships changes to this app constantly — it is an AI company, and the interface moves faster than the software you may be used to. Buttons get renamed, panels move, new things appear. That is a good sign, not a problem. Learn the **names and the jobs** of each part rather than memorising where they sit on screen, and you will still be fluent after the next update. Where something in your view looks different from mine, the job it does will almost always be the same.

💬 Core Concepts

Where we work — and where we don't. There are two different Copilots with similar names, so let's clear that up once:

Address	What it is	Do we use it on this course?

`m365.cloud.microsoft`	The Microsoft 365 Copilot app, signed in with your **work** account. This is the one that can see your business files, emails, meetings and chats.	**Yes — this is our home base for the whole course.**
`copilot.microsoft.com`	The free consumer Copilot, aimed at personal use with a Microsoft account. Great for general questions, image generation and everyday help — but it is not connected to your business data and is not covered by your organisation's data protections.	No. Worth knowing it exists; we do not work there.

The Microsoft 365 Copilot app is reachable three ways, and it is the same experience with the same chat history in all three:

- **Browser** — go to `m365.cloud.microsoft` and sign in with your work account
- **Desktop app** — the Microsoft 365 Copilot app pinned to your Windows taskbar
- **Teams** — the Copilot app pinned to the left-hand rail inside Microsoft Teams

The anatomy of the app. Layouts shift as Microsoft ships updates, so learn the *names*, not the pixel positions:

Area	What it does	When you use it at Pashun Sports T-Shirts
Chat	The main prompt box in the centre of the screen — where you type or speak your request	"Summarise the fabric quote thread with Jamie Jordan"
Work IQ	The setting that lets Copilot Chat reach your own work content — files, emails, meetings and chats on your tenant. Switched on for us.	Asking about the Pashun Pro Tee launch and getting an answer from our own documents
Add content (paperclip)	Points Copilot at one specific file, email or meeting instead of letting it search	Attach `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` before asking for a rewrite
Voice input	The microphone in the prompt box — speak your request instead of typing it	Dictating a long instruction while reviewing the sales workbook
Prompts / Prompt Gallery	Microsoft's library of starter prompts plus prompts you save yourself	Reused every month for the Monthly US Sales Review
Chat history	Every previous conversation, searchable and resumable	Return to last week's Ridgeline Apparel Supply analysis
Pages	Turns an answer into a live, shareable working document	Covered in Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document

Create	Image and design generation	Draft social visuals for the US launch
Agents	Pre-built and custom helpers pinned for repeat tasks	Covered in Section 10: AGENTS
Apps and files feed	Recent and recommended files across OneDrive, SharePoint and Teams	Jump straight back into the US sales forecast workbook

A note on "Work" and "Web" buttons. You will see older tutorials and screenshots that show a **Work / Web toggle** above the prompt box — two buttons that switched Copilot between searching the open internet and searching your organisation's content. On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, that pair of buttons is not what we see. Instead, our access to business content comes through **Work IQ** — when it is on, Copilot Chat can reach your work files, mail, meetings and chats, and it will still use the web when the question calls for it. So rather than flipping a switch, you get the same result by being clear in your prompt: say "from my files" or "from my email with Jamie Jordan" when you want your own data, and say "search the web" when you want the open internet. If your tenant does show the two buttons, nothing is broken — you simply have an interface version where the choice is manual.

Three things that trip people up:

- **Be explicit about your source.** Because there is no Work/Web button in our view, the words you use do that job. "What is the current US retail price range for performance-blend sports t-shirts? Search the web" and "Using my files, what is the latest status of the Pashun Pro Tee US launch?" are two very different requests.
- **Indexing is not instant.** Newly created files, new mailboxes and new colleagues become findable on their own timelines. A brand-new document may not show up in a search for a while — but you can still attach it directly with the paperclip and work with it immediately.
- **People need to be real users.** Copilot can reason about colleagues who exist as licensed users on your tenant (Paul Ashun, Jamie Jordan, Morgan Reyes). A name typed by hand into your Outlook contacts is not a "person" Copilot can look up.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens `m365.cloud.microsoft` signed in as **Paul Ashun, Founder & Director of Pashun Sports T-Shirts**, on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, and walks the interface live:

1. **The landing view** — points out the prompt box in the centre, the recent files feed showing `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx` and `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx`, and the left-hand navigation.
2. **Confirming Work IQ is on** — shows where the Work IQ setting lives and explains in one line what it unlocks: Copilot Chat being able to reach our own Pashun Sports content rather than answering from general knowledge alone.
3. **A web-style question** — asks *"Search the web: what is the current retail price range for performance-blend sports t-shirts in the US?"* and reads the answer with its web citations.
4. **A work-style question** — asks *"Using my files and recent emails, what is the latest status of the Pashun Pro Tee US launch?"* Copilot draws on the range brief, the Planner plan `Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch` and the Production channel in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team.
5. **Attaching a specific file** — uses the paperclip to add `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` and asks for a three-bullet summary for Morgan Reyes in Finance. Paul shows why attaching is more dependable than searching when a file is brand new or has just been rebuilt.

6. **Speaking instead of typing** — taps the microphone and dictates the next request, showing that voice input is simply another way into the same chat.
7. **Referencing a person** — asks *"What has Jamie Jordan sent me about the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote?"* and shows the citation links back to the source emails.
8. **Prompts** — opens the prompt library, picks a summarisation prompt, edits it for Pashun Sports T-Shirts and saves it for reuse.
9. **Chat history** — reopens an earlier conversation to show that work in the app is persistent, not disposable.

Throughout, Paul calls out the **citations** under every answer — clicking through to the source is the habit that separates confident Copilot users from casual ones. He also reminds the class that if a panel has moved since recording, the name and the job will still match.

✅ Summary

- The Microsoft 365 Copilot app at `m365.cloud.microsoft` is one hub reachable from browser, desktop and Teams — same experience, same chat history.
- `copilot.microsoft.com` is the free consumer Copilot for personal use; useful to know about, but not where we work on this course.
- On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, **Work IQ** is what gives Copilot Chat access to your work files, email, meetings and chats — there are no separate Work and Web buttons in our view, so say in your prompt whether you want your own content or the web.
- **Attaching a file** with the paperclip is more dependable than hoping search finds it, especially for new or recently edited documents.
- **Saved prompts** and **chat history** turn one-off questions into a reusable working system, and the **microphone** lets you speak a request instead of typing it.
- Copilot recognises colleagues who are real licensed users on your tenant — not names typed into contacts.
- Expect the interface to keep evolving; learn the names and jobs, and you will stay fluent through every update.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open `m365.cloud.microsoft` in your browser and sign in with your work account.
2. Locate and name out loud: the prompt box, the Work IQ setting, the paperclip for adding content, the microphone, your saved prompts, chat history, Pages and your recent files feed.
3. Ask a general industry question relevant to your own business and include the words "search the web".
4. Ask a similar question about your own organisation, starting with "Using my files and recent emails…" — then click at least one citation to confirm where the answer came from.
5. Attach a specific document from your OneDrive or SharePoint and ask Copilot to summarise it in three bullets for a named colleague.
6. Use the microphone to speak one request instead of typing it, and note how the wording comes out.
7. Save one prompt you would realistically reuse every week.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 8: How to Navigate the Microsoft 365 Copilot App — Your AI Command Centre** and use the **Copilot App Interface Map** one-pager alongside the **Work IQ Grounding Checklist**; then carry them forward into **Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files**.

Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you learn the single most-used surface in Microsoft 365 Copilot — **Copilot Chat** — and the one distinction that governs everything you do in it: whether Copilot is answering from **the open web** or from **your own business content**. We work in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan, and by the end you will be getting grounded, trustworthy answers about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch.

One quick note before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface constantly, so a button may sit somewhere slightly different by the time you watch. Don't worry — the ideas in this lecture stay the same, and I point out what to look for rather than only where it sits today.

💬 Core Concepts

- **One chat box, two possible sources of truth.** Copilot Chat can answer from the public internet, or from your organisation's own files, emails, chats and meetings. On some older or different versions of the interface you may have seen separate **Web** and **Work** buttons above the prompt box. Our plan does not work that way.
- **Our plan uses Work IQ.** Work IQ is simply Microsoft's name for Copilot's access to your work intelligence — your files, mail, calendar, Teams chats and more. When Work IQ is switched on, Copilot Chat can reach your business content; when it is off, you are effectively getting a web-and-model answer only. There is no Web/Work toggle to hunt for on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** — you control it with Work IQ and with how you write the prompt.
- **You still steer the source with your words.** Ask for market trends and Copilot reaches outward; ask about "my email thread with Jamie" or reference a file and it reaches inward. Being explicit about which you want is the single biggest quality lever in this whole course.
- **Grounding** simply means pointing Copilot at specific content instead of hoping it finds the right thing. You ground by typing `/` to reference a file, or by typing a colleague's name to pull in their related mail and meetings.
- **Permissions are respected exactly.** Copilot only ever returns content you already have permission to open. It does not widen your access; it speeds up your access.
- **The people point.** Copilot recognises people through **Entra ID** — that's Microsoft's directory of the real, licensed users in your organisation. A contact you typed by hand into Outlook is just text, so Copilot will not treat it as a person. In Pashun Sports, Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) are real tenant users, which is exactly why they work beautifully in prompts.
- **Indexing is not instant.** File content, mailbox content and people profiles all become searchable on their own timelines. A document saved five minutes ago may not be answerable yet. That's normal behaviour, not a fault — and it's easily worked around.

- **Citations are the trust layer.** Answers drawn from your business content carry numbered references back to the source email, document or meeting. Always open at least one before you act on an answer.
- **You can speak your prompts.** The prompt box includes a microphone so you can dictate rather than type — genuinely useful for long, context-rich prompts. We go deeper on voice later in the course.

Question you want to ask	Where the answer should come from	Why
"What are typical US wholesale margins on performance tees?"	Public web	Public market data, no internal source exists
"Summarise my email thread with Jamie about the fabric quote"	Your work content	Lives in your mailbox
"What did Ridgeline Apparel Supply quote us per unit?"	Your work content	Supplier detail sits in files and mail
"Draft a launch email using our brand tone and US sizing norms"	Your work content, grounded on a file	Needs both internal voice and internal facts
"Who else is working on the US launch?"	Your work content	Resolved through Entra ID and your organisation's activity

A word on **copilot.microsoft.com**: that is Microsoft's consumer Copilot — a free, personal, web-facing assistant. It is a perfectly good tool for personal use, but it has no connection to your business tenant, no access to your work files, and different data handling. Everything in this course happens at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in with your work account.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** tenant on the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch and demonstrates the following sequence:

1. Opening Copilot Chat at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in as Paul Ashun (Founder & Director, **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**), and confirming **Work IQ** is switched on before typing anything.
2. **A web-facing question:** *"Act as a US apparel market analyst. Summarise current consumer trends in performance-blend sports t-shirts in the US market, with three implications for a small challenger brand."* Paul shows that the answer cites public sources — and contains nothing about Pashun Sports.
3. **A work-facing question in the same box:** *"Summarise what I know about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch so far."* Copilot pulls from the range brief, the Paul–Jamie fabric quote thread and the Weekly Production Catch-Up calendar entry.
4. **File grounding with `/`:** *"/Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx — list every decision that is still marked as open, and who owns it."* Paul opens the citation to prove the answer came from the document itself.
5. **Cross-source query:** *"Using my emails with Jamie Jordan and the Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast workbook, what is the gap between forecast launch volume and what our supplier has quoted for?"* This is the moment the value lands — one question, three sources, thirty seconds.

6. **People grounding:** *"What has Morgan Reyes sent me about invoicing for the Pro Tee line?"* Paul contrasts this with a manually-typed Outlook contact, which returns nothing, and explains the Entra ID reason.
7. **Using voice:** Paul dictates a longer prompt with the microphone to show how much faster rich, detailed prompts become when you speak them.
8. **Handling a quiet answer gracefully:** Paul asks about a file saved moments earlier to show the indexing delay, then re-runs it successfully — so you recognise the behaviour instead of assuming Copilot is broken.

✅ Summary

- Copilot Chat can answer from the public web or from your own business content — and telling it clearly which you want is the number-one driver of a good answer.
- On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** there is no Web/Work toggle; **Work IQ** is what gives Copilot Chat access to your work files, mail, chats and meetings.
- Copilot respects your existing permissions exactly; it never shows you content you could not already open.
- Use `/` to reference a specific file, and a real colleague's name to pull their mail, chats and meetings into the answer.
- Only real Entra ID users (like Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes) resolve as people — typed-in contacts do not.
- Always open a citation before acting, expect a short indexing delay on brand-new content, and remember the microphone is there when typing feels slow.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Copilot Chat at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and confirm **Work IQ** is on.
2. Run one prompt about your industry or market and note that it returns nothing about your organisation.
3. Now run: *"Summarise everything I know about [your current live project]."*
4. Re-run it grounded: type `/`, select your most important project document, and ask: *"List every open decision in this document and who owns it."*
5. Ask a person-grounded question: *"What has [a real colleague's name] sent me about [project] in the last 30 days?"*
6. Try step 5 again using the microphone instead of the keyboard.
7. Open **at least one citation** in each answer and confirm the source. Note down one answer that could be sharper — you will use it in **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice**.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files** and use the **Web vs Work IQ Grounding Cheat Sheet** together with the **Pashun Pro Tee Chat Prompt Set** to replicate every prompt shown in the demo.

Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In the last lecture you learned to get answers out of Copilot Chat — but those answers vanish the moment you close the chat. This lecture shows you how to turn any Copilot answer into a **Copilot Page**: a live, editable, shareable document that you and your colleagues can work on together, with Copilot sitting inside it.

Everything here is done at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan — the same plan used throughout this course. A quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface often, so a button may sit in a slightly different place by the time you watch this. The steps and the thinking stay the same, and the handout is kept up to date.

💬 Core Concepts

- **What a Page actually is.** A Copilot Page is a live document saved into your OneDrive (in a folder called *Copilot Pages*). It looks like a document, behaves like a shared whiteboard you can type into, and keeps Copilot available inside it for further editing.
- **Why it matters.** Chat is temporary and private to you. A Page is saved and shareable. The moment an answer is worth keeping or worth showing someone, it should become a Page.
- **"Edit in Pages" is the whole trick.** Most substantial Copilot Chat responses have an icon that sends the answer to a Page. You can keep adding further Chat answers to the *same* Page, building it up section by section.
- **Co-authoring is real-time.** "Co-authoring" simply means two or more people typing in the same document at the same time. Once shared, Jamie Jordan can be working in the top half while you prompt Copilot in the bottom half. Changes appear live, with little photos showing who is where — no attachments, no "final_v3".
- **Copilot lives inside the Page.** Highlight a paragraph on the Page and you can ask Copilot to shorten it, change the tone, or turn it into a table without going back to Chat.
- **Work IQ is what makes the first answer useful.** On our plan there are no separate **Work** and **Web** buttons — you may still see those in older videos or older tenants. Instead, **Work IQ** gives Copilot Chat access to your work content (your emails, files, meetings and chats) alongside the web, so the answer you send to a Page can already be grounded in real Pashun Sports material. This is covered fully in Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files.
- **Permissions follow OneDrive.** A new Page is private to you until you explicitly share it — see Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See.

Feature	Copilot Chat	Copilot Page	Word Document
Persists after closing	No (chat history only)	Yes	Yes
Multiple people editing live	No	Yes	Yes (in Word for the web)

Copilot available inside it	Yes	Yes	Yes
Best for	Quick questions, testing prompts	Fast-moving shared working notes	Formal, formatted deliverables
Typical lifespan	Minutes	Days to weeks	Permanent record

- **The rule of thumb:** Chat to *think*, Pages to *work together*, Word to *publish*. A Page is a staging post, not a final deliverable — when the content is settled, move it into Word (covered in Section 5).

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through a live Pashun Sports T-Shirts scenario: choosing a fabric supplier for the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch.

1. Paul signs in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, opens **Copilot** from the left-hand rail, and checks that **Work IQ** is switched on so Copilot can reach his Pashun Sports content.
2. He prompts: *"Summarise my recent email thread with Jamie Jordan about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote. List the key numbers, the open questions, and anything Jamie is waiting on from me."*
3. Copilot returns a summary with links back to the real quote thread. Paul clicks the **Edit in Pages** icon on the response — the answer slides out into a new Page beside the chat.
4. Paul renames the Page **"Pashun Pro Tee — Supplier Selection Working Page"** and shows that it has saved itself into his OneDrive *Copilot Pages* folder.
5. Back in Chat, he asks a second question: *"Using the Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx, list the three fabric requirements the supplier must meet for the US launch."* He sends that answer to the **same Page** — showing how a Page grows into a working brief.
6. On the Page itself, Paul highlights the supplier summary, clicks the Copilot icon that appears, and prompts inline: *"Turn this into a comparison table with columns for Supplier, Price Per Unit, Lead Time and Open Question."* The prose becomes a table without leaving the Page.
7. Paul clicks **Share**, adds **Jamie Jordan** and **Morgan Reyes**, and sets *Can edit*. He then pastes the link into the **Production** channel of the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team in Teams — where it appears as a live, editable component inside the conversation.
8. **Watch point Paul calls out:** Morgan Reyes is on a Business Basic licence without Copilot. Morgan can still open, read and edit the Page — the *content* is shared, but the Copilot tools inside it are not. This is the most common surprise when Pages are rolled out to a team on mixed plans, and it is worth saying out loud before you share.
9. Paul finishes by typing a manual line under the table — *"Decision due before the Weekly Production Catch-Up"* — proving the Page is a genuine editable document, not a locked AI output.

✅ Summary

- A Copilot Page turns a disposable chat answer into a saved, shareable, co-editable document stored in your OneDrive.
- Use **Edit in Pages** to send an answer across, and keep adding further Chat answers to build one Page up over time.
- With **Work IQ** switched on, the answers you send to a Page are already grounded in your real emails, files and meetings.

- Copilot works *inside* the Page — highlight any text and reshape it into tables, summaries or a different tone.
- Pages are private until you share them, and they paste into Teams channels as live components.
- Colleagues on a plan without Copilot can still view and edit a shared Page — they simply don't get the AI tools inside it.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and open **Copilot**, with **Work IQ** switched on.
2. Ask Copilot to summarise one real email thread or meeting from your last two weeks — include *"list the key decisions and any open actions"* in your prompt.
3. Click **Edit in Pages** to send the answer to a new Page, then rename the Page something a colleague would understand at a glance.
4. Ask Copilot a second, related question in Chat and add that answer to the **same** Page.
5. On the Page, highlight one paragraph and use the inline Copilot prompt to turn it into a table.
6. Share the Page with one colleague as *Can edit*, and paste the link into a Teams chat so you can see it appear as a live component.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document** and use the **Copilot Pages Starter Prompts sheet** and the **Chat vs Pages vs Word decision chart** — both are built around the Pashun Pro Tee supplier-selection scenario used in the demo.

Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This lecture removes the single biggest blocker to trusting Copilot with real business content: not knowing what it can actually see. By the end you will be able to state exactly which Pashun Sports files, emails and chats Copilot can reach, which it cannot, and what happens to your prompts once you hit Enter.

Everything here is demonstrated on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, working at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. That distinction matters for this topic more than any other, so we will be precise about it throughout.

💬 Core Concepts

The golden rule: Microsoft 365 Copilot can see exactly what *you* can see — no more, no less. It inherits your existing permissions from your organisation's directory (Microsoft Entra ID, which is simply the list of real user accounts in your business) and from SharePoint. It does not grant new access, and it does not "learn" your data into the underlying model.

Where you are working matters. There are two different Copilot experiences with similar names, and only one of them is in scope here:

Experience	What it is	Does it see your work content?
Microsoft 365 Copilot at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/	The work Copilot included with our Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot plan, signed in with your work account	Yes — your mail, files, meetings and chats, within your permissions
Copilot at copilot.microsoft.com	The free consumer assistant for personal use, general questions and web content	No — it has no connection to your business files, and business content should not be pasted into it

We work only in the first one. The consumer version is worth knowing exists so you never accidentally put Pashun Sports figures into the wrong window.

Work IQ — how Copilot reaches your business content on our plan. On our plan, Copilot Chat's access to your work content is powered by **Work IQ**, Microsoft's work-intelligence layer that understands your files, mail, meetings and chats. When Work IQ is switched on for your account, Copilot Chat can ground answers in your own business content automatically. You may see older tutorials showing separate **Work** and **Web** toggle buttons above the prompt box — those buttons are **not** in the interface we use. Nothing is missing; the capability is simply built in rather than toggled. This is covered in full in **Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files**.

The three grounding sources Copilot draws on ("grounding" just means the material Copilot bases an answer on):

- **Your Microsoft Graph** — mail, calendar, Teams chats and meetings, OneDrive files, SharePoint sites, Loop pages and Planner tasks you have permission to open.
- **The open web** — when the prompt needs current public information.
- **The prompt itself** — anything you paste in, plus files you explicitly attach or reference with the `/` command.

What Copilot can and cannot see:

Copilot CAN see	Copilot CANNOT see
Files in your OneDrive and any SharePoint site you have access to	Files on your local C: drive that never sync to OneDrive
Your own mailbox, and shared mailboxes you're a member of	A colleague's private mailbox or 1:1 chats you're not part of
Teams channel messages in teams you belong to	Teams meetings that were never recorded or transcribed

Meeting transcripts where transcription was switched on	Content in a PDF attachment that was never saved to a Copilot-indexed location
SharePoint Lists on a Team's own site	Third-party tools (Xero, Shopify, Slack) unless connected via a Graph connector
Word, Excel, PowerPoint, OneNote and Loop content you can open	Files that are corrupt, encrypted, or sensitivity-labelled above your clearance

Five points that matter to a non-technical user:

- **Prompts are not training data.** Your Pashun Sports margin figures stay inside the Microsoft 365 service boundary and are not used to train the foundation model.
- **Oversharing is a permissions question, not a Copilot question.** If the wholesale price list sits on a site where "Everyone except external users" has access, Copilot will helpfully surface it to any employee who asks. Copilot doesn't create that situation — it makes an existing one visible fast, which is a genuine gift if you act on it.
- **Indexing is not instant.** A file saved two minutes ago may not be groundable yet. People-profiles in the directory and mail/calendar grounding index on *separate* timelines, so a brand-new colleague can be findable in chat before their emails are.
- **Typed-in contacts are not people.** A supplier contact typed manually into Outlook is just text. Copilot only treats someone as a "person" it can reason about if they are a real user account in your organisation's directory — which is exactly why Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes are real licensed users in the Pashun Sports tenant.
- **Licence differences change results.** Paul Ashun holds Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot. Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes hold Microsoft 365 Business Basic without Copilot — their content is still reachable by Paul where permissions allow, but they do not get the Copilot experience themselves. If a colleague says "Copilot didn't do that for me", check the licence before anything else.

Sensitivity labels carry through: if a document is labelled *Confidential — Pashun Sports Internal*, any Copilot output that draws on it inherits that label, so the protection travels with the content.

A note on the interface. Microsoft ships changes to Copilot constantly — buttons move, panels get renamed, new options appear. If your screen doesn't match the recording exactly, you haven't gone wrong. The permission model in this lecture is the part that stays stable; look for the same *idea* under a slightly different label and you will find it.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** to make the boundary visible rather than theoretical.

1. **Prove the permission boundary.** Signed in as **Paul Ashun (Founder & Director)**, Paul asks Copilot Chat: *"Summarise the fabric quote discussion with Jamie Jordan about the Pashun Pro Tee."* It returns the thread from the real mailbox. He then asks for a summary of a mailbox he has no rights to — Copilot explains it has no access, rather than inventing content.
2. **Show the "who can reach this?" check.** Paul opens `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` in SharePoint, clicks **Manage access**, and shows that **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** and **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)** both have edit rights — which means Copilot would ground on this file for any of the three, given a Copilot licence.

3. **Demonstrate the oversharing risk safely.** He shares a mock wholesale price list via a broad link, then asks from a second account: *"What is our wholesale unit price for the Pashun Pro Tee?"* Copilot answers. He then tightens the permission, waits for re-index, and re-runs the prompt — access is correctly refused.
4. **Show the indexing lag.** Paul adds a new file to the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team's **Production** channel, immediately asks Copilot about it, gets nothing useful, then shows the same prompt succeeding later — and explains that "Copilot can't see it" is usually a timing or location matter, not a fault.
5. **Show what breaks grounding.** Using the earlier corruption incident on the Range Brief, Paul demonstrates that a damaged or non-indexable file simply doesn't appear — and how to spot that from the citations panel.
6. **Show the people boundary.** Paul compares asking about **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)**, a real directory user, with asking about a supplier contact typed manually into Outlook — and shows why only the first is treated as a person Copilot can reason about.
7. **Check the citations.** Every answer is expanded to show its source links, proving which specific files, emails and Teams messages fed the response.

✅ Summary

- Copilot sees exactly what your Microsoft 365 permissions allow — it never expands your access.
- We work at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/ on Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot; copilot.microsoft.com is the separate consumer assistant and has no sight of your business content.
- On our plan, Work IQ gives Copilot Chat access to your work content automatically — there are no Work/Web mode buttons to switch.
- Your prompts and business data stay inside the service boundary and are not used to train the model.
- Oversharing comes from loose SharePoint and link permissions, not from Copilot itself — and Copilot helps you find it early.
- Local files, unrecorded meetings, other people's private mail and unconnected third-party apps are invisible to Copilot.
- Indexing delays, corrupt files, manually typed (non-directory) contacts and missing Copilot licences are the most common reasons Copilot "can't find" something that clearly exists.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open one business-critical file — your equivalent of the Pashun Sports wholesale price list — and click **Manage access** to list exactly who can open it.
2. In Copilot Chat at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/, ask: *"What files do I have access to that mention [your most sensitive project name]?"* and read the citations carefully.
3. Note any file in that list that surprises you — that is your oversharing risk register, and it starts today.
4. Ask Copilot to summarise a meeting you attended but that was **not** recorded, and observe how it responds. This teaches you the shape of a "no source available" answer so you recognise it instantly.
5. Save a document to your desktop only, then ask Copilot about it. Confirm for yourself that unsynced local files are invisible.
6. Confirm which licence each of your colleagues holds, so you know in advance who will and will not have the Copilot experience.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See** and use the **Copilot Data Visibility Checklist** and the **Oversharing Risk Audit Template** — then keep them alongside the data-protection prompts in **Lecture 5: DOWNLOAD: Microsoft 365 Copilot Course Handout (including the Everyday Prompt Pack)**.

Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot is only ever as good as the instruction you give it, and the gap between a disappointing answer and a genuinely useful one is almost always the prompt — not the tool. In this lecture you will learn the **RTCA framework** (Role, Task, Context, Aim) and use it to turn vague requests into repeatable, business-grade prompts you can reuse every day at Pashun Sports.

Everything here is demonstrated in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in with our **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. Because that plan includes **Work IQ** — the part of Copilot that connects the chat to your work files, emails, meetings and chats — there are no separate "Work" and "Web" buttons to press. You may see those buttons in older screenshots online; on our plan Copilot simply reaches your work content when your prompt points it there. Microsoft updates this interface often, so if a button has moved since recording, the wording and the ideas still hold — look for the same label, not the same pixel.

💬 Core Concepts

The problem with how most people prompt. A typical first attempt looks like *"Summarise my emails"* or *"Write a supplier email."* Copilot has no idea who it is being, what standard of output you want, which files to look at, or what happens next. It fills those gaps with generic assumptions — and you get generic output.

RTCA gives Copilot the four things it is missing:

Element	What it answers	Weak version	Strong version
R — Role	Who should Copilot be?	(nothing)	"You are an experienced apparel sourcing manager."
T — Task	What exactly must it produce?	"Help with the supplier."	"Draft a 150-word email to Ridgeline Apparel Supply following up on the revised fabric quote."
C — Context	What should it ground itself in?	(nothing)	"Use the email thread with Jamie Jordan about the fabric quote and / Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx."

A — Aim	What is the outcome and format?	(nothing)	"Aim: confirm a price and lead time by Friday. Warm but clear, bullet the three open questions."

Key points to hold on to:

- **Role sets tone and expertise level.** "You are our Head of Finance" produces a very different sales summary from "You are a marketing copywriter." Role is the cheapest quality upgrade in the whole framework.
- **Task must be a single, concrete deliverable.** One prompt, one output. If you need an email *and* a slide, that is two prompts — or a task with explicitly numbered outputs.
- **Context is where Copilot's real advantage lives.** Referencing a file with `/` (forward slash) or naming a person or meeting is what separates Microsoft 365 Copilot from a free public chatbot. A prompt with no grounding is just a general chatbot wearing a Microsoft badge.
- **Aim drives format and length.** Say the audience, the length, the tone and the structure. "For Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance, one page, plain English, three bullets per section."
- **Order is a guide, not a law.** RTCA is a checklist you mentally run before you press Enter — it stops you sending a prompt with a hole in it.
- **Grounding caveat:** `/` file references only work on files Copilot can actually reach and has already indexed — that is, files stored in SharePoint, OneDrive or Teams that you have permission to open. ("Indexed" simply means Copilot has finished reading and cataloguing the file behind the scenes.) Recently uploaded or recently renamed files can take a while to appear.
- **You can speak your prompt.** RTCA prompts are long, and the microphone button in the Copilot chat box lets you dictate them instead of typing. Say the four parts out loud in order, then tidy the text before you send.

The RTCA skeleton you can copy:

> **Role:** You are a [role] with experience in [domain].

> **Task:** [One specific deliverable, with a number attached — words, bullets, slides, rows.]

> **Context:** Use /[file] and the email thread with [person] about [subject]. Background: [2–3 lines of business context Copilot cannot infer].

> **Aim:** This will be [used by / sent to] [audience] so that [outcome]. Tone: [tone]. Format: [format].

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works live in the **Microsoft 365 Copilot app at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on the Pashun Sports tenant, building one prompt up through four stages so you can see the quality climb at each step.

1. **The starting prompt.** Paul types *"Write an email to the supplier about the fabric."* Copilot returns a polite, empty, entirely invented email — no prices, no dates, no product name. Paul points out that nothing in it could be sent without a full rewrite.
2. **Add Role.** *"You are an experienced apparel sourcing manager acting for a small US sports-apparel brand. Write an email to our fabric supplier about the performance blend."* The tone sharpens and industry language appears — but the detail is still invented.

3. **Add Task and Context.** Paul rewrites it as: *"Draft a 150-word email to Ridgeline Apparel Supply following up on the revised performance-blend fabric quote. Use the email thread between me and Jamie Jordan about the fabric quote, and /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx for the fabric spec and target launch date."* Because Work IQ is switched on for this plan, Copilot now pulls the actual fabric weight, colourway count and launch window from the brief, plus the open question Jamie raised in the thread.
4. **Add Aim.** Final line added: *"Aim: confirm a unit price and lead time in writing before the Weekly Production Catch-Up on Thursday. Tone: warm but commercially clear. End with three numbered questions."* The output arrives structured, dated, and — Paul's phrase — *"85% sendable."*
5. **Second pass on a different job type.** Paul reuses the same skeleton for a finance task: *"You are our Head of Finance. Produce a 5-bullet summary of US sales performance using /Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, Sales Summary tab. Aim: brief Morgan Reyes ahead of the Monthly US Sales Review — plain English, one risk flagged."* This shows that RTCA works for any job, not just writing.
6. **What Paul deliberately shows going wrong.** He references a file that has not finished indexing, and Copilot answers from general knowledge instead. He shows how to spot it — no reference links or citation chips under the answer — and fixes it by attaching the file directly from the chat box. Watch for those references; they are your proof that grounding worked.

✅ Summary

- **RTCA — Role, Task, Context, Aim — is a pre-flight checklist for every prompt.** Run it mentally before you press Enter.
- **Role controls tone and expertise; Task must be one concrete, quantified deliverable.**
- **Context is Copilot's superpower** — reference real files with `/`, real people and real meetings, which Work IQ on the Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot plan makes available inside chat.
- **Aim tells Copilot the audience, format, length and outcome**, which is what makes output usable rather than merely correct.
- **No references under an answer means no grounding happened** — check before you trust it.
- **The interface will keep evolving** — Microsoft ships changes constantly. RTCA is about how you think, so it survives every redesign.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and pick one real piece of work you have to write this week — an email, a summary or a short brief.
2. Write the simplest possible version of the prompt first: one vague sentence. Run it in Copilot chat and note how generic the result is.
3. Rewrite it using the RTCA skeleton, filling in all four elements. Reference at least one real file with `/` and one real colleague or meeting.
4. Run it again and compare the two outputs side by side.
5. Check for the reference links under the answer to confirm Copilot actually read your file.
6. Save your finished RTCA prompt into a note — you will start building this into a reusable library in **Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library**.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim** and use the **RTCA Prompt Skeleton Card** together with the **Before-and-After Prompt Examples (Pashun Sports)** sheet, which contains the full supplier-email and sales-summary prompts demonstrated above.

Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim you learned how to *structure* a prompt. In this lecture you learn how to *feed* it — pointing Copilot at your own Pashun Sports files, email threads, meetings and colleagues so the answer comes from your business reality instead of Copilot's general knowledge.

We work where we always work in this course: signed in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. A quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface often, so a button may sit somewhere slightly different by the time you watch this. The grounding *technique* below is stable even when the furniture moves.

💬 Core Concepts

Grounding means telling Copilot exactly which of your own content to read before it answers. An ungrounded prompt produces plausible fiction; a grounded prompt produces work you can check and stand behind.

- **The forward slash (`/`)** is your grounding key. Type `/` in Copilot Chat and start typing a filename, an email subject, a colleague's name or a meeting title — Copilot offers matches from your Microsoft 365 account. Select one and it becomes a live reference, not just text.
- **Work IQ is what makes this possible on our plan.** Work IQ is simply Microsoft's name for Copilot's access to your work content — your files, mail, chats, meetings and calendar. On Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot it is on for you, which is why `/` finds real Pashun Sports content. Older versions of the interface had separate **Work** and **Web** mode buttons you had to click between; our version does not show those buttons, because Work IQ handles work content and Copilot still reaches the web when the question calls for it.
- **You can ground on four kinds of thing:** files (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, PDF, OneNote), email and chat threads, meetings (transcript and meeting chat), and people (their recent mail, chats and documents that you already have permission to see).
- **Permissions are inherited, never bypassed.** Copilot can only ground on content your account already has rights to open. If Jamie Jordan cannot open a file today, Copilot will not surface it for Jamie tomorrow.
- **Multi-source grounding is where the real value sits.** Referencing a spreadsheet *and* an email thread *and* a meeting in one prompt lets Copilot reconcile them — spotting where a quoted price in email does not match the margin assumption in a workbook.
- **Thin answers are usually an indexing question, not an intelligence one.** A file saved five minutes ago, a contact typed by hand into Outlook rather than being a genuine account in your

organisation, or a damaged document will each quietly fail to resolve. Copilot answers anyway — from general knowledge.

Grounding method	How you invoke it	Best used for
`/` file reference	Type `/` then the filename	Specific documents, spreadsheets, decks
`/` person reference	Type `/` then a colleague's name	"What has Morgan sent me about US invoices?"
`/` meeting reference	Type `/` then the meeting title	Recapping the Weekly Production Catch-Up
In-app Copilot (Word, Excel)	Open the file, open the Copilot pane	Deep work inside one document
Work IQ (on for our plan)	Nothing to switch on — just ask	Broad search across the work content you own
Paste-in content	Paste text straight into the prompt	Content that lives outside Microsoft 365

The three grounding traps

- **Vague reference.** "Look at the sales spreadsheet" leaves Copilot guessing. Name the file: *Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx*.
- **Phantom people.** A supplier contact typed straight into Outlook is not a real account in your organisation, so `/Ridgeline` returns nothing. Genuine users such as Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes resolve as people every time.
- **Assumed freshness.** File content and people profiles are catalogued on separate timelines. A brand-new document may take a few minutes before it can be grounded on.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works live in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant as Paul Ashun, Founder & Director, preparing for the Monthly US Sales Review. Everything happens in Copilot Chat at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/.

1. **The ungrounded baseline.** Paul asks: *"Summarise our US sales position for the Pashun Pro Tee."* The answer is generic and confidently wrong — no real numbers. This is the result students need to learn to recognise instantly.
2. **Grounding on one file.** He re-runs it as: *"Using /Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, summarise the US Forecast tab and highlight the three states with the weakest forecast-versus-stock position."* Copilot now returns real state-level figures with citations you can click.
3. **Grounding on email.** *"Using my email thread with /Morgan Reyes about US sales and invoicing, list every commitment I made and the date I made it."* Paul shows the citations linking back to the original messages.
4. **Grounding on a person.** *"What has /Jamie Jordan shared with me about the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote in the last month?"* — pulling mail, Teams chat from the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team's Production channel, and the Planner task into one answer.
5. **Grounding on a meeting.** *"Using the /Weekly Production Catch-Up, list the decisions taken and who owns each one."*

6. **Multi-source reconciliation — the headline moment.** *"Act as my finance analyst. Using /Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx and my email thread with /Jamie Jordan on the fabric quote, tell me where the assumptions disagree and which number I should present at the Monthly US Sales Review."* Copilot surfaces the mismatch between the quoted fabric cost and the margin assumption in the brief.
7. **Diagnosing a reference that does not resolve.** Paul deliberately references a file saved moments ago, shows the thin answer, and walks the checks: open the file to confirm it opens cleanly, confirm it is saved to OneDrive or the Team's SharePoint site (SharePoint lists such as *Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts* live on the Team's own site, not personal OneDrive), then wait a few minutes and retry.

✅ Summary

- Grounding is the difference between Copilot guessing and Copilot reporting — always name your source explicitly with `/`.
- Work IQ is what gives Copilot Chat access to your work content on Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot; our version of the interface has no separate Work and Web mode buttons to switch between.
- Copilot can ground on files, email and chat threads, meetings, and genuine colleagues in your organisation — not on contacts typed by hand into Outlook.
- Copilot respects existing permissions absolutely; grounding never grants access you did not already have.
- Multi-source prompts are the highest-value use: reconciling a spreadsheet, a brief and an email thread in one question.
- When an answer feels thin, check indexing time, file health and storage location before blaming the model.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Copilot Chat at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/ and confirm you can see your own recent work content when you type `/`.
2. Run a deliberately ungrounded prompt about a current project and save the answer — this is your control.
3. Re-run the same request grounded on one named file using `/`, then compare the two side by side.
4. Write one person-grounded prompt naming a real colleague, asking what they have sent you on a specific topic this month.
5. Write one multi-source prompt referencing at least two files plus one email thread or meeting, and ask Copilot to identify where they disagree.
6. Note any reference that did not resolve and record why — file too new, not a real account in your organisation, or stored outside OneDrive/SharePoint.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results** and use the **Grounding Prompt Templates & Checklist**, then cross-reference it with the **RTCA Prompt Builder** from Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim.

Lecture 14: How to Refine and Iterate an Output From Rough First Draft to Finished Deliverable

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot's first answer is almost never the finished answer — and the professionals who get real value from it are the ones who treat that first output as a draft to be steered, not a verdict to be accepted. In this lecture you'll learn a repeatable refinement loop that takes a rough Copilot output and drives it to a deliverable you'd genuinely send to a supplier, a client or your Head of Finance.

Everything here is demonstrated on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, working in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and inside Word and Outlook. One reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to these apps constantly, so a button may sit in a slightly different place by the time you watch this. The refinement loop itself doesn't change — if a control has moved, look for the same wording nearby and carry on.

💬 Core Concepts

- **The first draft is raw material, not the deliverable.** Your RTCA prompt from *Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim* gets you 70% of the way. Iteration closes the remaining 30%, and that 30% is what makes the output look like it came from a human who knows the business.
- **Refine in one dimension at a time.** Changing length, tone, structure and facts all in one follow-up prompt produces a mess. Fix structure first, then content accuracy, then tone, then length. Each pass should have a single job.
- **Copilot holds the thread.** Inside a single chat session Copilot remembers the previous draft, so you can say *"keep everything but rewrite paragraph three"* without re-pasting the document. Start a new chat and that memory is gone.
- **Quote the bit you want changed.** Vague instructions get vague edits. *"Make it better"* is useless; *"Replace the phrase 'we would be delighted to explore' with something direct — we've worked with Ridgeline for eight months"* is actionable.
- **Iterate in the app, not just in chat.** In Word you can select a paragraph and use the Copilot icon in the margin to rewrite just that block. In Outlook, **Coaching by Copilot** gives you feedback on your own draft rather than rewriting it — useful when you want to keep your own voice.
- **Know when to start fresh.** If three refinement passes haven't moved the output closer, the prompt is the thing to improve, not the answer. Rewrite the RTCA prompt with better context and run it again — that's faster and cleaner than a fourth pass.

The Four Refinement Moves

Move	When to use it	Example follow-up prompt

Restructure	Right content, wrong shape	"Turn this into four short sections with bold headings, and move the pricing paragraph to the end."
Reground	Facts are thin, generic or wrong	"Rewrite using the actual fabric weights and minimum order quantity figures from *Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx*."
Retone	Accurate but sounds robotic or off-brand	"Rewrite in a warm, direct British business tone. No exclamation marks, no 'delve', no 'leverage'."
Reduce or expand	Length is wrong for the audience	"Cut to 150 words for a busy Head of Finance. Keep the margin figures and drop the background."

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul takes one real Pashun Sports T-Shirts task from rough output to sendable deliverable, using Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot.

The task: a launch-update email to Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) summarising where the Pashun Pro Tee US launch stands ahead of the Monthly US Sales Review.

1. **Pass 0 — the RTCA prompt.** Paul prompts Copilot in Word: *"You are the founder of Pashun Sports T-Shirts. Draft an internal launch-status email to Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes covering the Pashun Pro Tee US launch. Use /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx and /Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx. Aim: they can both walk into the Monthly US Sales Review already briefed."*
2. **Read the draft critically.** It's 600 words, opens with "I hope this email finds you well", buries the stock risk in paragraph five, and includes a delivery date that appears in no source file. Paul names each of those three faults out loud — this is the diagnostic habit students need.
3. **Pass 1 — Restructure.** *"Keep the content but restructure: a two-line summary at the top, then three bold headings — Production, US Forecast, Risks. Put the stock risk under Risks."*
4. **Pass 2 — Reground.** *"The delivery date isn't in either source file. Remove it. Pull the actual unit forecast and stock-cover figures from the US Forecast tab of Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx and name the tab."* Paul opens the workbook side by side and confirms the numbers match — the fact-check discipline covered in *Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice*.
5. **Pass 3 — Retone.** *"Rewrite in plain British English. Drop the opening pleasantry. Jamie and Morgan work here — write as a colleague, not a vendor."*
6. **Pass 4 — Reduce.** *"Cut to under 200 words. Protect the three headings and every number."*
7. **Targeted edit, not a full rewrite.** Paul selects only the Risks paragraph in Word, clicks the Copilot icon in the margin, and uses **Rewrite** to sharpen that block alone — showing that late-stage iteration should get smaller and more surgical, never broader.
8. **The close.** Paul compares Pass 0 and Pass 4 side by side: same underlying facts, but one is a draft and one is a deliverable — roughly 90 seconds of work between them.

✅ Summary

- Treat Copilot's first output as a draft. The value is in the second, third and fourth pass, not the first.
- Refine one dimension at a time — restructure, reground, retone, then reduce — rather than firing vague "make it better" prompts.
- Quote the exact text you want changed, and name the exact file or tab you want Copilot to pull facts from.
- Stay in the same chat session so Copilot remembers the draft; use the in-app Rewrite option for surgical edits to a single paragraph.
- If three passes haven't improved it, improve the prompt — rewrite the RTCA prompt and run it fresh.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick a real piece of work you need to produce this week — a status update, a supplier email or a short internal summary.
2. Write one RTCA prompt for it in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/, grounding it in at least one of your own files using the `/` file reference.
3. Read the first draft and write down exactly three faults: one structural, one factual, one of tone.
4. Fix them in three separate follow-up prompts — one fault per prompt — staying in the same chat.
5. Run a final length pass: *"Cut to X words. Keep every number and heading."*
6. Compare draft one against your final version and note how many passes it actually took. Record that number — it's your personal benchmark for the rest of the course.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 14: How to Refine and Iterate an Output From Rough First Draft to Finished Deliverable** and use the **Refinement Loop Prompt Card** (the four moves with ready-to-paste follow-up prompts) alongside the **Pashun Pro Tee Launch Email — Pass 0 to Pass 4 Comparison** document, so you can see every intermediate draft from the demo, not just the finished version.

Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

You have spent the last three lectures learning how to build a strong prompt from scratch — but rewriting the same prompt every Monday morning is wasted effort. In this lecture you will learn how to use Microsoft's built-in Prompt Gallery, save and pin your own prompts, and build a reusable Pashun Sports prompt library that turns your best RTCA prompts into one-click work.

Everything here is demonstrated in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in on our **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. A quick reassurance before we

start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface often, so a button may sit in a slightly different place by the time you watch. The ideas — save, pin, parameterise, reuse — do not move, and I will always describe what you are looking for as well as where it currently sits.

💬 Core Concepts

What the Prompt Gallery actually is

- The **Prompt Gallery** is Microsoft's ready-made, searchable catalogue of prompts, built into the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and into the Copilot pane inside Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook and Teams.
- You reach it from the **View prompts** button (the small book-and-sparkle icon) just above or beside the Copilot message box, or from the **Prompts** area of the Microsoft 365 Copilot app.
- It holds three kinds of prompt: **Microsoft prompts** (written by Microsoft), **your saved prompts**, and — where a tenant administrator has published them — **organisation prompts** shared across the whole business.
- Because our plan includes **Work IQ** — the part of Copilot that lets chat reach your work files, emails, meetings and chats — the prompts you save can safely refer to real Pashun Sports content and still work next month. Note that this plan has no separate **Work** and **Web** mode buttons; you may see those in older screenshots online, but in our interface Copilot draws on work content and the web without you flipping a switch.

Why a prompt library beats a clever one-off prompt

- A good prompt is an asset, not a message. The Monday sales summary you built in Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results should be run, not rewritten.
- Reuse gives you **consistent output**. Morgan Reyes in Finance and Jamie Jordan in Project Management get the same structure from the same report prompt every week.
- Reuse makes prompts **improvable**. When a prompt produces a weak result you improve the stored version once, and every future run inherits that improvement.

Filtering the Gallery so it's actually usable

Filter	What it does	Practical use at Pashun Sports
App	Restricts to Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, Teams or Copilot chat	Show only Excel prompts before opening the US Sales and Stock Forecast workbook
Job function	Filters by role, e.g. Sales, Finance, Project Management	Morgan Reyes filters to Finance; Jamie Jordan filters to Project Management
Category / task	Catch up, Create, Ask, Edit, Understand	"Catch up" prompts after the Weekly Production Catch-Up
Saved	Shows only prompts you have saved or pinned	Your own Pashun Sports library

The four ways a prompt gets into your library

1. **Save from the Gallery** — find a Microsoft prompt, select the bookmark/save icon, and it appears under your saved prompts.
2. **Save one of your own** — type a prompt into the Copilot box, then choose **Save** (the bookmark icon) before or after sending it.
3. **Pin it** — pinned prompts sit at the top of the prompt list in the relevant app so they are one click away.
4. **Organisation prompts** — an administrator or Copilot champion publishes a prompt across the tenant from the Microsoft 365 admin centre, so everyone at Pashun Sports sees the approved version.

What makes a prompt library-worthy

- It is **repeated** — weekly, monthly, or every time a supplier quote arrives.
- It is **parameterised** — it contains a placeholder you swap out, e.g. `[STATE]`, `[MONTH]`, `[SUPPLIER]`. (Parameterised simply means it has a fill-in-the-blank slot.)
- It **points at a real file, meeting or person** using the `/` file picker, so it keeps working next month.
- It is **written in full RTCA** — Role, Task, Context, Aim — so you are not relying on memory to reconstruct why it worked.

The one big limitation to plan around

- Saved prompts store **text**, not attachments. If a prompt depends on a specific file, name the file in the prompt text — for example *"using Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx"* — and then re-attach it with `/` at run time. That combination gives you the most reliable result, because Copilot no longer has to work out which document you meant.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the real Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and builds a starter library live.

1. Touring the Gallery

- Paul opens the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, selects **View prompts**, and filters by **App: Outlook** and **Job function: Project Management**.
- He runs Microsoft's ready-made *"What's the latest from [person]"* prompt against **Jamie Jordan**, showing how Work IQ pulls the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote email thread and the Weekly Production Catch-Up invite.
- He flags the point covered in Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See — this works because Jamie is a real licensed user in the tenant. A contact typed by hand into Outlook is not a "person" Copilot can reason about, so always build people-based prompts around real accounts.

2. Saving and improving a Microsoft prompt

- Paul saves the Outlook catch-up prompt, then opens it and rewrites it into a Pashun-specific RTCA version:

> *"You are my project coordinator. Summarise everything Jamie Jordan has sent me about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric quote in the last 14 days. Group it as: Agreed / Outstanding / Waiting on Ridgeline Apparel Supply. Aim: I want to walk into the Weekly Production Catch-Up knowing exactly what Jamie needs from me."*

- He saves this as **"PST — Jamie fabric quote catch-up"** and pins it in Outlook.

3. Building the Finance prompt

- Switching to Excel with **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** open, Paul builds and saves the monthly reporting prompt used for Morgan Reyes:

> *"You are a sales analyst. Using the US Forecast and Sales Summary tabs of Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, produce a table of units sold and stock cover by US state for [MONTH]. Highlight any state where stock cover is under 4 weeks. Aim: a one-screen briefing for the Monthly US Sales Review with Morgan Reyes."*

- He demonstrates the placeholder swap: change `[MONTH]` from March to April and re-run — same structure, new numbers.

4. Naming convention and housekeeping

- Paul shows his naming standard: `**PST — [App] — [Task]**`, e.g. *PST — Word — Supplier agreement plain-English summary*, *PST — PPT — Pro Tee pitch rebuild*.
- He removes a prompt he no longer uses and explains the quarterly review habit: anything not run in 90 days either gets improved or gets cleared out.

5. Sharing it with the team

- Paul copies three finished prompts into a Loop component in the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** Team's Production channel so Jamie and Morgan — who are on Business Basic licences — can still copy the text into their own Copilot chat.
- He then shows where an administrator would publish these as **organisation prompts** so they appear in everyone's Gallery automatically.

✅ Summary

- The **Prompt Gallery** is built into the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and every Copilot pane — filter it by app, job function and task rather than scrolling it.
- Saving, pinning and editing Microsoft's prompts is faster than writing from scratch; treat their prompts as starting templates.
- A library-worthy prompt is **repeated, parameterised, pointed at a named file, and written in full RTCA**.
- Saved prompts store text only — always name the source file in the prompt and re-attach it with `/` when you run it.
- Use a naming convention like `**PST — [App] — [Task]**` and review the library quarterly so it stays trustworthy.
- The buttons may move as Microsoft updates the interface — look for the save/bookmark and pin icons rather than a fixed position on screen.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app and select **View prompts** to open the Prompt Gallery.
2. Filter by the app you use most and by your own job function, then run two Microsoft prompts as they are to see what they produce.
3. Save the better of the two, then rewrite it in full **RTCA** form using one of your own real files, meetings or colleagues.
4. Add at least one `[PLACEHOLDER]` to it — a month, a client name, a region — so it can be reused.
5. Save it with a naming convention of your own (prefix, app, task) and **pin** it so it sits at the top of your prompt list.
6. Run it twice with two different placeholder values and confirm you get the same structure with different content.
7. Repeat until you have **five** saved prompts covering your week: a catch-up prompt, a reporting prompt, a drafting prompt, a meeting prompt and a summarising prompt.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library** and use the **Pashun Sports Starter Prompt Library** (25 copy-paste RTCA prompts across Outlook, Word, Excel, PowerPoint and Teams) together with the **Prompt Library Naming & Review Sheet** for your own quarterly housekeeping.

Lecture 16: How to Give Copilot a House Style So Every Output Sounds Like Your Business

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot's default voice is polite, corporate and slightly bland — it does not sound like your business. In this lecture you will build a reusable **house style block** for Pashun Sports T-Shirts so every email, product description, supplier message and slide comes out already sounding like you wrote it.

Everything here is done in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in with our **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. Because Copilot is built by an AI company that ships updates constantly, buttons may sit in slightly different places by the time you watch this — that is normal, and the method in this lecture does not depend on any one button.

💬 Core Concepts

- **House style is Context, not Task.** In the RTCA framework from Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim, house style lives in **Context**. The Task is "write a supplier follow-up email"; the Context is "Pashun Sports writes short, warm, direct British English, no exclamation marks."

- **Copilot starts each new chat fresh.** By default it does not carry your style from one chat to the next. You fix this three ways: paste a style block, point Copilot at a style document, or save a reusable prompt (covered in Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library).
- **Show beats tell.** Two real sample paragraphs of your own writing will shape Copilot's output far more reliably than ten adjectives. "Warm but efficient" is vague; a real Paul-to-Jamie email is not.
- **Pointing Copilot at a file is the strongest method.** Grounding simply means giving Copilot a specific source to work from. A Word document held in SharePoint or OneDrive — referenced with `/` in the prompt — gives Copilot a persistent, shareable, version-controlled style guide the whole team can point at.
- **Our plan uses Work IQ.** On Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot, Copilot Chat can already reach your work files, emails and meetings, so your style guide is available to it once the file is saved and indexed. There are no separate "Work" and "Web" mode buttons to press in this version of the app.
- **Style has hard rules and soft rules.** Hard rules (spelling variant, currency format, words to avoid) must be stated explicitly. Soft rules (tone, warmth, rhythm) are best conveyed by example.

The six elements of a usable house style block

Element	What to specify	Pashun Sports example
Voice	Who the brand sounds like	Founder-led, plain-speaking, never salesy
Reader	Who it is written for	US wholesale buyers and our own small team
Language variant	Spelling and date format	British English internally, US English for US customers
Sentence rules	Length, jargon, formatting	Max 20 words per sentence; keep language plain, avoid "leverage", "synergy", "reach out"
Formatting	Structure defaults	Bullets over paragraphs; bold the ask; sign-off "Best, Paul"
Words to avoid	Habits to leave out	No exclamation marks, no emoji in supplier comms, always name the person rather than "Dear Sir/ Madam"

Three ways to apply it, ranked

Method	How it works	Best for
Inline style block	Paste 6–10 lines of rules into the Context of each prompt	One-off high-stakes documents
Style document Copilot can read	`/Pashun Sports - House Style Guide.docx` referenced in the prompt	Daily use, team consistency
Saved prompt	Style block stored in your own prompt library	Fast repeat tasks like supplier emails

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the live Pashun Consulting tenant at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, on the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch, signed in as Founder & Director.

1. **The "before" baseline.** In Copilot Chat, Paul asks: *"Write an email to Ridgeline Apparel Supply following up on the outstanding fabric quote for the Pashun Pro Tee."* The result is competent and completely generic — "I hope this email finds you well", an exclamation mark, and three sentences of padding before the actual ask.
2. **Extracting the real style.** Paul references the existing Paul-to-Jamie fabric quote email thread and prompts: *"Read my last five sent emails in this thread. Describe my writing style in eight bullet points — sentence length, tone, formatting habits, sign-off, and any words I never use."* Copilot returns an accurate profile: short sentences, no greeting fluff, bolded deadline, sign-off "Best, Paul".
3. **Building the style block.** Paul edits Copilot's analysis into a six-element block matching the table above, adds the words-to-avoid list, and pastes two genuine sample paragraphs underneath as worked examples.
4. **Creating the lasting style document.** The block is saved into a Word file, **Pashun Sports - House Style Guide.docx**, stored alongside *Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx* so Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes can reach it too.
5. **The "after" test.** Paul reruns the exact same Ridgeline follow-up email, this time with `/Pashun Sports - House Style Guide.docx` referenced in the prompt. The output opens with the ask, runs to four sentences, bolds the date Jamie needs the quote by, and signs off correctly.
6. **Proving it travels across apps.** Paul repeats the test in **Word** on the range brief and in **PowerPoint** on *Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx*, referencing the same style document each time. Slide headline copy shifts from "Unlocking Performance Excellence" to "A tee that survives the third wash."
7. **Two variants, one brand.** Paul finishes by adding a second short section to the guide — *US customer-facing voice* — with American spelling and dollar formatting, then shows Copilot switching between the internal and US voices on demand: *"Use the US customer-facing voice from the house style guide."*
8. **Note on finding the file.** Paul flags that if Copilot appears to ignore the style document, it is almost always a question of whether Copilot can see the file yet, not a style problem — the file must be saved, closed, and given a little time to be indexed. Reference it with `/` and pick it from the list rather than only naming it in prose.

✅ Summary

- House style belongs in the **Context** element of RTCA — not the Task.
- Real samples of your own writing teach tone far better than adjectives like "professional" or "friendly".
- A Word style guide that Copilot can read beats a pasted block because it persists, travels across Word, Outlook, PowerPoint and Copilot Chat, and can be shared with the team.
- State hard rules explicitly: language variant, currency, words to avoid, sign-off, formatting defaults.
- Hold more than one voice in the same guide — internal versus US customer-facing — and name the voice you want in the prompt.
- On Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot, Work IQ means Copilot Chat can already reach your saved style guide without switching any mode.

🎯 Your Turn

1. In Copilot Chat at https://m365.cloud.microsoft/, ask: *"Read my last ten sent emails. Describe my writing style in eight bullet points, covering sentence length, tone, formatting, sign-off, and words I never use."*
2. Edit that output into a six-element style block using the table in this handout — Voice, Reader, Language variant, Sentence rules, Formatting, Words to avoid.
3. Paste two genuine paragraphs of your own writing underneath as worked examples.
4. Save it as a Word document in OneDrive or SharePoint, named after your organisation, and close the file so Copilot can index it.
5. Write one real work email twice — once with no style instruction, once referencing your style document with `/`. Compare them side by side.
6. Improve whatever the second version still missed by adding one more rule to the guide, then rerun.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 16: How to Give Copilot a House Style So Every Output Sounds Like Your Business** and use the **House Style Guide Template (Pashun Sports Version)**, the **Style Extraction Prompt Card**, and the **Words and Phrases to Avoid Starter List**.

Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot is confident whether it is right or wrong, and it is your name on the email, contract or forecast it helped produce. In this lecture you will learn a repeatable four-step verification routine — and the specific warning signs that tell you an answer needs checking before it leaves your desk.

Everything here is demonstrated in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, signed in on our **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan. Microsoft updates this interface often, so a button may sit somewhere slightly different by the time you watch — the checking routine itself does not change, and that is the part worth learning.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot does not "know" anything — it retrieves and predicts.** On our plan, Work IQ (Microsoft's work-intelligence layer, which is what lets Copilot Chat reach your own work content) pulls real material from Outlook, SharePoint, OneDrive and Teams. When it cannot find that content, it does not stop; it fills the gap with plausible language. That gap-filling is where wrong answers are born.
- **Three distinct failure types**, and each needs a different fix:

Failure type	What it looks like	Why it happens	Your fix
Hallucination	A confident fact, figure or quote that does not exist anywhere in your files	No grounding source found; the model predicted instead	Re-prompt with an explicit file reference using `/`
Wrong source	A real number — from the wrong document or an outdated version	Multiple similar files; Copilot picked the nearest match	Name the exact file and tab/section in the prompt
Bad inference	Real data, wrong conclusion (for example, adding up a margin column that actually contains percentages)	Copilot misread structure or intent	Ask it to show its working, then correct the assumption

- **The five red flags.** Treat any of these as an automatic "verify before you send" trigger:
- - A **specific number** you did not supply (revenue, unit cost, headcount, dates)
- - A **named person, company or supplier** you did not mention
- - A **quotation** presented as someone's exact words
- - A **legal, contractual or financial claim** (payment terms, liability, tax)
- - **No citations shown** when you asked a question about your own files
- **Citations are your fastest tool.** In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, answers built from your own content show numbered reference chips. Click one — it opens the actual source document at the actual passage. No chip means no source. An answer about your own business with zero citations is an answer you have not yet verified.
- **Citations prove retrieval, not correctness.** Copilot can cite a real file and still summarise it wrongly. Open the source and read the line, rather than simply trusting the chip.
- **"I don't know" is a valid output — ask for it.** Adding *"If the answer is not in the files I've referenced, say so explicitly rather than estimating"* to a prompt measurably reduces invention.
- **Indexing delays are real, and they are not hallucinations.** New files, new mailboxes and newly created people take time to become searchable. A recently added colleague may not appear to Copilot as a "person" straight away, and file-content grounding can lag behind mail and calendar grounding. If Copilot says it cannot find something you know exists, allow for indexing time before you conclude the model is wrong.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through three deliberately broken answers in the Microsoft 365 Copilot app on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts content.

1. **Forcing a hallucination.** Paul asks Copilot Chat: *"What unit price did Ridgeline Apparel Supply quote for the Pashun Pro Tee performance blend, and what are their payment terms?"* The quoted price exists in the Paul/Jamie Jordan fabric quote email thread — the payment terms do not exist anywhere. Copilot returns both, fluently. Paul points out that the price carries a citation chip and the payment terms do not. That difference is the tell.
2. **The re-prompt that fixes it.** Paul re-runs it as: *"Using only the email thread between me and Jamie Jordan about the Ridgeline fabric quote, list the unit price and payment terms. If payment terms are not stated in that thread, reply 'not stated' — do not estimate."* Copilot now returns the price with a citation and "not stated" for the terms. Same question, honest answer.
3. **Catching the wrong source.** Paul asks for total forecast US units for the Pro Tee launch. Copilot answers from **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx**, but Paul clicks the citation

and shows it pulled from the **Sales Summary** tab when the intended figure lives on **US Forecast**. He corrects it by naming the tab explicitly — and shows the two numbers side by side so students see how easily a plausible-but-wrong figure reaches a board pack.

4. **Catching bad inference.** Paul asks Copilot to summarise margin performance from the same workbook and then adds the key follow-up: *"Show me the exact cells and rows you used to reach that figure."* Copilot lists its working, revealing it treated a percentage column as currency. Paul corrects the assumption in the prompt rather than editing the output — so the fix survives the next re-run.
5. **The four-step routine**, applied to the final draft of a supplier email to Ridgeline Apparel Supply: **Scan** for the five red flags → **Click** every citation → **Cross-check** one hard number against the original file → **Ask** Copilot "what in this answer is not supported by my files?" before sending.

✅ Summary

- Copilot fills gaps rather than flagging them — invented detail appears exactly where your own data runs out.
- Missing citations on a question about your own business content are the single strongest warning sign.
- Citations prove a source was retrieved, not that it was read correctly — always open the source for numbers that matter.
- Instruct Copilot to say "not stated" rather than estimate; it dramatically reduces invention.
- Allow for indexing delays before you conclude Copilot has given you a genuinely wrong answer.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Sign in at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and ask Copilot Chat a question about your own work that deliberately mixes something real with something that does not exist — for example a real project's budget plus a "risk register" you have never created.
2. Count the citation chips in the answer. Note which claims have one and which do not.
3. Click every chip and confirm the cited passage actually says what Copilot claims.
4. Re-run the same question with this added: *"Use only the files I have referenced. If any part of the answer is not supported by them, say 'not stated' rather than estimating."*
5. Compare the two answers and save the second prompt wording into the reusable prompt library you started in **Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library**.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice** and use the **Copilot Fact-Check Checklist (Five Red Flags + Four-Step Routine)** and the **Anti-Hallucination Prompt Snippets** file.

Lecture 18: How to Summarise a Long Email Thread and Know What Actually Needs a Reply

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn how to take a long, messy Outlook email thread and turn it into a short, accurate summary that tells you what was decided, what is still open, and whether you actually need to reply at all. We will do it on a real 14-message supplier thread inside the Pashun Sports T-Shirts mailbox, not a toy example.

Everything here is shown on a **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan, using Outlook on the web and the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. One friendly reminder before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface often, so a button may sit in a slightly different place by the time you watch. The prompts and the thinking in this lecture stay exactly the same — look for the Copilot icon and you will find your way.

💬 Core Concepts

- **The "Summarise" button is not the same as a prompt.** Outlook shows a **Summarize** option at the top of a thread. It gives you a fast, generic recap with clickable references back to individual messages. It is excellent for orientation, weak for decision-making. A typed prompt in the Copilot pane gives you control over *what kind* of summary you get.
- **A thread summary answers four questions.** Good summaries of business email always cover: what was agreed, what changed, what is unresolved, and who owes whom something. If your summary does not tell you those four things, your prompt was too vague.
- **Grounding is limited to the thread you have open.** "Grounding" simply means the material Copilot is allowed to read when it answers. When you summarise from inside a message, Copilot reads that one conversation. It does not automatically pull in the attached fabric spec, the Planner task, or a separate thread with the same supplier unless you ask it to in Copilot Chat instead.
- **Citations are your fact-check.** Every claim in an Outlook summary carries a small numbered reference to the message it came from. Click it. If a line has no reference, treat it as Copilot's inference rather than fact — this links directly to Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice.
- **"Needs a reply" is a judgement, and you can ask for it.** Copilot will happily sort a thread against a rule you supply: does this contain a direct question to me, a deadline, or a commitment I made?
- **In Copilot Chat, your work content is reached through Work IQ.** On our plan there are no separate "Work" and "Web" buttons to toggle — older versions of the interface had those, ours does not. With Work IQ switched on, Copilot Chat can already reach the mail, files and meetings you personally have access to, so you can simply ask your question. We cover this in more detail in Lecture 9: How to Use Copilot Chat to Get Instant Answers From the Web and Your Own Files.

Tool	Best for	Limitation
Summarize button (top of thread)	30-second orientation on a thread you have never read	Generic; no action extraction; no prioritisation

Typed prompt in the Copilot pane (in the open message)	Decisions, open items, owner and deadline extraction	Only sees the open conversation
Copilot Chat at m365.cloud.microsoft	Cross-thread questions: "everything from Ridgeline this month"	Needs a clear, specific question; very recent mail can take a little time to appear
Coaching by Copilot (tone review)	Reviewing the tone of a reply *you* have drafted	Reviews your draft only, not the inbound thread

- **A useful distinction: summarise versus triage.** Summarising tells you what happened. Triage — deciding what deserves your attention first — tells you what to do next. Ask for both, explicitly, in the same prompt.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens the Pashun Sports T-Shirts mailbox and finds the fabric quote thread between **Paul Ashun (Founder & Director)** and **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)**, which now runs to 14 messages and brings in **Ridgeline Apparel Supply** on the performance-blend fabric for the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch.

1. **The fast pass.** Paul clicks **Summarize** at the top of the thread. Copilot returns a bulleted recap with references. Paul reads it aloud and points out what it gets right (the quote revisions, the minimum order quantity change) and what it leaves out (nobody has yet confirmed the revised delivery date).
2. **The controlled pass.** Paul opens the **Copilot** pane inside the message and types a structured prompt using the RTCA framework from Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim:

"You are my executive assistant. Summarise this thread in four headed sections: (1) Decisions made, (2) What changed since the first message, (3) Open questions with no answer yet, (4) Actions with owner and due date. Context: this is the Ridgeline fabric quote for the Pashun Pro Tee US launch. Aim: I need to know in 60 seconds whether anything is waiting on me. Keep it under 200 words and cite each point."

1. **The triage question.** Paul then asks in the same pane: *"Does this thread contain a direct question to me that is still unanswered? If yes, quote it and tell me who asked it. If no, say 'no reply needed'."* Copilot surfaces Jamie's unanswered question about whether to approve the higher-grade blend at the revised unit cost.
2. **Verification.** Paul clicks two references, lands on the source messages, and confirms the minimum order quantity figure. He also shows one point Copilot slightly overstated and corrects it with a follow-up: *"Message 9 says the date was proposed, not agreed. Rewrite point 2."*
3. **The cross-thread move.** Paul switches to **Copilot Chat** at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and asks: *"Summarise all email from Ridgeline Apparel Supply and from Jamie Jordan about fabric in the last 30 days, and list anything still awaiting my decision."* Because Work IQ is on, Copilot reaches his mail without any mode switching. He notes the practical point: very recent messages can take a short while to become searchable, so if something obvious is missing, open the thread directly rather than assuming Copilot has the facts wrong.
4. **The output.** Paul pastes the final four-section summary into the **Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch Checklist** OneNote page so the decision trail lives outside the inbox.

✅ Summary

- The **Summarize** button orients you; a **typed prompt** gives you decisions, open questions and owners — use the button to skim, the prompt to act.
- Always ask for a structure: decisions, changes, open questions, actions with owner and date.
- Ask the triage question separately — *"is there an unanswered direct question to me?"* — because a summary alone will not tell you whether to reply.
- Click the references. Uncited lines are Copilot's inference and are worth verifying before you act on them.
- In-thread Copilot sees one conversation; use **Copilot Chat** at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** for anything that spans multiple threads or people, and allow a little time for very recent mail to appear.
- The interface will keep evolving — the four-question structure and the triage prompt will keep working regardless of where the buttons move.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Find the longest unread or half-read thread in your own inbox — ideally one with at least eight messages and more than two participants.
2. Click **Summarize** and read the result. Note one thing it missed.
3. Open the Copilot pane and run the four-section prompt: decisions, changes, open questions, actions with owner and due date, under 200 words, cited.
4. Ask the triage follow-up: *"Is there a direct question to me in this thread that has not been answered? Quote it, or reply 'no reply needed'."*
5. Click at least two references and verify them against the source messages.
6. Save the prompt that worked into your reusable prompt library from Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 18: How to Summarise a Long Email Thread and Know What Actually Needs a Reply** and use the **Thread Summary & Triage Prompt Card**, together with the **Ridgeline Fabric Quote Thread (sample transcript)** if you would like to practise on the Pashun Sports example before using your own inbox.

Lecture 19: How to Draft Customer and Supplier Emails in Seconds From a Single Sentence

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn how to turn a single sentence of intent — "follow up with Ridgeline for the revised fabric quote" — into a complete, on-tone, ready-to-send email using Copilot's **Draft with Copilot** pane in Outlook. By the end you will be able to produce customer replies and supplier emails in seconds, and control tone, length and content without rewriting from scratch.

Everything here is demonstrated on the **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan we set up earlier in the course, working in **Outlook on the web** — reached from the app launcher at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. The new Outlook for Windows app behaves the same way.

A quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to this interface often, so a button may sit a little differently or carry a slightly different label by the time you watch this. The steps and the thinking stay the same — look for the wording, not the exact pixel.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Draft with Copilot** is the pane that appears in the compose window when you click **New mail** in Outlook. You give it an instruction in plain English, and it writes a full draft into the body of the message.
- **One sentence is enough — but three things make it better.** Copilot will draft from any instruction, but quality jumps when your sentence contains **who it's to**, **what you want to happen**, and **one hard fact** (a date, a price, an order number).
- **Tone and length controls** sit under **Generate options** in the draft pane. Tone choices include Direct, Neutral, Formal, Casual and Professional (labels vary slightly between builds). Length choices are Short, Medium and Long. Change these and click **Regenerate** — you do not need to retype your instruction.
- **Grounding with `/`** — "grounding" simply means pointing Copilot at your real business content instead of letting it invent something. Type a forward slash inside your instruction to reference a file or a colleague in your tenant (for example `/Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`). One practical catch: people only resolve if they are real users in your organisation's directory. A contact you typed by hand into Outlook will not be found.
- **Draft versus Reply.** Drafting from scratch uses only your instruction. Drafting a *reply* quietly uses the conversation above it as well, which is why replies usually need a much shorter prompt. That is covered fully in **Lecture 20: How to Reply to Any Email With Copilot Without Sounding Like a Robot**.
- **Copilot never sends.** Every output lands in your compose window as an editable draft. You remain the author and the approver.

What you type	What Copilot gives back	When to use it
"Follow up on the quote."	Generic, vague, no specifics	Almost never
"Follow up with Ridgeline Apparel Supply for the revised performance-blend quote we asked for on the 14th."	Named, dated, actionable	Most supplier follow-ups
"Apologise to a customer whose Pashun Pro Tee arrived in the wrong size, offer a free exchange with a prepaid return."	Full service email with a clear remedy	Customer service replies
"Ask Ridgeline to confirm the per-unit price at 2,000 units, referencing /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx"	Draft with real figures from the brief	Anything involving your own data

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works live in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant as **Paul Ashun, Founder & Director**, on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**.

1. **The supplier follow-up.** Paul opens **New mail**, addresses it to the contact at **Ridgeline Apparel Supply** (our fabric supplier in Georgia, USA), clicks **Draft with Copilot** and types one sentence: *"Follow up with Ridgeline for the revised performance-blend fabric quote at 2,000 units — we'd like it before the Monthly US Sales Review."* Copilot returns a full, polite, specific email in roughly five seconds.
2. **Tone tuning.** The first draft reads a little soft. Paul opens **Generate options**, switches tone to **Direct** and length to **Short**, and clicks **Regenerate**. The email tightens from four paragraphs to two and keeps the deadline.
3. **Grounding in a real file.** Paul regenerates with the instruction extended: *"...and confirm the colourway list matches /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx."* Copilot pulls the actual colourways from the Range Brief into the email body instead of guessing.
4. **The customer email.** Paul drafts a reply to a customer who received the wrong size Pashun Pro Tee: *"Apologise, confirm we'll ship the correct size today, include prepaid return label instructions, warm and reassuring."* Copilot produces a service-standard email; Paul edits one line and sends.
5. **The fact-check.** Paul deliberately shows a draft where Copilot has invented a delivery lead time that appears nowhere in the Range Brief — and removes it. The rule: **Copilot writes the email, you own the facts.**
6. **Internal note.** Paul drafts a short update to **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** from the single sentence *"Let Jamie know the Ridgeline quote is running late and ask her to hold the Planner task for the US launch."* Because Jamie is a real user in the tenant, the `/` reference to her resolves properly and Copilot addresses her by name.

✅ Summary

- **Draft with Copilot** turns one plain-English sentence into a complete, sendable email in seconds.
- The best prompts contain **recipient, desired outcome and one hard fact** — a date, quantity, price or order number.
- Use **Generate options** to change tone and length, then **Regenerate**, rather than retyping your instruction.
- Use `/` to ground a draft in real files and real colleagues in your organisation, so figures and names come from your business rather than from the model's imagination.
- Copilot drafts; it never sends. **Every fact in the email is your responsibility before you click Send.**
- Button positions and labels may shift as Microsoft updates Outlook — the approach in this lecture stays valid.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open **Outlook** from the app launcher at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**, click **New mail**, then **Draft with Copilot**.
2. Type one sentence describing a real email you have been meaning to write — include the recipient, the outcome you want, and one hard fact (a date, amount or reference).
3. Read the draft, then open **Generate options**, change the tone, and click **Regenerate**. Compare the two versions.
4. Re-run the prompt with a `/` reference to one of your own documents and notice how much more specific the draft becomes.

5. Check every number, date and name in the final draft against the source before you send it.
6. Save your best instruction wording into your personal prompt library from **Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library**.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 19: How to Draft Customer and Supplier Emails in Seconds From a Single Sentence** and use the **Pashun Sports Email Draft Prompt Sheet** — twelve ready-to-paste one-sentence prompts covering supplier follow-ups, price conversations, customer complaints, refunds and internal updates.

Lecture 20: How to Use Coaching by Copilot to Get the Tone Right on a Difficult Message

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Coaching by Copilot is the one Outlook feature that reviews a draft **you** wrote and tells you how it will land before you send it. In this lecture you will use it on a genuinely difficult message — a firm email to our fabric supplier about a late Pashun Pro Tee sample run — and learn how to act on its feedback without losing your own voice.

A quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to Copilot constantly, so a button may sit in a slightly different place by the time you watch this — sometimes under a **Copilot** icon in the ribbon, sometimes behind the Copilot side pane. The feature and the workflow are the same. Look for the word *Coaching* and you will find it.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Coaching by Copilot is not "Draft with Copilot".** Drafting writes the email for you. Coaching reads what you have already typed and gives feedback on it. You keep authorship; Copilot acts as an editor over your shoulder.
- **Where it lives:** open a new message or a reply, type your draft, then open **Copilot** from the message ribbon and choose **Coaching by Copilot**. Feedback appears in a side pane — nothing is changed in your draft unless you choose to change it.
- **Which Outlook:** we are working on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, using the new Outlook for Windows and Outlook on the web. Coaching is available in both. Classic Outlook may not show it.
- **What it assesses:** Copilot reviews your draft across three lenses and gives specific, quotable suggestions for each.

Lens	What Copilot is checking	Typical feedback you'll see
Tone	Is it too blunt, too apologetic, too casual for the recipient?	"The opening line may read as accusatory — consider stating the impact before the fault."

Reader sentiment	How the recipient is likely to feel on reading it	"The reader may feel blamed. Acknowledge the pressure they are under."
Clarity	Is the ask obvious? Is there one action or five?	"The request for a revised delivery date is buried in paragraph three."

- **Coaching works best on messages with consequences** — escalations, complaint responses, following up with a supplier, pushing back on a colleague, sharing news about a slipped deadline.
- **You are not obliged to take the advice.** A deliberately firm email to a supplier who has missed two dates is allowed to read as firm. Coaching tells you *how firm it reads* — you decide if that matches your intent.
- **Coaching does not check facts.** It has no idea whether the delivery date you quoted is correct. Accuracy is still your job — see **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice**.
- **Improve in passes, don't rewrite.** Apply one suggestion, re-run Coaching, and watch the feedback change. Two passes is usually enough; more than three and you will sand the personality off the message.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the real Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant, signed in as **Paul Ashun (Founder & Director)** on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**.

1. **Set the scene.** Paul opens the fabric quote thread with **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** and the escalation from **Ridgeline Apparel Supply**, our performance-blend fabric supplier. The Pashun Pro Tee sample run is now two weeks late and the US launch date is fixed.
2. **Write a weak draft deliberately.** Paul types a short, irritated reply to Ridgeline: *"This is the second time. We were promised samples on the 14th and heard nothing. This is not acceptable and it is putting our launch at risk. I need an answer today."* No greeting, no specific ask, no date.
3. **Run Coaching by Copilot.** Open **Copilot** in the message ribbon, then choose **Coaching by Copilot**. The pane returns feedback across Tone, Reader Sentiment and Clarity — typically flagging the opening as confrontational, noting the reader is likely to feel attacked rather than mobilised, and pointing out that "I need an answer today" does not say *an answer to what*.
4. **Apply the clarity fix first.** Paul rewrites the close to a single, dated, unambiguous ask: *"Please confirm by 5pm ET today either (a) a firm despatch date for the Pro Tee sample run, or (b) that we should route this order to an alternate mill."*
5. **Apply the tone fix — partially.** Paul softens the opening to state impact before fault, but deliberately **keeps** the firmness, because this is a second miss and the message is meant to carry weight. He shows students how to set a suggestion aside on purpose.
6. **Re-run Coaching.** The second pass now reports improved clarity and a professional-but-direct tone. Paul reads both drafts side by side so students can hear the difference.
7. **Contrast with an internal message.** Paul writes a short note to **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)** letting her know the delay may move the revenue recognition date, runs Coaching, and shows how feedback shifts for an internal colleague versus an external supplier — same tool, different bar.

Watch for: Coaching evaluates the draft in the compose window only. If you want Copilot to also use the history of the Ridgeline thread, summarise the thread first (covered in **Lecture 18: How to Summarise a Long Email Thread and Extract Every Action Item**), then draft, then coach.

✅ Summary

- **Coaching by Copilot reviews your own writing** — it does not replace it, so your voice and your judgement stay intact.
- It gives feedback on **tone, likely reader sentiment and clarity**, with specific line-level suggestions you can accept or set aside.
- Use it on **consequential messages**: supplier escalations, complaints, difficult news, pushback — not on routine one-liners.
- **Fix clarity first, tone second.** An unclear message fails even when it is beautifully polite.
- Copilot checks how your message *reads*, never whether it is *true* — facts, dates and figures remain your responsibility.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Outlook and start a new message to yourself (or to a colleague's address you will not send to).
2. Write a genuinely difficult real-work email in under 120 words — following up on a late supplier, declining a request, or flagging a slipped deadline. Write it quickly and honestly, without editing.
3. Open **Copilot** in the message ribbon and choose **Coaching by Copilot**, then read all three feedback categories.
4. Apply **only the clarity suggestions** and re-run Coaching. Note what changed in the tone and sentiment feedback.
5. Now apply one tone suggestion and deliberately set another aside. Write one sentence in your notes explaining *why* you set it aside — that reasoning is the skill this lecture is really teaching.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the numbered folder for **Lecture 20: How to Use Coaching by Copilot to Get the Tone Right on a Difficult Message** and use the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply — Late Sample Run Escalation (Before & After Drafts)** file, together with the **Difficult Message Coaching Checklist** one-pager.

Lecture 21: How to Handle a Complaint Email — Apology, Resolution and Follow-Up in One Pass

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

A complaint email is the highest-risk message in your inbox: get the tone wrong and you risk the relationship, get the facts wrong and you risk your credibility. In this lecture you will use Copilot in Outlook to read an unhappy customer email, pull the real order facts from your own files, and produce a reply that apologises, resolves and schedules the follow-up — in a single pass.

We are working in Outlook on the web, signed in with the same **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** account we use throughout this course — the same sign-in that opens the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. One quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to these panes often, so a button may sit in a slightly different place or carry a slightly different label by the time you watch this. The workflow below does not change — look for the wording, not the pixel position.

💬 Core Concepts

- **A complaint reply has three jobs, not one.** Acknowledge the specific problem, state a concrete remedy with a date, and commit to a follow-up action. Most AI drafts nail job one and skip jobs two and three, because the prompt only asked for "a polite reply".
- **Tone is a setting, not a wish.** The **Draft with Copilot** pane in Outlook gives you tone options (Direct, Casual, Formal, Neutral) and length (Short, Medium, Long). For complaints, **Formal + Medium** is the safe default. Keep "Casual" for friendlier messages.
- **Ground the apology in facts.** Our plan includes **Work IQ** — the setting that lets Copilot reach your work files, mail and calendar. With it switched on, Copilot can pull real data (order lines, delivery dates, stock positions) from your own documents instead of inventing them. An apology containing an invented delivery date is worse than no apology.
- **Only promise what you can deliver.** Copilot will happily write "we will ship a replacement tomorrow" if you leave the remedy vague. You decide the remedy; Copilot writes it well.
- **Summarise before you draft.** On a long or emotional complaint, run **Summary by Copilot** at the top of the message first. It sets the emotion aside and leaves you the factual claims — which are the things you actually have to answer.

Task in the complaint reply	What you tell Copilot	What you keep for yourself
Understand the complaint	"Summarise the customer's specific complaints as a numbered list"	Judging whether the complaint is fair
Apologise	"Open with a direct apology for the late delivery, no excuses"	The decision to accept fault
Resolve	"State that we will ship a replacement in Navy, size L, free of charge, arriving by Friday"	Choosing the remedy and its cost
Follow up	"Close by saying I will personally email on Monday to confirm it arrived"	Actually doing the follow-up
Tone	Formal, Medium, "warm but not grovelling"	Reading it before you hit Send

- **The one-pass principle.** Rather than draft, then edit, then re-draft, load everything the reply needs into a single RTCA-shaped prompt (Role, Task, Context, Aim — see Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim). One rich prompt beats four thin ones.
- **Coaching by Copilot** is your pre-send safety check. It rates tone, clarity and reader sentiment and will flag a sentence that reads as defensive or dismissive before your customer ever sees it.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works a live Pashun Sports T-Shirts complaint end to end, in Outlook on the web.

1. **The scenario.** A US wholesale customer has emailed Paul Ashun (Founder & Director) about the first **Pashun Pro Tee** shipment: three cartons arrived nine days late, and the Navy size L cartons were short by 24 units. The email is long, frustrated, and mixes facts with opinion.
2. **Summarise first.** Paul opens the message and chooses **Summary by Copilot** at the top. Copilot returns the factual spine: late delivery, 24 units short, Navy L, request for a credit note. The claims are now clearly visible.
3. **Check the facts before apologising.** In the Copilot pane alongside the message, Paul asks: *"Using Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, how many units of Pashun Pro Tee Navy size L are currently in stock for the US?"* This is the difference between a confident remedy and a guess. If Copilot says it cannot find the file, give it a moment — newly saved files take a little time to become searchable, as covered in Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results.
4. **Draft in one pass.** In the reply window, Paul opens **Draft with Copilot** and types a full RTCA prompt:

- *"You are the founder of Pashun Sports T-Shirts replying to a wholesale customer whose first Pashun Pro Tee order arrived nine days late and 24 units short in Navy size L. Write a reply that: apologises directly for both problems without making excuses; confirms we are shipping the 24 missing Navy L units free of charge for delivery by Friday; confirms a 10% credit note on the original invoice, which Morgan Reyes in Finance will issue this week; and closes by saying I will email personally on Monday to confirm everything has landed. Do not invent order numbers or dates. Formal tone, medium length."*

1. **Tune, don't rewrite.** Paul uses the tone and length controls to nudge the draft, then chooses **Regenerate** once. He deletes one over-apologetic sentence by hand — the human edit that stops it sounding like a form letter.
2. **Run the safety check. Coaching by Copilot** notes that the opening is strong but the middle reads a little passively. Paul accepts the suggested rewrite of one sentence and sends.
3. **Close the loop.** Paul then asks Copilot to *"draft a short internal message to Morgan Reyes asking her to raise a 10% credit note against this customer's first Pashun Pro Tee invoice this week"* — because the promise made in the reply now has to exist somewhere other than the reply.

✅ Summary

- Summarise a complaint before you draft it — it separates the facts you must answer from the emotion you should not mirror.
- Ground the remedy in real data (the **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** workbook) so you only promise stock you actually have.
- A complete complaint reply does three things: apologise, resolve with a date, and commit to a named follow-up.
- One rich RTCA prompt produces a better first draft than four vague follow-ups.
- Use **Coaching by Copilot** as a pre-send check, then always make at least one human edit before sending.
- Expect the Outlook Copilot buttons to move or be renamed over time — the three-job structure of a good reply stays exactly the same.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Find a genuine complaint or pushback email in your own inbox — or send yourself a test complaint about a late order.
2. Run **Summary by Copilot** on it and write down the factual claims it identifies.
3. Decide your remedy yourself, in one sentence, before you open the draft pane.
4. Open **Draft with Copilot** and write a single RTCA prompt that includes the apology, the specific remedy with a date, the named person responsible, and the follow-up commitment. Set tone to Formal, length Medium.
5. Run **Coaching by Copilot** on the result, accept or reject its suggestions, and make one edit of your own before you send.
6. Note how long the whole pass took compared with your usual complaint-handling time.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 21: How to Handle a Complaint Email — Apology, Resolution and Follow-Up in One Pass** and use the **Complaint Response Prompt Template (Apologise–Resolve–Follow Up)** together with the **Pashun Pro Tee Customer Complaint Email** sample so you can practise the full one-pass workflow on a realistic message.

Lecture 22: How to Triage a Full Inbox With Copilot Priority and Daily Catch-Up Summaries

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn how to walk into a very full inbox and be caught up in under five minutes, using Copilot's **Priority** ranking and the **Summary** and catch-up features inside Outlook. We will do it on the real Pashun Sports T-Shirts inbox on the Pashun Consulting tenant, running on our **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** plan, where Paul is handling a fabric supplier thread with Ridgeline Apparel Supply, sales queries from Morgan Reyes, and production follow-ups from Jamie Jordan.

One quick reassurance before we start: Microsoft ships changes to Copilot constantly, so a button may sit in a slightly different place or carry a slightly different label by the time you watch this. The *actions* stay the same — rank, summarise, ask across the mailbox — so follow the intent rather than the pixel position and you will always find it.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Triage is not reading.** Triage is deciding, for every message, one of four things: reply now, hand it to someone, schedule it for later, or let it go. Copilot's job is to get you to that decision without opening each email.
- **Priority** is Copilot's ranking engine inside Outlook. It looks at the messages in your inbox, scores them for urgency and relevance to you, and returns a ranked shortlist with a one-line reason for each — for example "Awaiting your approval on the Ridgeline fabric quote".

- **Summary on a thread** collapses a long conversation into bullet points with clickable references back to the original messages. On the 14-message Ridgeline supplier thread, this is the difference between eight minutes of scrolling and twenty seconds of reading.
- **Copilot Chat in Outlook** answers questions across your whole mailbox — "What has Morgan Reyes asked me for this week that I haven't answered?" — rather than working one message at a time.
- **Work IQ is what makes this possible.** Work IQ is simply Microsoft's name for the layer that lets Copilot Chat reach your work content — your mail, calendar and files — while respecting your existing permissions. On our plan it is on by default, which is why you will not see the older "Work" and "Web" toggle buttons that appear in some older screenshots and videos. Ours is one experience with work access built in.
- **Priority is personal, not universal.** Copilot works out what matters from who you email most, what you reply to fastest, and what you have flagged. Expect it to be slightly off for the first few days and to sharpen quickly.
- **Grounding depends on real accounts.** "Grounding" just means Copilot answering from your real content rather than general knowledge. Copilot recognises Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes as people because they are licensed users in the tenant. A name you typed manually into your own contacts list is not treated the same way — that is a very common cause of "Copilot can't find that person" results.

Task	Where you do it	Best prompt style
Rank the whole inbox	Copilot in Outlook	"Prioritise my inbox and tell me why each one matters"
Catch up on one long thread	Summary at the top of the thread	Click, then ask a follow-up question
Cross-inbox question	Copilot Chat in Outlook	"Summarise everything about the Pashun Pro Tee launch from the last 7 days"
Find unanswered asks	Copilot Chat in Outlook	"Which emails from this week are still waiting on a reply from me?"
Catch up after time off	Copilot Chat in Outlook	"Give me a catch-up on everything I missed between Monday and Friday"

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens the Pashun Sports T-Shirts inbox with a healthy pile of unread messages, including the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote thread with Jamie Jordan and a customer message about a Pashun Pro Tee order.

1. Paul opens **Copilot** in Outlook and asks it to prioritise the inbox. Copilot returns a ranked list — the Ridgeline quote expiry at the top, Morgan Reyes' invoice query second, a marketing newsletter far down the list — each with a plain-English reason.
2. Paul opens the Ridgeline thread and clicks **Summary** at the top of the conversation. Copilot produces a short set of bullets: quoted price per unit, the minimum order quantity Ridgeline is holding to, the two open questions Jamie Jordan raised, and the date the quote lapses. Paul clicks one of the numbered references to jump straight to the original message and confirm the price for himself.

3. Paul runs a daily catch-up in Copilot Chat in Outlook: *"Summarise all emails from the last 3 days about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch. List decisions made, open questions, and anything waiting on me."* Copilot pulls the supplier thread, Morgan's sales note and the customer message into one short briefing.
4. Paul demonstrates the time-away scenario: *"I've been away since last Monday. Catch me up on anything involving Jamie Jordan or Morgan Reyes, most urgent first."*
5. Paul shows a correction in action. Copilot ranks a low-value message near the top. He explains why — a recent reply to that sender taught Copilot the sender mattered — and then demonstrates adding a time window and a topic to the prompt to get a cleaner, tighter result.

A note on what you will see: Priority ranking and mailbox-wide chat roll out at different speeds across tenants, and Copilot's understanding of people and its access to mail and calendar can come online on separate timelines. If a feature is not there yet on your account, keep using the thread **Summary** and Copilot Chat prompts in the meantime — they deliver most of the value on their own.

✅ Summary

- **Priority** ranks messages and explains its reasoning — read the reasons, not just the order.
- **Summary** on a thread turns a 14-message supplier chain into a handful of checkable bullets in seconds.
- **Copilot Chat in Outlook** answers across the whole mailbox, which is how you build a daily or post-holiday catch-up.
- Always add a **time window** and a **topic** to catch-up prompts — open-ended prompts produce vague summaries.
- **Work IQ** is what gives Copilot Chat access to your work mail and files on our plan, which is why there is no separate work/web switch to worry about.
- Copilot's sense of priority is learned from your behaviour, so expect it to improve over the first week.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Outlook, open Copilot and ask it to prioritise your inbox. Read the reason given for the top three results and note whether you agree.
2. Find the longest email thread in your inbox and click **Summary**. Click at least one reference to confirm a fact in the original message.
3. In Copilot Chat in Outlook, run: *"Summarise all emails from the last 3 days about [your live project]. List decisions made, open questions, and anything waiting on a reply from me."*
4. Re-run the same prompt with a 7-day window and compare which version gives you a more useful briefing.
5. Save your best-performing version into your personal prompt library from Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the numbered folder for **Lecture 22: How to Triage a Full Inbox With Copilot Priority and Daily Catch-Up Summaries** and use the **Inbox Triage Prompt Card** and the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply Thread Summary Example** to compare your output against Paul's.

Lecture 23: How to Prepare for Any Meeting in Under a Minute With Meeting Preparation Summaries

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Walking into a meeting cold is the most avoidable time-waster in professional life. In this lecture you will learn how to use Copilot in Outlook to generate a full meeting preparation summary — attendees, history, open threads, documents and unanswered questions — in under sixty seconds, using the Pashun Sports **Weekly Production Catch-Up** and **Monthly US Sales Review** as our live examples.

Everything here is demonstrated on the real Pashun Consulting tenant using **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, working from Outlook and from the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/**. Because this plan includes **Work IQ** — the work intelligence layer that lets Copilot reach your mail, calendar, chats and files — meeting preparation works on your real business content rather than on the open web alone.

💬 Core Concepts

- **What a meeting preparation summary actually is.** Copilot reads the calendar invite (subject, body, attendees, attachments) and then reaches sideways into your mailbox, chats and files to pull everything related. It gives you a briefing, not a reminder.
- **Where it lives.** Open a meeting in your Outlook calendar and look for the **Copilot** button in the meeting window or reading pane, then choose the prepare/summary option. You can also start from the Microsoft 365 Copilot app at **https://m365.cloud.microsoft/** and simply ask Copilot Chat to prepare you for a named meeting.
- **The interface moves, and that is fine.** Microsoft ships Copilot updates constantly, so a button may be renamed or moved between the recording and the day you watch it. The capability stays the same: open the meeting, ask Copilot to prepare you. If you cannot find the button, type the request into Copilot Chat instead and you will get the same briefing.
- **Work IQ is what makes this possible.** On **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**, Work IQ is what gives Copilot Chat permission to look at your own emails, meetings and files. You will not see separate "work" and "web" mode buttons in this plan — older versions of the interface had them, but here work access is simply part of how Copilot Chat behaves when you are signed in with your work account.
- **What Copilot can pull in:**

Source	What it gives you
Meeting invite	Agenda, purpose, location, attachments
Your mailbox	Recent email threads with the attendees on this topic
Teams chat	1:1 and channel messages referencing the meeting subject
Files in OneDrive/SharePoint	Documents shared with or by the attendees

Previous meeting recap	Notes, decisions and actions from the last occurrence of a recurring meeting

- **Attendee intelligence.** Copilot can tell you who each attendee is (job title, department) and what you have recently exchanged with them — but only for **real licensed users in your organisation's directory**. A contact you typed manually into Outlook is not a "person" Copilot can profile. This is why Pashun Sports uses real accounts for Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance).
- **Recurring meetings are the goldmine.** For a series like the Weekly Production Catch-Up, Copilot can chain the previous recap to the current agenda: "here's what you agreed last time, here's what has happened since."
- **Allow a little time for indexing.** People profiles, mail and files all become searchable to Copilot on their own timelines. A document shared ten minutes ago may not appear in the prep summary yet. If it matters, name the file directly in your prompt and Copilot will go and open it.
- **Prep is a read, not a commitment.** Nothing is sent, nothing is saved, and attendees cannot see that you ran it.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates using the real Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot**.

1. **The cold open.** Paul opens the Outlook calendar and finds the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** with Jamie Jordan. He shows the invite as-is: a subject line, a Teams link, and nothing else. This is the state most professionals arrive in.
2. **One click to prepare.** Paul opens the meeting and asks Copilot to prepare him for it. Copilot returns a briefing covering: the Pashun Pro Tee production status, the open fabric quote thread between Paul and Jamie regarding Ridgeline Apparel Supply, and the outstanding Planner task assigned to Jamie in **Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch**.
3. **Reading the output critically.** Paul walks through each block and shows where the citations link back to the source email or file — and points out one item Copilot surfaced that is out of date, reinforcing the checking discipline from *Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice*.
4. **The custom prep prompt.** Where the built-in summary isn't enough, Paul switches to Copilot Chat and uses RTCA from *Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim*:

"You are my chief of staff. Prepare me for my Monthly US Sales Review with Morgan Reyes tomorrow. Summarise every email between Morgan and me about US sales and invoices in the last 30 days, list any figures Morgan has asked me to confirm, and flag anything I promised that is still outstanding. Use 'Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx' as the data reference. Give me five bullets and three questions to ask."

1. **Grounding explicitly.** Paul shows how naming the workbook directly encourages Copilot to open the **US Forecast** and **Sales Summary** tabs rather than working from email text alone.
2. **Attendee check.** Paul shows the people card for Morgan Reyes — role, recent interactions, shared files — and contrasts it with a manually typed external contact, where Copilot has nothing to work with, explaining exactly why.
3. **Turning prep into an output.** Finally, Paul asks Copilot to convert the briefing into a short agenda email to Morgan, sent before the meeting — prep becomes a deliverable, not just reading.

✅ Summary

- Copilot's meeting preparation summary pulls the invite, related emails, chats, files and previous recaps into a single briefing in seconds.
- Work IQ on **Microsoft 365 Business Standard with Copilot** is what gives Copilot access to that business content — there are no separate work/web mode buttons in this plan.
- It works best on **recurring** meetings with **real licensed directory users**; manually typed contacts give thinner results.
- The built-in prepare option is the fast path; a custom RTCA prompt in Copilot Chat is the precise path.
- Always name the specific file (for example *Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx*) when data accuracy matters, and allow a little time for very recent items to be indexed.
- Always check surfaced facts against the citation link before you repeat them in the room.
- If a button has moved or been renamed since recording, ask Copilot Chat in plain English instead — the capability is still there.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open your Outlook calendar and pick a real meeting happening in the next 48 hours that has at least two colleagues from your own organisation on it.
2. Open the meeting and ask Copilot to prepare you for it. Read the output and click at least two citations to check the source.
3. Now open Copilot Chat and write your own prep prompt using RTCA — give it a role, the task, the context (name a specific file or email thread), and the aim (for example "five bullets and three questions to ask").
4. Compare the two outputs and note which gave you something you did not already know.
5. Ask Copilot to turn the better one into a short agenda email and send it to the organiser before the meeting starts.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 23: How to Prepare for Any Meeting in Under a Minute With Meeting Preparation Summaries** and use the **Meeting Prep Prompt Card (RTCA)** together with the **Pashun Sports Monthly US Sales Review Sample Briefing** so you can compare your own output against a worked example.

SECTION 5: COPILOT IN WORD — DOCUMENTS AND WRITING

Lecture 24: How to Draft a Document From Scratch With a Prompt and a Reference File

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will use Copilot in Word to create a brand-new document from a blank page, using a written prompt plus one or more of your own files as the source material. By the end you will be able to turn an existing brief, spec or email thread into a first-draft document in under two minutes — and know exactly why grounding the prompt in a reference file produces a usable draft instead of generic filler.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Draft with Copilot** is the panel that appears on a blank Word document. It accepts a prompt of up to roughly 2,000 characters and, crucially, a **reference file** — you attach it by typing a forward slash (`/`) in the prompt box, or by clicking the paperclip / "Reference your content" control.
- **Ungrounded vs grounded drafting.** A prompt with no reference file produces plausible, generic business prose. A prompt that references `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` produces a draft containing your actual fabric blend, your actual colourways and your actual launch dates. The difference in editing time is enormous.
- **What you can reference:** Word documents, PowerPoint decks, PDFs, Excel workbooks, Loop pages, meeting transcripts and (in Copilot in Word) up to three files at once in most tenants. The files must be saved in OneDrive or SharePoint — a file sitting only on your local C: drive is invisible to Copilot.
- **RTCA still applies.** The framework from **Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim** is the backbone of every Draft prompt. The reference file is your Context; the rest of the prompt still needs Role, Task and Aim.
- **Copilot drafts structure, not truth.** It will happily invent a price, a lead time or a clause if your reference file doesn't contain one. Every generated figure must be checked against the source — see **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice**.
- **The three post-draft controls** sit under the generated text: **Keep it**, **Regenerate**, and the free-text refine box ("Make it shorter", "Add a section on returns", "Rewrite in a more formal tone").

Prompt Style	Example	Typical Result
Vague, no reference	"Write a supplier agreement"	Generic template, zero Pashun detail, 40+ minutes of rewriting
Specific, no reference	"Write a 2-page supplier agreement for a US t-shirt brand buying performance fabric"	Better shape, still invents every fact
Specific + reference file	"Using /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx, draft a 2-page supplier agreement…"	Real fabric blend, real volumes, real dates — 5–10 minutes of tidying
Specific + multiple references	Range Brief + Sales Forecast workbook	Draft with commercial context and volume commitments

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the live **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** tenant as **Paul Ashun, Founder & Director**, building a document the business genuinely needs: a supplier agreement summary for **Ridgeline Apparel Supply**, the fabric supplier for the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch.

1. Paul opens Word on the web, creates a **blank document**, and the **Draft with Copilot** panel appears automatically.
2. **The bad prompt first.** He types `Write a supplier agreement for a t-shirt company` and generates. The result is competent, generic and wrong — invented company names, invented payment terms, no mention of performance blend fabric. Paul deletes it deliberately so students see the contrast.
3. **The grounded prompt.** He starts a new draft and types a forward slash, which opens the file picker, and selects **`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`** from OneDrive. The full prompt reads:

"You are a commercial manager at Pashun Sports T-Shirts, a US sports-apparel brand. Using /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx, draft a two-page supplier agreement summary for Ridgeline Apparel Supply covering fabric specification, order volumes, lead times, quality tolerances and payment terms. Use British English, plain professional language, numbered clauses. Aim: a document Jamie Jordan can send to the supplier for comment this week. Where the brief does not contain a figure, insert [TO CONFIRM] rather than inventing one."

1. Paul highlights the last sentence of that prompt as the single most valuable line in the lecture — the `[TO CONFIRM]` instruction converts hallucination risk into a visible to-do list.
2. **Reviewing the output.** The draft lands with real detail pulled from the brief: the performance-blend composition, the colourway range, the US launch window. Paul scrolls through and points out where `[TO CONFIRM]` appeared — exactly the fields the brief never specified.
3. **Refining without starting over.** Into the refine box he types *"Add a clause on returns and defective stock, and shorten the fabric specification section to one paragraph"*, then regenerates that portion only. He compares this to the wasteful habit of deleting everything and re-prompting from scratch.
4. **Adding a second reference.** Paul starts a fresh draft for a different deliverable — a wholesale price list introduction — referencing **both** the Range Brief **and** `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`, showing that Copilot pulls narrative from the Word file and volume context from the workbook's US Forecast tab.
5. **The honest failure note.** Paul flags a real-world issue encountered on this tenant: when a source file is corrupted or has only just been saved, Copilot may return "I couldn't find that file" or draft with no grounded detail at all. The fix is to open the file, confirm it renders, wait for OneDrive sync to complete, then re-reference it. This is a grounding problem, not a prompting problem — and knowing the difference saves an hour of rewriting prompts that were never the issue.
6. He finishes by clicking **Keep it**, saving as `Ridgeline Apparel Supply - Draft Agreement Summary.docx` into the Pashun Sports SharePoint site so the document itself becomes referenceable material for later lectures.

✅ Summary

- **Draft with Copilot** turns a blank Word document into a structured first draft, and the forward slash (`/`) is how you attach the reference file that makes that draft specific to your business.
- A reference file must live in **OneDrive or SharePoint** — local-only files cannot be grounded.
- Build the prompt with **RTCA**: Role, Task, Context (your file), Aim — and always state the output length, tone and language.
- Add the instruction **"insert [TO CONFIRM] rather than inventing a figure"** to convert invented data into a visible checklist.
- Use the **refine box** to adjust an existing draft rather than regenerating from zero; and if grounding fails, check the file opens and has finished syncing before blaming the prompt.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one real document you need to write this week — a brief, a proposal, a policy note or a client summary.
2. Identify **one existing file** that contains the underlying facts, and confirm it is saved in OneDrive or SharePoint and opens cleanly.
3. Open a blank Word document, wait for the **Draft with Copilot** panel, and write an RTCA prompt of at least three sentences that names the role, the deliverable, the length, the tone and the audience.
4. Type `/` and attach your reference file. Add the line: *"Where the source does not contain a figure, insert [TO CONFIRM] rather than inventing one."*
5. Generate the draft, then use the **refine box twice** — once to change length, once to add or remove a section. Do not regenerate from scratch.
6. Search the finished draft for `[TO CONFIRM]` and list every one. That list is your real research task — and it is the honest measure of how much Copilot actually knew.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 24: How to Draft a Document From Scratch With a Prompt and a Reference File** and use the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply Agreement Prompt Template** together with the sample reference file **`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`**, so you can reproduce the demo exactly before applying it to your own documents.

Lecture 25: How to Summarise Long Documents and Ask Questions About Their Contents

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will use Copilot in Word to read long documents *for* you — turning a 30-page fabric specification from Ridgeline Apparel Supply into a one-screen summary, and then interrogating that document with follow-up questions until you have the exact clause, number or commitment you need. By the end you will be able to handle a document you have never opened before and answer questions on it with confidence in under five minutes.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Two different jobs, one pane.** *Summarising* compresses a document you have to read. *Asking questions* extracts a specific fact you need. Copilot in Word does both from the same chat pane, but the prompts look completely different — and mixing them up is the most common reason people say "Copilot's summary wasn't useful".
- **Where Copilot reads from.** When you open a document stored in OneDrive or SharePoint and click the Copilot icon in the ribbon, Copilot's answers are grounded in *that document's full text* — not just the page you can see on screen. It reads headings, body text, tables and footnotes.
- **The auto-summary at the top.** Open any long document in Word on the web or desktop and Copilot offers a generated summary with clickable citation references. Those little reference

markers are the most important feature on the screen: each one jumps you to the paragraph the claim came from, which is how you verify before you forward anything to Morgan Reyes or a supplier.

- **Summaries are a starting point, not the deliverable.** The default summary is neutral and generic. You control length, audience and focus by re-prompting: *"Summarise this for a finance director in five bullets, focusing only on cost and payment terms."*
- **Question-asking beats reading.** For a 30-page spec, you are almost never asked "what does it say?" — you are asked "does it cover shrinkage after industrial wash?" That is a question, not a summary request.
- **Copilot will not invent a clause — but it will misread one.** If a term isn't in the document, a well-formed prompt will get "this document does not mention…". The real risk is subtler: mixing up two similar tables, or reading a draft figure as final. Always click the citation.

Prompt type	Use it when	Example on the Ridgeline fabric spec
Full summary	You've never seen the document	"Summarise this document in 8 bullets covering scope, fabric composition, testing and delivery."
Audience summary	Someone else needs it	"Summarise this for Jamie Jordan as project manager — only the items that create a delivery deadline."
Targeted question	You need one fact	"What shrinkage tolerance is specified after three industrial washes?"
Existence check	You suspect a gap	"Does this document specify anything about colourfastness testing for the navy colourway? Quote the exact wording or say it is not covered."
Extraction to table	You need to compare	"List every numeric tolerance in this document as a table with Attribute, Value, Unit and Section."
Risk read	Before sign-off	"List anything in this document that commits Pashun Sports to a cost, a deadline or a minimum order quantity."

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through the **Pashun Pro Tee** launch, playing the person who has just been forwarded a long technical document they did not write.

1. **Open the document.** Paul opens `Ridgeline Apparel Supply - Pro Tee Fabric Specification.docx` from the Pashun Sports T-Shirts SharePoint site — a 30-page performance-blend spec full of tables, test standards and tolerances. He scrolls once, quickly, to show how unrealistic it is to read this before a 10am call.

2. **Take the default summary.** He clicks the **Copilot** icon in the Home ribbon and uses the auto-generated summary. He reads it aloud, then points out what's wrong with it: it's accurate but flat, and it buries the two things that actually matter — the 250-unit minimum order and the 12-week lead time.
3. **Re-prompt for a useful summary.** Paul types: *"Summarise this document in six bullets for a non-technical founder preparing for a supplier call. Focus on anything that affects cost, timing or quality risk. Ignore general boilerplate."* The output is dramatically more usable.
4. **Verify with citations.** He clicks a reference marker next to the lead-time bullet, Word jumps to page 19, and he confirms the figure in the source table. This is the habit the whole lecture is built around.
5. **Ask real questions.** Paul then interrogates the document the way a real working day does:

- *"What shrinkage tolerance is specified after three industrial washes?"*
- *"Does this specification cover colourfastness for the navy colourway? Quote the wording."*
- *"List every deadline or lead time mentioned, with the section it appears in, as a table."*

1. **Handle a gap honestly.** He deliberately asks about a term that isn't there — *"What does this document say about returns of faulty stock?"* — and shows Copilot correctly reporting that it isn't covered. He explains that this is a genuinely valuable answer: it tells him the supplier agreement, not the spec, is where that conversation belongs.
2. **Turn the answer into work.** Paul asks: *"Draft three questions I should put to Ridgeline on tomorrow's call based on the gaps in this specification."* He pastes the result straight into the **Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch Checklist** OneNote page.
3. **Cross-document contrast.** Finally he opens the **Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx** and asks: *"Does anything in this brief conflict with the fabric weight stated in the Ridgeline specification?"* — demonstrating that when you need two documents compared, you reference the other file explicitly using the `/` file-reference in Copilot chat rather than expecting Word to guess.

✅ Summary

- Copilot in Word reads the **whole** document, not just the visible page — so summaries of 30-page specs are genuinely complete.
- The default summary is a draft; **re-prompt with audience, length and focus** to get something you'd actually send.
- **Click the citation markers.** A summary you haven't spot-checked is not something to forward to a supplier or your Head of Finance.
- For most real work, **targeted questions beat summaries** — "what's the shrinkage tolerance?" is faster and safer than reading a summary and hoping.
- "This document does not mention that" is a **useful answer**, not a failure — it tells you where the gap is.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open the longest document you have in OneDrive or SharePoint — ideally 15 pages or more, and ideally one you didn't write.
2. Click the **Copilot** icon in the Word ribbon and accept the default summary. Read it, then note one thing it left out that you'd have led with.
3. Re-prompt using this structure: *"Summarise this document in [5] bullets for [audience]. Focus only on [cost / deadlines / risks / obligations]. Ignore boilerplate."*
4. Click at least two citation markers and confirm the source text says what the summary claims.
5. Ask three targeted questions of the document — make one of them a question you're fairly sure the document does **not** answer, and check that Copilot says so rather than inventing something.

6. Finish with: *"Based on this document, list the three questions I should ask the author or supplier."* Paste the result somewhere you'll actually see it again.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 25: How to Summarise Long Documents and Ask Questions About Their Contents** and use the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply — Pro Tee Fabric Specification (sample 30-page document)** together with the **Document Interrogation Prompt Card**, which lists the six prompt types from the table above in copy-paste form; if you want to build on the summarising technique, pair it with the prompt structure from **Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim**.

Lecture 26: How to Rewrite and Transform Existing Text for a New Audience or Purpose

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Most business writing already exists — it just exists in the wrong tone, the wrong length or for the wrong reader. In this lecture you will learn how to use Copilot's **Rewrite** and inline rewriting prompts in Word to transform text you already have at Pashun Sports into a version that lands with a completely different audience or serves a completely different purpose.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Rewriting is not generating.** Generating creates new content from a prompt. Rewriting starts from text that is already approved, already accurate and already yours — so the risk of hallucination drops sharply. This is the safest, highest-value Copilot task in Word.
- **Two ways to rewrite in Word.** Select text and use the Copilot icon in the left margin → **Rewrite with Copilot**, which offers alternative versions you can cycle through and Replace. Or select text and open the Copilot chat pane to give a full instruction such as "Rewrite the selected paragraphs for a US wholesale buyer who has never heard of our brand."
- **Rewrite with Copilot is fast but shallow.** It varies wording and flow. It will not change audience, reading level or purpose unless you tell it to. The chat-pane instruction is where real transformation happens.
- **Four transformation levers.** Almost every rewrite request at Pashun Sports is a combination of these:

Lever	What you change	Example instruction
Audience	Who is reading it	"Rewrite for a US retail buyer, not an internal team"
Tone	How it sounds	"More confident and commercial, less cautious"

Length	How much there is	"Cut to 150 words with no loss of factual detail"
Format	How it is presented	"Turn into five bullet points, each starting with a verb"

- **Always state what must survive.** Rewrites quietly drop facts. Add a protection clause: "Keep every price, GSM figure and delivery date exactly as written."
- **Reading level is a real instruction.** "Rewrite at a reading level suitable for a non-technical customer" produces a genuinely different document from "Rewrite for a textile engineer."
- **Rewriting respects your house style.** If you built a house-style prompt in *Lecture 16: How to Give Copilot a House Style So Every Output Sounds Like Your Business*, paste it above your rewrite instruction and the output will stay on brand.
- **Selection matters more than the prompt.** Copilot rewrites what you highlighted. Highlight a heading plus three paragraphs and it treats them as one block; highlight one sentence and it will not see the surrounding argument. Select the full unit of meaning.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in **Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx**, the internal brief written for Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance).

1. **Audience transformation.** Paul selects the three-paragraph fabric section — written for an internal audience, full of GSM figures and supplier shorthand from Ridgeline Apparel Supply — and opens the Copilot pane:

"Rewrite the selected text for a US independent retail buyer who has never bought from Pashun Sports before. Lead with the customer benefit, keep the 180 GSM performance-blend figure and the moisture-wicking claim exactly as written, remove all internal supplier names, and keep it to 120 words."

Ridgeline disappears, the engineering language becomes benefit language, and the numbers survive.

1. **Purpose transformation.** Same source paragraphs, new instruction: *"Rewrite this as three product-page bullets for the Pashun Sports website. Maximum 15 words each. No marketing superlatives."* Paul shows how the identical source text produces web copy rather than a brief.
2. **Tone transformation.** Paul selects the delivery-risk paragraph and asks for two versions: one for Morgan Reyes — *"Rewrite for our Head of Finance: factual, risk-first, quantify the exposure in weeks and units"* — and one for the supplier — *"Rewrite as a polite, firm paragraph I can send to Ridgeline Apparel Supply asking them to confirm the shipping window."*
3. **Rewrite with Copilot (inline).** Paul selects the executive summary, clicks the margin icon, chooses **Rewrite with Copilot**, cycles the alternative versions, and shows the **Regenerate** and **Adjust tone** options — then explains why this route is for polish, not repurposing.
4. **The fact-check pass.** Paul puts the original and the rewrite side by side and checks every number, date and claim. He deliberately shows one rewrite where the 180 GSM figure has been softened to "high-performance fabric" — and fixes it with a follow-up: *"Reinstate the exact GSM figure from my original text."*
5. **Version safety.** Paul demonstrates **Undo** and Word's **Version History** so students know a bad Replace is never permanent.

✅ Summary

- Rewriting existing, approved text is lower-risk and higher-value than generating new text from scratch.
- Use inline **Rewrite with Copilot** for polish; use the **Copilot chat pane** with a full instruction for genuine audience or purpose transformation.
- Combine the four levers — audience, tone, length, format — in a single clear instruction rather than rewriting four times.
- Always add a protection clause naming the facts, figures and dates that must survive unchanged.
- Never accept a rewrite without comparing it against the original for dropped or altered facts.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open any document you have written in the last month for an internal audience — a brief, a report or a set of notes.
2. Select one full section of three to four paragraphs.
3. In the Copilot pane, ask: *"Rewrite the selected text for [a specific external reader]. Keep every figure and date exactly as written. Maximum 150 words."*
4. Without changing your selection, run a second instruction: *"Now rewrite the same text as five bullet points for a slide, each under 12 words."*
5. Compare both outputs against the original and list any fact that changed or disappeared.
6. Save your two best instructions into the reusable prompt library you started in *Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library*.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 26: How to Rewrite and Transform Existing Text for a New Audience or Purpose** and use **Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx** together with the **Rewrite Instruction Templates** sheet, which gives you ready-made audience, tone, length and format instructions plus the standard fact-protection clause.

Lecture 27: How to Generate Tables for Price Lists, Stock Records and Comparison Charts

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn how to make Copilot in Word build proper, structured tables from scratch, from a rough list, or from a block of messy prose — so price lists, stock records and supplier comparison charts stop being hand-typed and start being generated. We will build three real tables for the Pashun Pro Tee US launch inside Word, then tidy and reformat them without leaving the document.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot in Word can create tables three different ways.** From a written instruction ("create a table of..."), from existing text you select and convert, or from content it pulls out of a referenced file using the `/` grounding command.
- **Tables are a structure problem, not a data problem.** Copilot is excellent at deciding *columns, ordering and headers*. It is only as good as the numbers you give it. Never let it invent prices, margins or stock counts — always ground them.
- **Column-first prompting gets the best results.** Tell Copilot exactly which columns you want, in the order you want them, rather than describing the table in general terms. "Create a table with columns: Size, Colourway, Wholesale Price (USD), RRP (USD), Margin %" beats "make me a price table".
- **Convert-to-table beats regenerate.** If you already have the content as a bulleted list or a paragraph, select it and ask Copilot to turn it into a table. You keep your exact figures and only gain structure.
- **Copilot can restructure a table it has already made.** Add a column, sort by a field, merge two tables, convert currency labels, or collapse rows — all by selecting the table and prompting in the Copilot-in-Word box.
- **Word tables are not Excel.** Copilot in Word will not recalculate a margin if you change a price. Where numbers must stay live, build in Excel (Section 6) and bring the result into Word.

Table type	Best prompt approach	Grounding source for Pashun Sports
Wholesale price list	Specify columns + currency + sort order	`Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`
Stock record	Ask for one row per SKU, plus a total row	US Forecast tab, size/colourway/ stock data
Supplier comparison chart	Ask for criteria as rows, suppliers as columns	`Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts` SharePoint list
Spec summary table	Convert existing prose with "turn this into a table"	`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`

- **Two Copilot entry points in Word matter here.** The Copilot icon in the left margin of an empty paragraph (generates new content inline) and the Copilot pane on the right (better for referencing files and iterating).

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` on the Pashun Consulting tenant, building the commercial section of the brief.

1. **Generating a wholesale price list from a prompt.** Paul places the cursor under the heading "Wholesale Pricing" and uses the inline Copilot icon with:

"Create a table with the columns: SKU, Size, Colourway, Wholesale Price (USD), Suggested RRP (USD), Margin %. Include one row for each of the six Pashun Pro Tee size/colourway combinations. Leave price cells blank for me to complete."

Note the deliberate instruction to leave prices blank — this is the safe pattern when the real figures live elsewhere and you do not want Copilot guessing.

1. **Grounding the same table in the real workbook.** Paul reruns it from the Copilot pane using `/` to reference `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`, asking Copilot to populate the stock

column from the US Forecast tab. He shows what good grounding looks like — and honestly shows what it looks like when file-content grounding is slow to index, which happens on recently edited or recently rebuilt files. The fix: wait for indexing, or paste the source figures into the document and convert.

1. **Converting prose into a stock record table.** Paul selects an existing paragraph in the range brief describing sizes, colourways and opening stock quantities, then prompts: *"Turn this selected text into a table with columns Size, Colourway, Opening Stock Units, Reorder Point. Do not change any numbers."* The "do not change any numbers" clause is the single most useful guardrail in this lecture.

1. **Building the supplier comparison chart.** Working from the `Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts` SharePoint list (which lives on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts Team site, not personal OneDrive), Paul creates a decision table for Jamie Jordan: *"Create a comparison table with suppliers as columns, including Ridgeline Apparel Supply, and these criteria as rows: Lead Time, Minimum Order Quantity, Price Per Unit, Fabric Certification, Location. Mark unknown values as 'To confirm'."*

1. **Refining without retyping.** Paul selects the finished comparison table and asks Copilot to add a "Risk Rating" row, then to sort the price list by wholesale price ascending. He finishes with Word's own **Table Design** tab to apply the Pashun Sports banding, showing where Copilot hands over to formatting.

1. **The handover to Morgan Reyes.** Paul shows the completed pricing table being copied into an email to Morgan (Head of Finance) for margin sign-off — the realistic end point of a Word table in a real business.

✅ Summary

- Prompt for tables **column-first**: name the columns, their order, the currency and the sort order.
- Use **"convert this selected text into a table"** whenever the content already exists — you preserve your real figures.
- Ground price and stock tables in the actual workbook with `/`, and add **"do not change any numbers"** to stop Copilot rounding or inventing values.
- Copilot will happily **restructure an existing table** — add columns, add rows, sort, merge — so build rough and refine in place.
- Word tables are **static**; anything needing live calculation belongs in Excel and comes into Word as a finished result.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a Word document containing a paragraph or bulleted list of product, pricing or inventory information from your own work.
2. Select that text and prompt Copilot: *"Turn this selected text into a table. Do not change any numbers or add any information that is not in the selection."*
3. Now select the resulting table and add a column with a single prompt — for example *"Add a Notes column and a Last Reviewed column, both blank."*
4. Ask Copilot to sort the table by your most important field, then apply a Word table style from the **Table Design** tab.

5. Finally, write a fresh table from nothing: prompt Copilot for a three-supplier comparison chart with your own five decision criteria as rows, marking anything you do not yet know as "To confirm".

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 27: How to Generate Tables for Price Lists, Stock Records and Comparison Charts** and use the **Table Prompt Card** (the column-first prompt templates for price lists, stock records and comparison charts) alongside the sample file **Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx** so you can practise the convert-to-table step on real content; if you need to revisit the `/` file-referencing technique, see **Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results**.

Lecture 28: How to Write Website and Product Page Copy That Matches Your Brand Voice

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Website and product page copy is the writing task most small businesses outsource, delay or do badly — and it is the one Copilot in Word handles best, provided you give it a brand voice to work from. In this lecture you will turn the Pashun Pro Tee range brief into finished US product page copy that sounds like Pashun Sports rather than like a chatbot.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Brand voice is an input, not an instruction.** Telling Copilot "write in our brand voice" produces nothing useful, because Copilot has no idea what that is. You must either reference a file that demonstrates the voice, or describe the voice in concrete, testable terms.
- **Three ways to give Copilot your voice in Word**, in increasing order of reliability:

Method	How it works	Best for
Describe it in the prompt	You spell out tone rules in the prompt text itself ("short sentences, no exclamation marks, never say 'unleash'")	Quick one-off copy
Reference an existing file	Use `/` in the Copilot prompt box to point at a document that already sounds right	Consistency across a campaign
Reference a written Brand Voice Guide	A one-page Word doc holding your voice rules, banned words and worked examples, referenced every time	Teams, repeat work, handing over to others

- **Product page copy has a fixed anatomy.** Ask for the whole structure in one go rather than one blob of prose: product name, one-line hook, 40–60 word descriptive paragraph, four to six benefit bullets, a materials/spec block, a sizing note, and a call to action.
- **Features versus benefits.** Copilot defaults to restating features from your source document ("performance blend fabric"). You must explicitly instruct it to convert each feature into a customer outcome ("stays dry through a full training session") — this is the single biggest quality lever in product copy.
- **Ground everything in the range brief.** Copy that invents fabric weights, wash temperatures or country of origin is a legal and returns problem, not just a style one. Every factual claim in the output must be traceable to `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`.
- **US market voice.** Because Pashun Sports is launching in the USA, the prompt must specify US English spelling, US sizing conventions and US-familiar phrasing — Copilot will otherwise mirror the UK English in the source brief.
- **Banned-words lists work.** Copilot responds well to explicit prohibitions. A short list such as "never use: unleash, elevate, game-changer, revolutionary, crafted, journey" removes most of the AI-generic feel in one pass.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works entirely in Word, on the Pashun Consulting tenant, signed in as Paul Ashun (Founder & Director, Business Standard with Copilot).

1. **Build the Brand Voice Guide first.** Paul creates a new Word document, `Pashun Sports - Brand Voice Guide.docx`, and uses **Draft with Copilot** with the prompt: *"Create a one-page brand voice guide for Pashun Sports T-Shirts, a US sports apparel brand selling performance t-shirts direct to consumers. Include: three voice principles, a tone slider (formal vs casual, serious vs playful), a banned words list, and two worked examples showing a weak sentence rewritten in the brand voice."* He then edits it by hand — this is the step most people skip, and the guide is only useful once a human has made it opinionated.
2. **Open the source material.** Paul opens `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` and shows the sections Copilot will draw on: fabric blend, colourways, size range and target customer.
3. **Draft the product page.** In a new blank document, Paul opens the Copilot draft box and types a grounded prompt:

"Using /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx for all product facts and /Pashun Sports - Brand Voice Guide.docx for tone, write the product page copy for the Pashun Pro Tee for our US web store. Structure it as: one-line hook, a 50-word description, five benefit bullets that convert features into customer outcomes, a materials and care block, a sizing note, and a call to action. Use US English. Do not invent any fabric, weight or care detail that is not in the range brief."

1. **Inspect the first draft against the brief.** Paul reads the output side by side with the range brief and flags one invented claim — a common failure — then fixes it with a targeted follow-up: *"Remove the moisture-wicking claim; the range brief does not state it. Replace that bullet with a benefit based on the stated fabric blend."*
2. **Tighten the voice.** Paul uses **Rewrite with Copilot** on the hook line only, asking for three shorter alternatives under eight words, and picks one. This shows students that selective rewriting beats regenerating the whole page.
3. **Create the variants.** From the finished page, Paul asks Copilot to produce a 160-character meta description, a 25-word category-listing blurb and a three-line Instagram caption — all derived from the approved copy so every channel stays consistent.
4. **Share for review.** Paul saves the document to the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site and tags Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) in a comment for sign-off, closing the loop between AI drafting and human approval.

✅ Summary

- Copilot cannot guess your brand voice — you must supply it as a described set of rules or, better, as a referenced Brand Voice Guide document.
- Ask for product copy by its component parts (hook, description, benefit bullets, spec block, CTA), not as one undifferentiated block of text.
- Explicitly instruct Copilot to turn features into customer benefits, or it will simply paraphrase your specification sheet.
- Every factual claim must be grounded in the range brief; check the first draft for invented product details before anything reaches a customer.
- Generate channel variants (meta description, category blurb, social caption) from the approved copy so all touchpoints stay on message.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Create a new Word document called **Brand Voice Guide** for your own organisation and use Draft with Copilot to produce a first version with three voice principles, a tone slider and a banned words list.
2. Edit that guide by hand until at least one line in it would be uncomfortable for a competitor to copy — that is your proof it is specific enough.
3. Open a blank document and write a grounded product or service page prompt that references both your source spec file and your new Brand Voice Guide using the `/` file picker.
4. Compare the draft line by line against your source file and mark any claim Copilot invented.
5. Fix those claims with one targeted follow-up prompt rather than regenerating the whole page, then generate a 160-character meta description from the approved text.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 28: How to Write Website and Product Page Copy That Matches Your Brand Voice** and use the **Brand Voice Guide Template** and the **Product Page Copy Prompt Card**; if you have not yet built your grounding habit, revisit **Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results** before you start.

Lecture 29: How to Turn a Word Document Into a Presentation, Email or Summary in One Click

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

You have written the document — now you need it as a deck for the board, a two-paragraph email to the supplier, and a one-page summary for the team. In this lecture you will learn how to reuse a single Word document across PowerPoint, Outlook and Copilot Chat without ever rewriting it by hand.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Repurposing beats rewriting.** The most expensive habit in professional writing is producing the same content three times in three formats. Copilot treats your finished Word document as the source of truth and generates every downstream format from it.
- **"One click" really means "one instruction plus one review."** The generation is instant; the professional value comes from the 60 seconds you spend correcting it afterwards. Never send a generated artefact untouched.
- **The Word → PowerPoint route** is triggered from inside PowerPoint, not Word. In a blank presentation you use Copilot's **"Create presentation from file"** option and reference the Word document. Copilot reads your headings and builds one slide per major heading, so a well-structured document produces a well-structured deck. A wall of unstructured prose produces a poor deck — structure in, structure out.
- **The Word → Email route** works in two directions. You can select content in Word, copy it into Outlook and ask Copilot to rewrite it as a short covering email; or you can draft in Outlook with Copilot and reference the document in your prompt so Copilot pulls the substance directly from the file.
- **The Word → Summary route** is the fastest of the three. In the Word Copilot chat pane, ask for a summary at a stated length and reading level, and copy the result into Teams, Loop or an email.
- **Grounding syntax matters.** In Copilot Chat and Outlook, typing `/` followed by the filename attaches the document as grounding. Typing the filename as plain text does not — Copilot may guess instead of read.

Target format	Where you start	What Copilot needs from you	Typical fix afterwards
PowerPoint deck	New blank presentation → Copilot → Create presentation from file	A document with real Heading 1 / Heading 2 styles	Reapply brand template, cut filler slides
Outlook email	Outlook → Draft with Copilot	Audience, tone, length, and the `/filename` reference	Fix the opening line and the specific ask
Short summary	Word → Copilot chat pane	Word count, audience, and what to prioritise	Restore exact figures and dates
Teams / Loop update	Copilot Chat with `/filename`	"Bullet points, no more than 6, plain English"	Remove anything commercially sensitive

- **Fidelity rule:** generated formats compress. Numbers, dates, names and prices are the first casualties. Always re-check them against the source document before the artefact leaves your desk.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works from the real Pashun Sports tenant using **Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx**, the Word document built in earlier lectures in this section.

1. **Start in the document.** Paul opens the Range Brief and shows the heading structure — Heading 1 for each major section (Product Concept, Fabric and Sourcing, US Market Positioning, Pricing,

Launch Timeline), Heading 2 for the detail underneath. He points out that this structure is what will drive every format that follows.

2. **Word → PowerPoint.** Paul opens PowerPoint, creates a blank presentation, opens Copilot and chooses **Create presentation from file**, selecting `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`. Copilot builds a draft deck mapped to the brief's headings. Paul shows the honest reality: the generated deck arrives on the default Office template, not the Pashun Sports brand template, and includes two low-value slides that need deleting. He applies the brand template via **Design → Themes**, deletes the filler, and demonstrates that the whole job took under three minutes versus a morning of copy-paste.
3. **Word → Outlook email.** Paul opens a new message to **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** and uses **Draft with Copilot** with the prompt: *"Write a short internal email to Jamie summarising the US Range Brief for the Pashun Pro Tee. Reference /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx. Three short paragraphs. Confirm the launch timeline and ask her to confirm the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric lead time by Friday."* He shows the `/` grounding picker attaching the real file, then edits the generated opening line, which is too formal for an internal message.
4. **Word → summary for Finance.** Back in Word, Paul opens the Copilot chat pane and asks: *"Summarise this document in 150 words for Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance. Prioritise cost, margin and launch dates. Plain English, no marketing language."* He then runs the deliberate fact-check: he compares the unit costs and launch dates in the summary against the source text, and shows one figure that Copilot rounded — proving why the check is non-negotiable.
5. **The reuse point.** Paul finishes by showing all four artefacts side by side — brief, deck, email, Finance summary — produced from one document in a single sitting, and notes that the quality of all three outputs was determined by the structure of the original Word file.

✅ Summary

- One well-structured Word document can become a deck, an email and a summary without any rewriting.
- Presentations are generated from **inside PowerPoint** using Create presentation from file — Word headings become slides, so structure your document properly first.
- Use `/filename` to ground Outlook drafts and Copilot Chat prompts in the real document rather than letting Copilot guess.
- Always state audience, tone and length when asking for a summary or email — vague prompts produce vague, over-formal output.
- Generated formats compress detail: re-verify every figure, date, name and price against the source document before you send anything.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a Word document you have already written for real work — ideally one with proper heading styles applied.
2. In Word's Copilot chat pane, ask for a 150-word summary aimed at a named colleague, stating what to prioritise and what tone to use.
3. Open a blank PowerPoint presentation, choose Copilot → **Create presentation from file**, and select that same document. Review the deck and note which slides you would delete.
4. Apply your organisation's brand template to the generated deck via Design → Themes.
5. In Outlook, use **Draft with Copilot** to write a covering email, using `/` to attach your document as grounding, and specifying three short paragraphs plus one clear action request.
6. Check every number and date in all three outputs against the original document and log anything Copilot changed, rounded or dropped.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 29: How to Turn a Word Document Into a Presentation, Email or Summary in One Click** and use the sample file **Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx** together with the **Document Repurposing Prompt Card**, which contains the exact deck, email and summary prompts used in this demo — and if your headings are not yet structured for reuse, revisit **Lecture 27: How to Structure a Long Document With Copilot** before running the PowerPoint step.

Lecture 30: How to Review, Track Changes and Tidy a Document You Did Not Write

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Most of the documents you have to deal with at work were written by somebody else — a supplier, a colleague, a lawyer — and your job is to understand them, check them and mark them up quickly. In this lecture you will use Copilot in Word to summarise, interrogate, review and tidy a document you did not write, then commit your edits properly using Track Changes so the other side can see exactly what you changed.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Reading a document you didn't write is three separate jobs.** Understanding it, finding the risks in it, and changing it. Copilot is excellent at the first two and useful — but supervised — at the third.
- **Summarise first, edit second.** Never start marking up a 30-page fabric specification until you have asked Copilot to tell you what is actually in it. The summary at the top of the Copilot pane in Word gives you the structure, and each bullet is clickable straight to the source paragraph.
- **Ask questions of the document, don't just read it.** Copilot in Word answers grounded questions about the open file: "What are the payment terms?", "Where does this document mention returns?", "Does this agreement say anything about minimum order quantity?"
- **Copilot does not turn Track Changes on for you.** This is the single most common mistake. If Track Changes is off and you accept a Copilot rewrite, the original text is gone silently. Turn it on under **Review** → **Track Changes** → **For Everyone** *before* you let Copilot touch a word of someone else's document.
- **Rewrite with Copilot works on selection.** Highlight a paragraph, use the Copilot icon in the margin, and choose **Rewrite with Copilot** — or type your own instruction, e.g. "Rewrite this clause in plain English but do not change its legal meaning."
- **Comments vs. edits.** If the document belongs to someone else, a comment is often more appropriate than an edit. Ask Copilot to draft the wording, then paste it into a real Word comment so the author decides.
- **Copilot cannot see tracked changes as changes.** It reads the resulting text. If you need a summary of what has been altered, use Word's **Compare** feature (Review → Compare) rather than asking Copilot.

Task	Best tool	Why
Understand a long document fast	Copilot summary + follow-up questions	Cites paragraph sources you can click
Find a specific term or risk	Copilot prompt: "Where does this document mention…"	Faster and more reliable than Ctrl+F for concepts
Soften or clarify wording	Select text → Rewrite with Copilot	Works on selection, keeps the rest untouched
Show the author what you changed	Word Track Changes (turn on manually)	Copilot edits are invisible without it
Suggest rather than impose	Copilot-drafted text pasted into a Word comment	Keeps authorship with the original writer
See what changed between two versions	Review → Compare	Copilot does not read revision marks

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** supplier paperwork for the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch.

1. **Open the supplier agreement** sent over by Ridgeline Apparel Supply — a document Paul did not write and did not ask to be 14 pages long.
2. **Read the auto-summary** in the Copilot pane, then click two of the bullets to jump straight to the source clauses.
3. **Interrogate it.** Paul prompts: *"What are the payment terms, the minimum order quantity and the lead time in this agreement? Quote the exact wording for each."* Then a risk pass: *"List anything in this agreement that could cost Pashun Sports money if the US launch date slips."*
4. **Turn Track Changes on for everyone** under the Review tab — Paul deliberately shows what happens when you forget, by accepting a rewrite with it off and watching the original clause disappear with no trace.
5. **Rewrite a clause.** Paul selects the delivery clause and prompts: *"Rewrite this in plain English for a non-lawyer, keep the same obligations, and keep it under 60 words."* The result appears as a tracked insertion with the original struck through.
6. **Draft a comment instead of an edit.** For the returns clause, Paul asks Copilot in the pane: *"Draft a short, polite comment to Ridgeline asking them to confirm who pays return shipping on faulty stock."* He pastes it into a real Word comment addressed to the supplier.
7. **Tidy the formatting.** Paul opens the 30-page fabric specification document, which arrived with inconsistent headings, and uses Copilot to generate a clean executive summary at the top, then Word's own Styles to fix the heading levels — showing clearly where Copilot stops and manual work begins.
8. **Hand it on.** Paul saves to the Pashun Sports SharePoint site and shares it with Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) so Jamie sees the tracked markup, not a mystery rewrite.

✅ Summary

- Summarise and question a document with Copilot **before** you edit a single word of it.

- Turn on **Track Changes** → **For Everyone** manually — Copilot will not do it for you, and edits made without it are irreversible.
- Use **Rewrite with Copilot** on a selection for clause-level clarity, not on the whole document at once.
- When the document is someone else's, have Copilot draft a **comment** rather than imposing an edit.
- Copilot reads the text, not the revision marks — use Word's **Compare** to see what changed between versions.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open any document you received from someone else — a contract, a policy, a long brief.
2. Ask Copilot in Word: *"Summarise this document in five bullets and tell me what it is asking me to agree to."*
3. Ask a second, risk-focused question: *"What in this document could create a problem or a cost for us later?"*
4. Turn on **Review** → **Track Changes** → **For Everyone**.
5. Select one badly written paragraph and prompt: *"Rewrite this in plain English, keep the meaning identical, maximum 60 words."*
6. Ask Copilot to draft one polite query about a clause you are unsure of, and paste it into a real Word comment.
7. Save, reopen, and confirm your markup is visible as tracked changes — not as silent replacements.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 30: How to Review, Track Changes and Tidy a Document You Did Not Write** and use the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply — Pashun Pro Tee Supplier Agreement (practice copy)** together with the **Document Review Prompt Card**; if you also want the source brief that generated it, it sits in the folder for **Lecture 28: How to Draft a Professional Document From Scratch in Word With Copilot**.

Lecture 31: How to Clean Up a Messy Spreadsheet So Copilot Can Actually Work With It

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Ridgeline Apparel Supply has sent Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance, a genuinely messy export to reconcile against their invoice. Morgan forwards it straight on to Paul, because the same numbers feed the Pashun Pro Tee US launch forecast he owns — and it lands in his inbox exactly as messy as Ridgeline sent it. In this lecture you will do what Paul does: recognise the structural problems that make a real-world spreadsheet hard to work with, fix them by hand and with Copilot's help, and get the Pashun Sports forecast workbook into the same clean, Table-based shape used in every other lecture in this section.

💬 Core Concepts

Why this file needs work before you touch Copilot. The workbook Ridgeline sent has a merged title row, a blank spacer row splitting the data in two, a stray "Grand Total" row sitting inside the records, two cells reading "TBC (Ridgeline)" instead of a number, and a Units column where some values are stored as text rather than numbers. None of this is unreadable to a human — Paul can see exactly what it means — but it's the kind of shape that makes any tool's job harder than it needs to be, Copilot included.

The habits worth fixing before you rely on Copilot for anything:

- **Work from a file saved to OneDrive or SharePoint. Copilot in Excel needs a cloud-hosted .xlsx, .xlsm or .xlsb file — a local-only copy on your desktop won't be grounded at all.**
- **Format the data as an Excel Table (Home → Format as Table, or Ctrl+T). This is the single most useful habit in this whole section — Tables give Copilot a clear, named block to reason over instead of an ambiguous range.**
- **One header row, at the top, with unique text headers. No two-row stacked headers, no blank header cells, no headers that are numbers or dates.**
- **Avoid merged cells inside the data range where you can. A merged title row above your table is fine once it's outside the Table itself — but a merge sitting inside the record area just confuses anything trying to treat each row as one record.**
- **No blank rows or spacer rows used for visual separation inside the block, and no stray commentary or totals rows buried between records — move a Grand Total row below the Table, or let Copilot build one for you.**
- **One data type per column. A "Units" column containing `1200`, `1,200 `, and `TBC (Ridgeline)` in different rows can't be reliably summed by anything, Copilot included.**
- **Vague, abbreviated headers slow everyone down. `Sz`, `Colour`, `Cost` and `Price` mean something to whoever built the sheet — a Copilot prompt, and the next person who opens the file, both do better with `Size`, `Colourway`, `Unit Cost ($)` and `Unit Price ($)`.**

What "messy but human-readable" looks like next to what a Table gives you:

Common in real spreadsheets	What Copilot needs instead
Merged title cell across A1:F1	Title moved to a separate sheet or removed
"Q1" merged above three month columns	Flat headers: `Q1 Jan Units`, `Q1 Feb Units`
Blank row between US regions	Continuous rows, with a `Region` column
Colour-coding to mean "at risk"	A real `Status` column with the word "At Risk"
`$14.50 *est` typed into a cell	`14.50` in the cell, `est` in a `Notes` column
Numbers stored as text (green triangle)	Converted to true numbers
Multiple mini-tables on one sheet	One table per sheet

Rows vs columns. Copilot reasons in records. Every row should be one thing that happened — one size/colourway combination for one state's Pashun Pro Tee launch. Ridgeline's export mixes a title row, a totals row and a placeholder value into that same block, which is exactly what a first tidy-up removes.

Naming matters more than you think. Copilot grounds on your header text. `Sz` and `Colour` tell it far less than `Size` and `Colourway` do. Rename the Table itself too (Table Design → Table Name) — `USForecast` beats `Table1`.

Give the cloud a moment after a big structural change. After you convert a fixed-up range into a Table and save, it's worth a short pause and a reopen from the cloud location before you judge whether Copilot has picked up the new shape — treat it as a sensible habit rather than a guaranteed fixed delay, since Microsoft doesn't publish an exact figure for it.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens the file Ridgeline Apparel Supply sent to Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance), which she then forwarded to him — Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast (Before Cleanup - Practice Copy).xlsx — because he needs clean, trustworthy numbers from it before it feeds the Pashun Pro Tee US launch forecast.

1. **Look at the mess first. The `US Forecast` tab has a merged title row across A1:G1, a blank spacer row splitting the state blocks, a "Grand Total" row sitting inside the data instead of below it, two cells reading "TBC (Ridgeline)" where a Units figure should be, and a Cost column stored as text. Headers read `State`, `Sz`, `Colour`, `Units`, `Cost`, `Price`, `Margin` — workable for Ridgeline's own team, but vague and inconsistent for anyone else.**
2. **Diagnosing. Paul walks the sheet top to bottom: unmerge A1:G1, delete the spacer row, spot the green "number stored as text" triangles in the Cost column, and find the stray Grand Total row sitting inside the data block.**
3. **Fixing. Cells unmerged; title moved above the data with a clear boundary *outside* the intended table; the Grand Total row moved below the data; the two "TBC (Ridgeline)" cells left as a genuine blank with a short note added in a new `Notes` column rather than guessed at; the Cost column converted from text to numbers with Convert to Number; headers renamed to `US State`, `Size`, `Colourway`, `Units Forecast`, `Unit Cost ($)`, `Unit Price ($)`, `Notes`. Paul also flags that the state names themselves are a mix of full names, two-letter codes and inconsistent casing ("TX", "new york ", "NY", "FL", "Illinois ", "GA") — exactly the**

kind of thing that will matter once he starts asking Copilot state-by-state questions in later lectures, and asks Copilot to standardise them: *"Standardise the US State column so every row uses the full, correctly capitalised state name, with no leading or trailing spaces."* He reviews each proposed change before accepting it.

4. **Converting to a Table. Ctrl+T, "My table has headers", then Table Design → Table Name → `USForecast`.**
5. **Saving and syncing. Paul saves the cleaned-up file back to the SharePoint team site rather than a local Downloads folder, so Copilot is working from the cloud copy.**
6. **Checking the work. Paul re-asks the question he'd have wanted answered from the start: *"Which US state has the highest forecast units for the Pashun Pro Tee, and what is the total forecast margin for that state?"* With the sheet now a clean Table, Copilot returns a ranked answer with figures and offers to add a formula column — Paul accepts one suggestion to show that Table structure is what makes an inserted column land cleanly in every row.**
7. **A closing habit. Paul reminds the room that Copilot in Excel analyses the sheet you're actually sitting on — click into the tab you mean to ask about before you prompt, especially in a multi-tab workbook like this one.**

✅ Summary

- A genuinely messy real-world file — merges, spacer rows, a totals row inside the data, placeholder text, text-stored numbers, inconsistent state names — is common, and it's worth fixing before you build a habit of prompting around it.
- The fastest single fix is Ctrl+T — convert your range to a proper Excel Table with one clean header row, then give it a meaningful name.
- Merged cells inside the data, blank spacer rows, mixed data types, inconsistent text values and totals rows buried in the middle are the habits worth breaking first.
- Work from a file saved to OneDrive or SharePoint — Copilot in Excel needs a cloud-hosted file, not a local-only copy.
- Copilot analyses the sheet you are standing on — always click into the correct tab before you prompt.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open one real working spreadsheet of your own — ideally one you already suspect is messy — and save a copy to OneDrive or SharePoint so you can experiment safely.
2. Run through the checklist: cloud-saved file, formatted as a Table, one header row, merges and spacer rows removed from the data area, one data type per column, no totals or notes rows inside the block.
3. Fix every issue you find. Unmerge, delete spacers, move commentary into a `Notes` column, convert text-numbers, standardise any inconsistent text values, and rename vague headers into plain business English.
4. Press Ctrl+T, confirm headers, and give the Table a real name in Table Design.
5. Ask Copilot one question you genuinely want answered from that data — for example, "Which product line had the highest total margin last quarter?"
6. Write down the question you couldn't answer confidently before your clean-up, and the answer you got after. That before/after is the evidence you will need when you ask your own team to change how they build spreadsheets.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 31: How to Clean Up a Messy Spreadsheet So Copilot Can Actually Work With It and use the Copilot-Ready Data Checklist (7-Point Audit) together with the two practice files, Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast (Before Cleanup - Practice Copy).xlsx and the clean US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, so you can fix the messy version yourself before comparing it to the finished one.

Lecture 32: How to Ask Plain-English Questions About a Spreadsheet and Get Real Answers

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will stop writing formulas to find things out and start simply *asking* — typing plain-English questions straight into Copilot in Excel and getting real, grounded answers from your own data. We'll use the **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** workbook to ask the kinds of questions Paul actually gets asked by the business: which US state sells most, where stock is thin, and what the forecast is really telling us.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot in Excel reads your data, not your file. It works with the cells, columns and headers in the sheet you have open. It is not guessing from general knowledge — the answer comes from your numbers.**
- **It works best on structured data — the same Table setup from Lecture 31: one clean header row, no merged cells or blank rows inside the range, one value per cell. If Copilot won't engage with your prompt, check this first.**
- **The file needs to be saved to OneDrive or SharePoint. A local file on your C: drive will not be grounded.**
- **Three kinds of questions you can ask:**

Question type	What Copilot does	Example against the Pashun workbook
Understand	Explains what's in the sheet in plain English	"Summarise what this data shows me."
Analyse	Finds patterns, outliers, totals, comparisons — returns an answer in chat	"Which three US states have the highest forecast units for the Pashun Pro Tee?"
Act	Changes the sheet — adds a formula column, highlights, sorts, filters	"Add a column showing margin per unit as a percentage of price."

- **Ask for the answer, not the method. "Which colourway has the lowest stock cover?" beats "Write me a VLOOKUP".**

- **Copilot shows its working. When it creates a formula column it tells you the formula it used and asks you to accept it. Read it before you click + Add to sheet — this is your fact-check moment, exactly as covered in *Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice*.**
- **One honest limit worth remembering: Copilot will not invent data it cannot see. If a figure genuinely isn't anywhere in the workbook, it can't hand it to you — the fix is adding the data, not rewording the prompt.**

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx from the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site, with the US Forecast tab active. Ahead of the Monthly US Sales Review, he wants his own answer before he sits down with Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance): *"Before the Monthly US Sales Review, tell me where the Pashun Pro Tee is actually selling and where we're going to run short."*

1. **Fix the foundation first. Paul selects the data range and presses Ctrl+T to convert it to a proper Excel Table, confirming the header row, and checks the file is saved to the SharePoint site.**
2. **Orientation question. He clicks the Copilot button on the Home ribbon and types: *"Summarise what this data shows, column by column, in plain English."* Copilot describes the size, colourway, stock and forecast columns — useful when you've inherited a workbook you didn't build.**
3. **The business question. *"Which US states have the highest forecast units for the Pashun Pro Tee, and which are the lowest three?"* Copilot answers in the side pane with a ranked list.**
4. **The follow-up. Paul keeps the thread going: *"Now show me which of those low states still has more than 500 units of stock allocated."* He points out that Copilot remembers the previous answer — you don't have to restate the whole question.**
5. **An "act" prompt. *"Add a column called Stock Cover showing stock units divided by forecast units, to one decimal place."* Copilot proposes the formula, Paul reads it aloud, checks one row manually against a calculator, then clicks + Add to sheet.**
6. **A working margin question. Paul asks *"What's our margin per unit?"* The workbook already has both a Unit Cost and a Unit Price column, so Copilot computes it directly and correctly — a good moment to show that Copilot will happily calculate from columns that already exist, without you writing the subtraction yourself.**
7. **Close the loop. He copies the ranked-state answer into an email to Morgan, so the analysis lands where the business actually needs it.**

✅ Summary

- Copilot in Excel answers questions about *your* data — it is not a search engine and it will not invent figures it cannot see.
- Format your range as an Excel Table and save it to OneDrive or SharePoint before you expect Copilot to engage properly.
- Ask business questions in plain English ("which state sells most?"), not technical instructions ("write me a formula").
- Always read the formula Copilot proposes and spot-check one row before adding it to the sheet.
- Conversations are threaded — ask a broad question first, then narrow it with follow-ups rather than one giant prompt.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open any real spreadsheet of your own that lives in OneDrive or SharePoint.
2. Select your data and press **Ctrl+T** to format it as a table with headers.
3. Open Copilot from the Home ribbon and ask: *"Summarise what this data shows, column by column."*
4. Ask one genuine business question you would normally have to build a pivot table to answer — for example "Which product line has the highest total value?"
5. Ask one "act" prompt that adds a calculated column, then manually check the formula against a single row before accepting it.
6. Ask a question that draws on a column that genuinely exists in your data, and one that draws on a figure that genuinely doesn't. Note which one Copilot answers and which it correctly won't invent. Bring both to the next lecture.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 32: How to Ask Plain-English Questions About a Spreadsheet and Get Real Answers and use the Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx practice workbook together with the Excel Plain-English Question Bank (25 ready-to-use analysis prompts) and the Copilot-Ready Spreadsheet Checklist.

Lecture 33: How to Create Formulas and Calculated Columns Without Knowing Any Formula Syntax

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will get Microsoft 365 Copilot to write, insert and explain Excel formulas for you — in plain English — so you can build calculated columns like margin per unit, margin percentage and revenue per US state without ever memorising a single piece of formula syntax. By the end you will be able to describe the number you want in business language and let Copilot construct the formula, place it in the right column, and tell you exactly what it does.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot in Excel works best on a proper Excel table, the same setup from Lecture 31 (Ctrl+T, one header row, no blank rows inside it). It can act on a plain range too, but a named Table gives it a far more reliable structure to work from — check this first if Copilot struggles to engage with your prompt.**
- **The file needs to be saved in OneDrive or SharePoint. Copilot in Excel works against the cloud copy of the workbook.**
- **Two different jobs, two different outcomes.** "Add a column that…" creates a new calculated column. "What is the…" or "Show me…" returns an answer, a chart or a PivotTable suggestion but changes nothing.

- **Copilot proposes, you approve.** Copilot shows you a preview card with the suggested formula and a short explanation. Nothing is written to the sheet until you click **+ Insert column**. This is your safety net — read the formula before you accept it.
- **Copilot uses structured references — Excel's way of naming a column by its header text instead of a cell address like D2. Instead of `=D2*E2` you will see something like `=[@[Unit Price ($)]]-[@[Unit Cost ($)]]` — using your exact column headers. This is normal, it is more readable, and it auto-fills down the whole column.**
- **Plain English in, syntax out.** You never type a function name. You describe the calculation, the columns involved, and the format you want the answer in.

What you say to Copilot	What Copilot builds	Excel function behind it
"Add a column showing unit price minus unit cost, called Margin per Unit"	Simple arithmetic column	Basic subtraction with structured references
"Add a column showing margin per unit as a percentage of unit price"	Percentage calculation	Division, formatted as %
"Add a column that flags any state where units sold is below 200 as 'Under Target'"	Conditional text column	`IF`
"Add a column that pulls the region for each state from the Sales Summary tab"	Lookup column	`XLOOKUP`
"Add a column showing forecast revenue, rounded to whole dollars"	Multiplication plus rounding	`ROUND`
"Explain the formula in column H"	Plain-English explanation	No change to sheet

- **Ambiguity is the enemy.** "Add a margin column" may produce gross margin, percentage margin, or a blank. "Add a column called Margin per Unit that subtracts Unit Cost from Unit Price and formats the result as US dollars" produces exactly one thing.
- **Always fact-check the first row.** Take one row, do the maths on a calculator or in your head, and confirm Copilot's output matches. Copilot can pick the wrong column if two have similar names.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in the live Pashun Sports workbook **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx**, stored on the Pashun Consulting Ltd tenant, using the **US Forecast** tab for the Pashun Pro Tee launch.

1. **Prepare the data. Paul selects the US Forecast range, presses Ctrl+T to convert it to a table, and confirms the file is saved to the cloud. He points out the existing columns: US State, Size, Colourway, Units Forecast, Unit Cost ($), Unit Price ($), Stock on Hand.**
2. **First calculated column — margin per unit. In the Copilot pane he types: *"Add a column called Margin per Unit that subtracts Unit Cost from Unit Price. Format it as US dollars."* Copilot resolves "Unit Cost" and "Unit Price" against the real headers and returns a preview card showing `=[@[Unit Price ($)]]-[@[Unit Cost ($)]]`. Paul reads the formula out loud, checks row 2 by hand, then clicks + Insert column.**

3. **Second column — margin percentage.** *"Add a column called Margin % showing Margin per Unit divided by Unit Price, formatted as a percentage with one decimal place."* Paul shows how Copilot happily builds on the column it just created.
4. **Third column — forecast revenue.** *"Add a column called Forecast Revenue that multiplies Units Forecast by Unit Price, rounded to whole dollars."* He highlights that `ROUND` appeared without him ever knowing the function name.
5. **A conditional column.** *"Add a column called Launch Flag that shows 'Priority State' where Forecast Revenue is above 25,000 and 'Standard' otherwise."* Copilot produces an `IF` formula. Paul demonstrates the fact-check: he sorts by Forecast Revenue and visually confirms the cut-off lands where it should.
6. **A lookup across tabs — a lookup simply means asking Excel to find a value in one place (a US state, on this tab) and pull back a related value sitting somewhere else (its region, on the Sales Summary tab). *"Add a column called Region that looks up the US State in the Sales Summary tab and returns the matching region."* Paul shows the `XLOOKUP` formula it inserts — XLOOKUP is simply the modern Excel function that performs this kind of lookup — and explains why the values need to match exactly on both tabs: an entry like "GA" on one tab and "Georgia" on the other would silently fail to find a match.**
7. **Explain and undo.** Paul asks Copilot *"Explain the formula in the Margin % column in simple terms"* and gets a plain-English walkthrough he can paste into a note for Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance. He then deletes one column and re-creates it to prove how cheap mistakes are.
8. **The deliberate failure.** Paul asks vaguely: *"Add a margin column."* Copilot returns something unintended. He rewrites it precisely and the correct column appears — demonstrating that prompt quality, not Excel skill, is the real variable.

✅ Summary

- Copilot in Excel works best on a formatted table saved in OneDrive or SharePoint.
- Describe the calculation, name the new column, and state the number format — precision in the prompt produces precision in the formula.
- Copilot previews the formula first; nothing changes until you click **+ Insert column**, so always read the formula before accepting.
- Structured references like `[@[Unit Price]]` are normal and auto-fill down the entire column.
- Ask Copilot to explain any formula in plain English — this is how you learn Excel while you work, and how you produce audit notes for finance colleagues.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open your own sales or cost spreadsheet in Excel on the web or desktop, saved to OneDrive or SharePoint, and convert the data range to a table with Ctrl+T.
2. Open the Copilot pane and ask it to add one simple arithmetic column — for example: *"Add a column called Margin per Unit that subtracts Unit Cost from Unit Price, formatted as currency."*
3. Read the previewed formula before inserting it, then hand-check the first row's result against your own calculation.
4. Ask for one conditional column using an "if… otherwise…" phrasing, such as flagging any row below a target as "Under Target".
5. Ask Copilot: *"Explain the formula in [your new column] in simple terms"* and save the explanation into your prompt library from Lecture 15: How to Use the Microsoft Prompt Gallery and Build Your Own Reusable Prompt Library.
6. Deliberately write one vague prompt, note what goes wrong, then rewrite it precisely — keep both versions as a personal reminder of what "specific" means.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 33: How to Create Formulas and Calculated Columns Without Knowing Any Formula Syntax and use the Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx practice workbook together with the Excel Calculated Column Prompt Card, which lists the exact wording for arithmetic, percentage, conditional and lookup columns.

Lecture 34: How to Highlight, Sort and Filter to Reveal Patterns in Your Sales Data

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you'll learn how to ask Copilot in Excel to **highlight, sort and filter** your data for you — in plain English — so that patterns in the Pashun Pro Tee US sales figures jump off the screen without you touching a single ribbon menu. This is the fastest, safest and most reliable thing Copilot does in Excel, and it's where every non-technical user should start.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot in Excel works most reliably on a proper Excel table — the same setup from Lecture 31. It can act on a plain range too, but a Table gives it cleaner boundaries, so format your range with Home → Format as Table, or Ctrl+T, whenever you can.**
- **Your file should be saved to OneDrive or SharePoint. Copilot works against the cloud copy of the workbook.**
- **Highlight = conditional formatting. Copilot writes the formatting rule for you and applies it. Example: "Highlight in green any US state where Pashun Pro Tee units forecast are above 800."**
- **Sort = reordering rows. Copilot can sort on one or multiple columns: "Sort by Unit Price, highest first, then by State A to Z."**
- **Filter = hiding rows that don't matter. Copilot applies a standard Excel filter you can clear at any time: "Show only rows where Units Forecast is under 300."**
- **These three actions are reversible and non-destructive.** Highlighting, sorting and filtering change how the data *looks*, not what it *is*. This is why they're the perfect first skill — you can't break anything.
- **Copilot tells you what it's about to do before doing it.** You'll always see a preview card with an **Apply** button. Read it. If it misread your column names, refine the prompt rather than accepting a wrong rule.

What you want	Say this to Copilot	What Excel actually does
Spot your best states	"Highlight the top 10 rows by Units Sold in green."	Adds a conditional formatting rule
Find weak margins	"Highlight any row where Margin Per Unit is below $4.00 in red."	Adds a conditional formatting rule

Rank performance	"Sort by Units Sold, largest to smallest."	Sorts the table
Focus on one region	"Filter to show only the Northeast region."	Applies a column filter
Combine conditions	"Show only states with Units Sold above 400 and Margin Per Unit above $5."	Applies a multi-column filter
Undo it all	"Clear all filters and remove the highlighting."	Removes filters and formatting rules

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx from the Pashun Sports SharePoint site, on the US Forecast tab, which holds the Pashun Pro Tee launch data by US state: US State, Size, Colourway, Units Forecast, Unit Cost ($), Unit Price ($) and Stock on Hand.

1. **Check the prerequisites. Paul confirms the file is in SharePoint and the data is a proper table with clean single-row headers. He deliberately clicks Copilot *before* formatting as a table so you see the prompt box behave differently — then fixes it with Ctrl+T so you recognise the fix in your own work.**
2. **Highlight the winners. Prompt: *"Highlight in green the rows where Units Forecast is greater than 800."* Copilot returns a preview card describing the conditional formatting rule. Paul clicks Apply — California and New York light up.**
3. **Highlight the problem. Prompt: *"Now highlight in red any row where Unit Cost ($) is above $6.00."* Several high-volume rows appear in red — high forecast units, but the most expensive unit cost to source, because of shipping from the Ridgeline Apparel Supply warehouse.**
4. **Sort to rank. Prompt: *"Sort the table by Unit Cost ($) from highest to lowest."* The most expensive states to supply rise to the top — a different list from the top-selling states.**
5. **Filter to focus. Prompt: *"Show only rows where Colourway is Navy and Units Forecast is above 500."* Paul notes the filter icons that appear in the header row — proof Copilot used standard Excel features, not something magical Jamie Jordan can't unpick later.**
6. **Refine a misread. Paul deliberately prompts *"highlight the expensive ones"* — vague. Copilot guesses a threshold. He corrects it: *"Highlight rows where Unit Cost ($) is above $6.00 in red."* Lesson: name the column, name the number, name the colour.**
7. **Reset cleanly. Prompt: *"Clear all filters and remove all highlighting from this table."* The sheet returns to its original state, ready to hand to Morgan Reyes for the Monthly US Sales Review.**

✅ Summary

- Copilot in Excel works best on data formatted as a table in a cloud-saved workbook — most "Copilot doesn't work" complaints trace back to one of these two things.
- Highlight, sort and filter are the safest Copilot Excel skills because they change presentation, not data, and are fully reversible.
- Name the **column**, the **number** and the **colour** in your prompt — vague prompts like "highlight the good ones" force Copilot to guess.

- Always read the preview card before clicking **Apply**; refine rather than accept a rule built on the wrong column.
- The real value is comparison: sorting by Units Forecast and then by Unit Cost ($) reveals that the biggest volume states aren't necessarily the cheapest to supply.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a sales or performance spreadsheet of your own from OneDrive or SharePoint (or the Pashun Sports US Forecast file from the handout pack).
2. Select your data range and press **Ctrl+T** to format it as a table with headers.
3. Prompt: *"Highlight in green the top 10 rows by [your volume column]."* Apply it.
4. Prompt: *"Now highlight in red any row where [your cost or margin column] is above [a specific number]."* Apply it.
5. Prompt: *"Sort by [your cost or margin column], highest to lowest."* Note which rows are green and red — these are your hidden problem accounts, products or regions.
6. Prompt: *"Clear all filters and remove all highlighting."* Confirm the sheet returns to normal.
7. Write down in one sentence the pattern you found that you had not noticed before — you'll use it in Lecture 35 when you ask Copilot to chart and summarise the numbers.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 34: How to Highlight, Sort and Filter to Reveal Patterns in Your Sales Data and use the Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx workbook (US Forecast tab) together with the Excel Highlight, Sort & Filter Prompt Card, which lists the exact prompt wording for all six actions demonstrated above.

Lecture 35: How to Generate Charts, PivotTables and Visual Summaries Instantly

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will turn raw rows of Pashun Sports sales data into charts, PivotTables and visual summaries in seconds — without touching the Insert ribbon, writing a formula, or knowing what a "value field setting" is. By the end you will be able to ask Copilot in Excel for a visual, judge whether it answered the right question, and drop it into a report you can send to Morgan Reyes.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Your data works best as a proper Excel table. Click any cell in your data, press Ctrl+T, tick *My table has headers*, and give the table a sensible name (Table Design ▸ Table Name ▸ `USForecast`). A plain range can work too, but a named Table removes the guesswork — the same habit from Lecture 31.**
- **Three output types you can ask for explicitly:**

Ask for this	You get	Best used for
"Show a chart of…"	A chart object inserted on the sheet	A single visual for a slide or email
"Create a PivotTable of…"	A new sheet with a live PivotTable	Data Morgan will want to slice herself
"Summarise this data"	A text summary + suggested insights in the Copilot pane	Understanding a file you did not build

- **Insights vs. instructions.** If you ask an open question ("what stands out in this data?"), Copilot returns *suggested insights* — trends, outliers, distributions — each with an **Add to a new sheet** button. If you give a precise instruction ("column chart of revenue by state, highest to lowest"), you get exactly that. Start open when you are exploring, be precise when you are producing.
- **Everything is editable afterwards.** A Copilot-generated PivotTable is an ordinary PivotTable; a Copilot chart is an ordinary chart. You can change the aggregation from Sum to Average, add a slicer, restyle it — Copilot just skips the ten clicks that get you there.
- **Copilot will not invent numbers, but it will mis-frame them. If your sheet mixes cost and price in adjacent columns, Copilot may chart the wrong one. Always check the axis labels and the field it used before you send anything to a stakeholder.**
- **Currency, dates and percentages need formatting first.** If a column of margin figures is stored as text or as a raw decimal, the chart will look absurd. Format the source column properly and Copilot inherits it.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`, on the US Forecast tab, which holds Pashun Pro Tee sales by US state, size, colourway, unit price and unit cost.

1. **Preparing the data. Paul shows the sheet as-is, clicks a cell and presses Ctrl+T, and names the table `USForecast`.**
2. **The open question. Prompt: *"What stands out in this data?"* Copilot returns suggested insights — the concentration of forecast units in a small number of states, and a colourway that appears less often. Paul clicks Add to a new sheet on one insight to show it becomes a real PivotChart, not a screenshot.**
3. **The precise instruction. Prompt: *"Create a column chart showing total units forecast by US state, sorted highest to lowest."* Paul checks the axis: Copilot has used Units Forecast, matching the prompt. He then deliberately runs a sloppier prompt, *"chart my sales,"* and shows Copilot having to guess which column "sales" means, to prove why naming the column matters.**
4. **The PivotTable. Prompt: *"Create a PivotTable of Unit Cost ($) by colourway and size, as an average."* Copilot builds it on a new sheet. Paul changes the aggregation to Average manually to show the PivotTable is fully live, then adds a slicer for state.**
5. **The summary for Morgan. Prompt: *"Summarise the top three states by Units Forecast and the state with the highest Unit Cost in four bullet points I can paste into an email to Morgan Reyes."* Paul copies the output straight into Outlook for the Monthly US Sales Review.**
6. **Comparing engines. Paul reminds the room that a Copilot-built chart or PivotTable is an ordinary, fully live Excel object — you can restyle it, re-aggregate it, or slice it yourself exactly as if you'd built it by hand.**

✅ Summary

- A clean, formatted Excel table (Ctrl+T) with a sensible name is the most reliable starting point for charts, PivotTables and summaries.
- Ask open questions to explore ("what stands out?"), give precise instructions to produce ("column chart of revenue by state, descending").
- Name the exact column you want measured; vague prompts make Copilot guess, and it often guesses units instead of revenue.
- Charts and PivotTables Copilot creates are fully live Excel objects you can restyle, re-aggregate and slice yourself.
- Always read the axis labels and field names before sending a visual to a stakeholder like Morgan Reyes — Copilot does not invent data, but it can measure the wrong thing.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open `**Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx**` (or your own sales file) and convert the main data range to a table with **Ctrl+T**, naming it clearly.
2. Open the Copilot pane and ask: *"What stands out in this data?"* Read the suggested insights and add one to a new sheet.
3. Now ask for something specific: *"Create a column chart of total forecast revenue by US state, sorted highest to lowest."*
4. Ask for a PivotTable: *"PivotTable of average margin per unit by colourway and size."* Then manually add a slicer for state to prove the object is live.
5. Finish with: *"Summarise the three strongest and one weakest performers in four bullets for a finance email."* Check every number against the sheet before you would actually send it.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 35: How to Generate Charts, PivotTables and Visual Summaries Instantly** and use the **Pashun Sports US Sales and Stock Forecast practice workbook** together with the **Excel Visuals Prompt Card** (chart, PivotTable and summary prompt templates); if your data still will not accept a prompt, revisit **Lecture 33: How to Ask Copilot Questions About Your Spreadsheet Data in Plain English** for the data-cleanup checklist.

Lecture 36: How to Use Copilot for Data Analysis (Advanced Analysis) on Messy Real-World Data

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Real business spreadsheets are messy — merged cells, blank rows, text stored as numbers, inconsistent state names — and that is exactly the kind of file Copilot's Advanced Analysis (Python-powered) capability is well suited to. In this lecture you will use it on a genuinely messy version of the Pashun Sports US sales workbook, clean up just enough of the data first, and produce answers you can actually put in front of Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Two different engines inside Copilot in Excel. Standard Copilot analysis writes native Excel formulas, PivotTables and conditional formatting into your sheet. Advanced Analysis sends your data to a sandboxed Python environment, runs real data-science code, and returns charts, tables and statistical output. Same chat box — very different capability.**
- **Use it for the heavier analysis jobs standard Excel isn't built for: spotting whether two figures move together (correlation) and projecting a likely future value from a trend (forecasting); finding the row that doesn't fit the rest of the data (outlier detection); grouping similar records together (clustering); and comparing several variables side by side at once (multi-variable comparison). It also draws chart types Excel doesn't offer out of the box: a box plot (shows the typical range of a set of numbers, plus anything unusual outside it), a heatmap (a grid coloured by value, so patterns jump out visually), and a scatter chart with a trend line (dots for each data point, with a line showing the overall direction).**
- **How to switch it on. It isn't a fixed toggle in the pane — it typically surfaces as a "Get deeper results using advanced analysis" suggestion under a normal Copilot answer, or you can ask for it directly by including "Enter advanced analysis mode" in your prompt. If neither shows up, Advanced Analysis may not be available on your licence or in your organisation — worth checking before you plan a whole lesson around it.**
- **The table rule. Copilot in Excel works dramatically better on data formatted as a proper Excel Table (Ctrl+T, as in Lecture 31): one header row, and as few blank rows, merges and buried totals rows as you can manage.**
- **Copilot can help clean the data it is about to analyse. You do not have to fix everything by hand — you can ask Copilot to flag problems first, then fix them, then analyse.**
- **Advanced Analysis can write live results back into the workbook. It can insert its output as a new worksheet with refreshable Python-backed cells, not just a static picture — so it's worth checking, after you change an underlying number, whether the analysis tab you asked for updates.**

Task	Use Standard Copilot	Use Advanced Analysis
Add a margin % column that recalculates	✅	❌
Highlight states below target	✅	⚠️ Possible, but not live
Find which variables correlate with unit sales	❌	✅
Forecast Q3 US sales from 6 months of history	⚠️ Basic trend only	✅
Spot statistical outliers in margin per unit	❌	✅
Build a heatmap of sales by state and size	❌	✅
Produce an output that survives a data refresh	✅	❌

- **Data residency and governance. Advanced Analysis runs in a Microsoft-hosted secure container; the data is not used to train models and the container is discarded after the**

session. Still, treat it as you would any cloud processing — check your organisation's policy before running payroll, health or customer-identifiable data through it.

- **Common messy-data problems to expect: numbers stored as text (`"1,250"` rather than `1250`), state names entered several different ways (`TX`, `Texas`, `new york `, `NY`), and trailing spaces. Any one of these can quietly skew a result if you don't clean it up first.**

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in the deliberately messy `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast (Before Cleanup - Practice Copy).xlsx`, on the US Forecast tab, playing the role of the person who has to report US launch numbers for the Pashun Pro Tee to Morgan Reyes before the Monthly US Sales Review.

1. **Open the workbook and look at the mess. The tab has a merged title across the top, a blank spacer row splitting the data, a Grand Total row sitting inside the block, and state names entered inconsistently — `TX`, `new york `, `NY`, `FL`, `Illinois `, `GA` alongside full names like `California`. Paul walks through exactly why this makes analysis harder than it needs to be.**
2. **Ask Copilot to audit the data first. Prompt: *"Review the data on this sheet and list every data quality problem you can find — inconsistent values, blank rows, numbers stored as text, a totals row inside the data. Don't change anything yet, just list the issues."***
3. **Fix the structural blockers by hand (a couple of minutes). Unmerge the title, delete the blank row, move the Grand Total row out of the data block, then Ctrl+T to convert the range to a proper Excel Table named `USForecast`.**
4. **Let Copilot fix the content problems. Prompt: *"Standardise the US State column so every value uses the full, correctly capitalised US state name with no leading or trailing spaces, and convert the Cost column from text to numbers."* Paul reviews each suggested change before accepting — this is the point where blindly clicking Apply gets you into trouble.**
5. **Switch to Advanced Analysis. In the Copilot pane, Paul types *"Enter advanced analysis mode. Using this table, calculate the margin per unit for each US state as Unit Price minus Unit Cost, weighted by Units Forecast. Show a table and a chart."***
6. **Go further than Excel can. Prompt: *"Test for statistical outliers in margin per unit by state using the 1.5×IQR method, and explain the findings plainly."* Copilot returns the working, the fences it used, and a plain-English interpretation — and it's a genuinely useful result even when the honest answer is that nothing in the data is a formal outlier: that's still a finding Morgan can act on.**
7. **Check the working. Paul asks Copilot to confirm which columns it used in its calculation, and reviews the new worksheet it inserted — a live, refreshable result rather than a static picture — before trusting a number enough to put it in front of Morgan.**
8. **Get the output out of Excel.** Paul asks Copilot to summarise the three key findings in plain business English, then copies the charts and summary into an email to Morgan Reyes — closing the loop back to Section 4's Outlook work.

Paul's real-world note: during build, Copilot's grounding behaved inconsistently across file types, and one failure traced back to an actually corrupted file. If Copilot repeatedly says it cannot read a workbook that looks fine, save a fresh copy to OneDrive, let it finish syncing, and try again before assuming it is a Copilot limitation.

✅ Summary

- **Advanced Analysis is a different engine — it runs Python in a secure sandbox and delivers statistics, outlier testing and chart types standard Excel Copilot doesn't easily produce, and it isn't a simple toggle in the pane, so check it's available on your licence before you plan around it.**
- **Structure still helps. A proper Excel Table with one header row and as few merges, blanks and buried totals rows as possible makes any Copilot analysis more reliable.**
- **Use Copilot to clean the data before Copilot analyses it — audit first, fix structure by hand, let Copilot standardise the content, review every change.**
- **Advanced Analysis can write a live, refreshable result back into the workbook as a new worksheet — check whether it updates after you change an underlying figure, rather than assuming it's a one-off snapshot.**
- **Always check the working. Confirm which columns were used before trusting a result — a silently wrong column gives a confident, wrong answer.**

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open the deliberately messy Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast (Before Cleanup - Practice Copy).xlsx from your handout pack (or your own messy sales workbook) and go to the US Forecast tab.
2. Ask Copilot: *"List every data quality issue on this sheet — inconsistent values, blanks, numbers stored as text, a totals row inside the data. Do not change anything yet."*
3. Fix the structural issues yourself: unmerge, delete blank rows, move any totals out of the data block, then press Ctrl+T to create a proper Excel Table.
4. Ask Copilot to standardise one inconsistent text column and convert one text-stored-number column to real numbers. Review each change before accepting.
5. Type "Enter advanced analysis mode" and ask Copilot to calculate margin per unit by state and show it as a table and chart.
6. Run one genuinely advanced prompt: *"Test margin per unit by state for statistical outliers using the 1.5×IQR method and explain the result in plain English"* — even a "no outliers found" result is a valid, useful finding.
7. Confirm which columns Copilot used before trusting the result. If it chose the wrong one, re-prompt naming the exact column header.
8. Finish by asking Copilot to summarise the three most important findings in five bullet points a Head of Finance could read in 30 seconds.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 36: How to Use Copilot for Data Analysis (Advanced Analysis) on Messy Real-World Data and use the deliberately messy Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast (Before Cleanup - Practice Copy).xlsx together with the Advanced Analysis Prompt Card — and if you need a refresher on prompt structure before you start, revisit Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim.

Lecture 37: How to Build a Monthly Sales Report Your Boss Will Actually Read

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will turn a raw Excel workbook into a monthly sales report that a busy director will actually read — a short written summary, three defensible numbers, and one chart — using Copilot in Excel plus Copilot Chat. You will learn the difference between *analysing* data and *reporting* on it, and why that difference is where most monthly reports fall apart.

💬 Core Concepts

- **A report is not a data dump.** Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) wants the workbook. Paul Ashun (Founder & Director) wants four sentences and a number he can act on. Copilot can produce both from the same source — but only if you tell it which audience you are writing for.
- **The three-layer report structure. Every readable monthly report has: (1) the headline — what the numbers show right now; (2) the standouts — which states or products are driving it, and which are lagging; (3) the ask — what decision or action you need from the reader. Build your prompts to produce those three layers, in that order.**
- **Copilot in Excel does the maths; Copilot Chat does the prose.** In-grid Copilot is strongest at formula columns, sorting, highlighting and native charts. For the written narrative, it is usually cleaner to ask Copilot Chat (or Copilot in Word) to read the workbook and write the summary, because you get more control over tone and length.
- **Ground every sentence in a cell.** If Copilot writes "Texas is our strongest state", you must be able to point at the row that proves it. Anything Copilot asserts that you cannot trace back to the workbook gets cut — see Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice.
- **One chart, not six.** Ask Copilot for the single chart that supports the headline. Extra charts dilute the message and invite questions you did not come to answer.
- **Format the numbers before you summarise. Copilot summarises what it sees. If a cost figure is sitting as `6.24` in a column labelled `Cost` with no currency format, expect sentences that read badly and numbers that get misquoted in the next meeting.**

Report element	Best tool	Typical prompt shape
Totals, growth %, margin columns	Copilot in Excel (grid)	"Add a column showing month-on-month % change in units sold."
Ranking and outliers	Copilot in Excel (grid)	"Which US states are in the top 5 by revenue and which fell furthest?"
Single supporting chart	Copilot in Excel (grid)	"Create a bar chart of revenue by US state, sorted descending."
150-word written summary	Copilot Chat / Copilot in Word	"Summarise this workbook for a non-financial director in under 150 words."
Recommended actions	Copilot Chat	"Based on this data, list three decisions the founder needs to make this month."

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, on the US Forecast tab, and builds the monthly launch report for the Pashun Pro Tee.

1. **Prepare the data. Paul confirms the sales range is a proper Excel table, checks that cost and price columns are formatted as currency, and fixes any state names that are inconsistent — Copilot will treat "TX" and "Texas" as two different states.**
2. **Build the numbers with in-grid Copilot. He prompts: *"Add a column showing Margin per Unit in dollars, and a column showing Forecast Revenue as Units Forecast multiplied by Unit Price."* He reviews the suggested formulas before clicking Keep.**
3. **Find the story. Next prompt: *"Which three US states have the highest forecast revenue, and which three have the lowest margin per unit? Show the figures."* Copilot highlights the rows; Paul notes that the headline is revenue concentrated in a small number of states, while margin tells a different story.**
4. **Create the one chart. *"Create a bar chart of forecast revenue by US state, sorted highest to lowest."* Paul deletes Copilot's suggested second chart — it does not support the headline.**
5. **Write the narrative. Paul switches to Copilot Chat and prompts with the file attached: *"You are a finance-literate business writer. Using Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, write a 150-word launch summary for the founder of a US sports-apparel brand who is not a numbers person. Structure it as: headline result, the standout states, then three decisions I need from him. Plain English, no jargon, no bullet padding."***
6. **Fact-check line by line. Paul takes each figure in Copilot's draft and traces it back to a cell. One state's revenue figure in the draft doesn't match the sheet — he corrects it and re-prompts with the exact column named explicitly.**
7. **Assemble and send. He pastes the summary into the body of an email to Paul-as-Founder (not as an attachment nobody opens), embeds the single chart, and attaches the workbook for Morgan Reyes, who *does* want the detail.**

Throughout, Paul flags the practical trap: if the workbook has recently been edited, Copilot may read an older indexed version. Save, close, reopen, and check one known figure before trusting the summary.

✅ Summary

- A monthly report that gets read is three layers: the headline, the movement, and the ask — in that order.
- Use in-grid Copilot for calculations, ranking and the chart; use Copilot Chat for the written narrative and recommended actions.
- Clean and format the data *before* summarising — bad formatting produces bad sentences and misquoted numbers.
- Every claim in the summary must trace back to a specific cell; cut anything you cannot prove.
- One chart that supports the headline beats six charts that dilute it.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx (or your own sales workbook) and confirm the data is a formatted table with clean, consistent labels.
2. Use in-grid Copilot to add a Margin per Unit column and a Forecast Revenue column.
3. Ask Copilot to create one chart that supports whatever the data's main story is.

4. In Copilot Chat, generate a 150-word summary structured as headline, standouts, three decisions — written for a non-financial reader.
5. Fact-check every number in the draft against a cell. Rewrite or re-prompt anything you cannot verify.
6. Paste the final summary into the body of an email, embed the chart, and attach the workbook.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 37: How to Build a Monthly Sales Report Your Boss Will Actually Read** and use the **Monthly Sales Report Prompt Set** and the **Three-Layer Report Template**, alongside the sample workbook **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx**.

Lecture 38: How to Create a Full Presentation From a Prompt, a Word Document or a PDF

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will build a complete, presentable PowerPoint deck three different ways — from a plain prompt, from an existing Word document, and from a PDF — and learn which of the three to reach for depending on what you already have. By the end you will have turned the Pashun Sports Pro Tee range brief into a full investor-ready deck without writing a single slide by hand.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot in PowerPoint starts with a deck, not a blank void.** Create a new presentation (or open an existing one), then open the Copilot pane from the Home ribbon. The three headline commands are *Create presentation from file*, *Create presentation about…*, and *Add a slide about…*.
- **"Create presentation from file" is almost always the better option.** Generating from a prompt alone gives Copilot no business context — it will invent plausible but generic content. Generating from your own Word document or PDF grounds every slide in facts you already approved.
- **Word headings become slide structure.** Copilot reads your Word document's heading hierarchy to decide slide breaks. A brief written as one long wall of text produces a flat, poorly-divided deck. Heading 1 and Heading 2 styles produce clean sections. This is the single biggest quality lever you control.
- **PDFs work, but only text-layer PDFs.** A supplier spec sheet exported from Word or InDesign will generate fine. A scanned or photographed PDF has no extractable text and Copilot will either fail or produce near-empty slides.
- **Templates must exist before you generate.** Copilot applies the theme of the deck you are working in. If you start from a blank default presentation you get Microsoft's stock look. Start from your organisation's branded template and the generated deck inherits your fonts, colours and slide masters automatically.
- **Length is a request, not a guarantee.** Asking for "about 20 slides" gets you approximately that. Copilot decides final structure based on source content volume.
- **Everything generated is fully editable.** These are real PowerPoint slides with real text boxes and real layouts — not images. Nothing is locked.

Starting point	Command to use	Best for	Main risk
Nothing but an idea	Create presentation about…	Early-stage brainstorming, training decks, internal explainers	Generic, unverified content — every fact needs checking
A Word document	Create presentation from file → select .docx	Turning an approved brief, report or proposal into a deck	Poor heading structure produces poor slide breaks

A PDF	Create presentation from file → select .pdf	Supplier specs, third-party reports, published documents	Scanned PDFs have no text layer and will fail
An existing deck	Add a slide about…	Extending or patching a deck you already have	Can drift from the tone of surrounding slides

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant as Paul Ashun, Founder & Director, preparing a pitch deck for the Pashun Pro Tee US launch.

1. **Method one — from a prompt.** Paul opens a blank presentation, opens the Copilot pane and asks: *"Create a presentation about launching a new performance-blend sports t-shirt in the US market, covering market opportunity, product positioning, pricing and launch timeline. About 12 slides."* Copilot returns a structured deck in roughly a minute. Paul walks through it and points out the problem — the slides are competent and completely generic. No mention of the Pro Tee, no mention of Ridgeline Apparel Supply, no real numbers. Useful as a skeleton, useless as a pitch.
2. **Method two — from a Word document.** Paul closes that deck, opens `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx` (which already carries the Pashun Sports brand template), and in the Copilot pane chooses **Create presentation from file**. He selects `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` from OneDrive and adds the instruction: *"Create a presentation for potential US wholesale buyers from this brief. About 20 slides. Include the fabric specification, sizing range and launch timeline. Keep the tone confident and commercial."*
3. **Reviewing the result.** Copilot produces a full deck with a title slide, agenda, section dividers and speaker notes on most slides. Paul opens the Notes pane to show that Copilot has written a talk track, not just bullets. He compares two slides — one generated from a properly styled Heading 2 section of the brief, one from a paragraph-heavy section — to demonstrate visibly how heading structure drives slide quality.
4. **Method three — from a PDF.** Paul selects the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric spec PDF and generates a short internal technical deck from it, showing that the same command handles PDFs identically. He then tries it with a scanned image-only PDF and shows the near-empty result, so students recognise the failure mode when it happens to them.
5. **First-pass clean-up.** Paul deletes three redundant slides, reorders two using Slide Sorter, and shows that the branded theme has carried through every generated slide — no manual reformatting required. He flags that refining slide content, rewriting individual slides and restructuring the deck are covered in the lectures that follow in this section.
6. **The honest caveat.** Paul checks two figures on the pricing slide against the source brief. Copilot has summarised accurately here, but he stresses the rule from Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice: every number that leaves your building gets verified against source.

✅ Summary

- Copilot in PowerPoint generates from a prompt, a Word document or a PDF — generating from your own file is almost always the better result because it is grounded in facts you already approved.
- Open your branded template *before* you generate, so the deck inherits your fonts, colours and layouts automatically.

- Word heading structure directly controls slide breaks — a well-styled brief produces a well-structured deck.
- PDFs must have a real text layer; scanned or photographed PDFs will not generate usable slides.
- Copilot also writes speaker notes, and everything it produces is fully editable PowerPoint — treat the output as a strong first draft, never a finished deliverable.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Find a Word document you already own that is at least three pages long — a report, proposal, brief or project summary.
2. Open it and check the heading styles. If it uses plain bold text instead of Heading 1 and Heading 2, spend five minutes applying proper heading styles.
3. Open your organisation's branded PowerPoint template (or a blank deck if you don't have one), open the Copilot pane from the Home ribbon and choose **Create presentation from file**.
4. Select your document and add a specific instruction naming the audience, the approximate slide count and the tone — for example: *"Create a presentation for our senior leadership team from this report. About 15 slides. Focus on findings and recommendations. Keep the tone factual and concise."*
5. When it finishes, open the Notes pane and read the speaker notes on three slides.
6. Write down two things Copilot got right and two things you would change — you will fix exactly those in Lecture 39 onwards.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 38: How to Create a Full Presentation From a Prompt, a Word Document or a PDF** and use **`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`** together with the **Deck Generation Prompt Card** and the **Heading Structure Checklist** so you can run all three generation methods against the same source material Paul uses in the demo.

Lecture 39: How to Apply Your Brand Template So Every Deck Looks Like Your Business

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot can build a deck in ninety seconds, but by default it will build it in *Microsoft's* look, not yours. In this lecture you will learn how to make Copilot generate presentations that already carry the Pashun Sports brand — fonts, colours, logo, slide layouts — so no one ever has to spend an afternoon reformatting a deck again.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot does not invent design — it fills in a template.** When Copilot creates slides it uses the layouts already present in the file's Slide Master. If the Slide Master is the default Office theme, you

get default Office slides. If the Slide Master is your brand template, you get brand slides from the very first generation.

- **Three ways to get your brand into a Copilot deck**, in order of reliability:

Method	How it works	Best for
Start from the template	Open your branded `.potx` or branded `.pptx`, then ask Copilot to create the presentation inside it	New decks — most reliable, brand applied from slide one
Organisation templates	IT publishes the template to the Office template gallery / SharePoint Organisation Asset Library so it appears under **File > New > Your Organisation**	Teams and businesses with a tenant admin
Apply after generation	Generate first, then use **Designer**, **Design Ideas** or **Slide Master** to reapply theme	Rescue job on an existing deck — often leaves stray formatting

- **`.potx` vs `.pptx`.** A `.potx` is a PowerPoint *template* file. Opening it creates a fresh copy rather than editing the original, which stops your team overwriting the master. A branded `.pptx` works too, but everyone must remember to "Save As".
- **The Slide Master is where the brand actually lives.** View > Slide Master holds your theme fonts (e.g. Pashun Sports headings in Montserrat, body in Open Sans), your colour palette (Pashun red #C8102E, charcoal, off-white), your logo placement and your layout set. Copilot writes content *into* these layouts.
- **Layout names matter to Copilot.** If your layouts are named meaningfully — *Title Slide*, *Section Header*, *Two Content*, *Image Left / Text Right*, *Data Slide* — Copilot maps its generated content onto them far more sensibly than if they are named Custom Layout 1–12.
- **Copilot will not create your template for you.** Brand templates are a design task. Copilot's job is to populate one consistently. Build it once, reuse it forever.
- **Watch the brand drift risks:** Copilot-inserted stock images, Designer suggestions that recolour outside your palette, and pasted-in charts from Excel that carry Excel's default colours rather than yours.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works with the Pashun Sports **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch deck (`Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx`), which currently exists as a handful of unbranded default-theme slides.

1. **Build the template.** Paul opens PowerPoint, goes to **View > Slide Master**, and sets the Pashun Sports theme: Montserrat for headings, Open Sans for body, the Pashun red and charcoal colour palette, and the Pashun Sports logo positioned bottom-right on every layout except the title slide. He renames the layouts clearly — *Pashun Title*, *Pashun Section Header*, *Pashun Two Content*, *Pashun Data*, *Pashun Product Shot*.
2. **Save it properly.** File > Save As > **PowerPoint Template (.potx)**, named `Pashun Sports - Brand Template.potx`, saved to the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** Team site so Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes both use the same one.
3. **Generate inside the template.** Paul opens the template (which creates a new untitled deck already carrying the brand), opens Copilot and prompts:

"Create a 12-slide investor-facing presentation for the Pashun Pro Tee US launch. Use the Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx as the source. Cover: the product, the performance-blend fabric, the Ridgeline Apparel Supply partnership, target US states, pricing and margin, launch timeline and the ask. Keep one idea per slide with short headline-style titles."

The deck comes back **already in Pashun red and Montserrat**, with the logo on every slide — no reformatting.

1. **Compare side by side.** Paul runs the same prompt in a blank default deck so students can see the difference in one glance: identical content, completely different professional impression.
2. **Rescue the existing deck.** For `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx`, which was already built unbranded, Paul demonstrates the retrofit: **Design > Browse for Themes**, selecting the Pashun template, then fixing the two slides where text boxes had been dragged off-layout. He points out the honest trade-off — retrofitting is ten minutes of clean-up, starting from the template is zero.
3. **Guard the brand.** Paul asks Copilot to *"replace the stock imagery on slides 4 and 7 with placeholders for our own product photography"* and shows how to reset a Designer-recoloured slide back to the theme palette using **Home > Reset**.

✅ Summary

- Copilot generates content into whatever Slide Master the file already has — brand the file first, prompt second.
- Save your brand as a `.potx` template on a shared Team site so every colleague generates from the same source of truth.
- Name your slide layouts descriptively; Copilot maps generated content onto well-named layouts far more intelligently.
- Retrofitting a brand onto a finished deck via Design > Browse for Themes works, but always leaves clean-up — starting from the template does not.
- Stock images, Designer suggestions and pasted Excel charts are the three most common causes of brand drift in a Copilot-generated deck.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a presentation that already looks the way your organisation's decks should look — or build one quickly in **View > Slide Master** with your fonts, two brand colours and your logo.
2. Rename at least four layouts with clear, descriptive names such as *Title*, *Section Header*, *Two Content* and *Data Slide*.
3. Save it as a **PowerPoint Template (.potx)** to a SharePoint or Teams location your colleagues can reach.
4. Open the template to create a new deck, then ask Copilot: *"Create an 8-slide presentation summarising [a real document you own]. One idea per slide, short headline titles."*
5. Check three things on the result: fonts, colour palette and logo placement. Note any slide where Copilot drifted off-brand, and fix it with **Home > Reset**.
6. Finally, take an old unbranded deck and retrofit it using **Design > Browse for Themes** — then time how long the clean-up takes, so you can prove to yourself why starting from the template is worth it.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 39: How to Apply Your Brand Template So Every Deck Looks Like Your Business** and use **Pashun Sports - Brand Template.potx** together with the **Brand-Safe Deck Prompt Card** and the **Slide Master Setup Checklist**; you will reuse this same template in **Lecture 40: How to Turn a Word Document Into a Full Presentation in One Prompt**.

Lecture 40: How to Add, Reorganise and Rewrite Slides With Copilot

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In the last lecture you generated a first-draft deck; now you will learn to *edit* it with Copilot — adding missing slides, reordering the story, and rewriting slides whose wording is wrong for the audience. By the end you will be able to take the raw `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx` and shape it into a deck you would happily put in front of a US wholesale buyer.

💬 Core Concepts

Copilot in PowerPoint edits at **slide level**, not paragraph level. That single fact explains most of what works and what doesn't.

- **Add a slide** — "Add a slide about our US shipping and returns policy." Copilot writes the slide, picks a layout, and inserts it *after the currently selected slide*. Always click the slide you want it to follow first.
- **Add a slide grounded in a file** — "Add a slide about fabric performance using /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx." The forward-slash file reference pulls real content instead of invented content. This is the single biggest quality lever in PowerPoint.
- **Add an image slide** — "Add an image of a folded navy performance t-shirt." Copilot pulls from stock imagery, not your brand photography. Treat it as placeholder art.
- **Organise / reorganise** — "Organise this presentation." Copilot groups related slides, adds section header slides, and proposes a running order. It shows you a preview you can accept or reject.
- **Rewrite a slide** — select the slide, then "Rewrite this slide for a wholesale buyer, not an internal team." Copilot rewrites the text on that slide only.
- **Summarise / condense** — "Make this slide more concise" or "Turn this paragraph into three bullets" fixes the classic Copilot problem of over-long body text.

What Copilot will and won't do in PowerPoint:

You ask for	Copilot's behaviour	What you must still do
Add a slide	Creates and inserts a full new slide	Check the layout matches your template
Organise presentation	Regroups slides, adds section headers	Accept/reject; it can bury your ask slide
Rewrite a slide	Rewrites text on the selected slide	Re-check numbers and product names
Delete a slide	Not supported by prompt	Delete manually in the thumbnail pane

Move one specific slide to position 4	Not reliable	Drag it in the thumbnail pane
Restyle to your brand template	Not supported	Apply via Designer / Slide Master

- **The order of operations that saves the most time:** get the content right first (add and ground the missing slides), then reorganise, then rewrite tone, then fix design manually. Reorganising before the content is complete just means reorganising twice.
- **Copilot cannot undo its own structural change intelligently** — but Ctrl+Z works. Use it freely; nothing here is destructive.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx` in PowerPoint on the Pashun Consulting tenant. The deck currently holds only four slides: a title, a product overview, a rough pricing slide and a closing slide. The audience has changed — Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) needs this deck to go to a US wholesale buyer, not to Paul as Founder.

1. **Add the missing content slides.** Paul selects slide 2, then prompts: *"Add a slide covering the fabric composition and performance claims for the Pashun Pro Tee, using /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx."* Copilot inserts a grounded slide with real wording from the brief rather than generic apparel marketing language.
2. **Add a commercial slide from the spreadsheet content.** Paul adds: *"Add a slide summarising expected first-season US demand by state."* He shows deliberately that PowerPoint's grounding is weaker than Word's here — and demonstrates the reliable workaround: copy the summary figures from `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx`, paste them into the prompt as context, and let Copilot format them.
3. **Add the slide the deck was missing entirely.** *"Add a slide about lead times and minimum order quantities for Ridgeline Apparel Supply."* Paul notes on camera that Copilot invents plausible numbers if you don't supply real ones — so he corrects them straight after.
4. **Reorganise.** With eight slides now present, Paul prompts *"Organise this presentation."* Copilot proposes section headers — Product, Commercials, Supply — and a new running order. Paul accepts, then immediately drags the pricing slide manually because Copilot buried it behind a section header.
5. **Rewrite for the audience.** Paul selects the product overview slide and prompts: *"Rewrite this slide for a US wholesale buyer. Focus on sell-through and margin, not on design process. Keep it to four short bullets."* He then rewrites the closing slide: *"Rewrite this slide as a clear call to action asking the buyer to confirm a sample order by the end of the month."*
6. **Condense the bloat.** One slide has come back with six lines of dense text. Paul selects it and prompts *"Make this slide more concise — maximum five words per bullet."*
7. **Fact-check pass.** Paul walks the deck end to end against the Range Brief, correcting the invented MOQ figure and the supplier name capitalisation. This is the step students skip, and it is the step that protects your credibility in the room.

✅ Summary

- Copilot in PowerPoint works slide by slide — select the slide *before* you prompt, because "add" inserts after the current selection.
- Ground new slides with a `/filename` reference wherever possible; ungrounded slides are plausible-sounding invention.

- "Organise this presentation" is powerful for structure but will happily bury your most important slide — always review the proposed order.
- Rewriting is where the real value sits: the same deck, rewritten for a wholesale buyer versus an internal team, is effectively two different decks for one prompt each.
- Copilot cannot delete slides, move a named slide to a named position, or apply your brand template — do those manually in the thumbnail pane and Slide Master.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open any existing deck of your own with fewer than ten slides, or use `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx` from the resource folder.
2. Select the second slide and ask Copilot to add one new slide grounded in a real document using a `/filename` reference.
3. Ask Copilot to add a second slide on a topic your deck is missing entirely — then fact-check every number it produced.
4. Run "Organise this presentation" and screenshot the before-and-after running order so you can see what it moved.
5. Select your weakest slide and rewrite it twice: once for an internal team, once for an external buyer. Compare the two.
6. Finish with "Make this slide more concise — maximum five words per bullet" on your most text-heavy slide.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 40: How to Add, Reorganise and Rewrite Slides With Copilot** and use `Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx` together with the **Slide Editing Prompt Card** — and keep `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx` from **Lecture 39: How to Create a Full Presentation From a Word Document or a Prompt** to hand, since you will need it for the grounded-slide step.

Lecture 41: How to Generate Speaker Notes and Rehearse Your Delivery

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

A deck is only half the deliverable — what you *say* over each slide is the other half. In this lecture you will use Copilot in PowerPoint to generate speaker notes for the Pashun Pro Tee US launch deck, tune those notes to your own speaking style and time limit, and then use Speaker Coach to rehearse the delivery before you present it to Morgan Reyes and the wider team.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Speaker notes are grounded in the slide, not invented.** Copilot reads the text, headings and structure already on the slide and writes notes that support it. If a slide is just an image and three words, your notes will be thin — fix the slide first, then generate notes.

- **"Add speaker notes" is a whole-deck action.** From the Copilot pane in PowerPoint you can ask for notes across every slide in one pass, then edit individual slides by hand. This is far faster than slide-by-slide prompting.
- **Notes are a first draft of your voice, not a script to read aloud.** Copilot writes clean, neutral corporate prose. Your job is to cut it down to prompts and phrases you can actually say — a bullet you can glance at, not a paragraph you have to read.
- **Time is the missing constraint.** Copilot has no idea you have eight minutes. You must state the total time, the number of slides, and roughly how long per slide you want. Without this, expect notes that would take 25 minutes to deliver.
- **Speaker Coach is a separate, non-AI-generative feature.** Found under **Slide Show → Rehearse with Coach**, it listens to you rehearse and reports on pace, filler words, repetitive language, pitch, and whether you are simply reading the slide. It works whether or not you have a Copilot licence.
- **The two tools complement each other.** Copilot gives you *what to say*; Speaker Coach tells you *how you said it*. Used together they turn a raw deck into a rehearsed presentation in under an hour.

Task	Tool	Where you find it	Licence needed
Generate notes for all slides	Copilot in PowerPoint	Home tab → Copilot → "Add speaker notes"	Microsoft 365 Copilot
Rewrite notes for one slide	Copilot pane, slide selected	Copilot side pane	Microsoft 365 Copilot
Shorten notes to a time limit	Copilot prompt with explicit timing	Copilot side pane	Microsoft 365 Copilot
Check pace, fillers, monotone	Speaker Coach	Slide Show → Rehearse with Coach	Included in M365
Present with notes visible	Presenter View	Slide Show → Use Presenter View	Included in M365

- **Useful prompt levers to include every time:** your role ("I am the founder presenting to our Head of Finance"), the audience, the total time, the tone, and the single takeaway you want each slide to land.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works in **Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx**, now expanded in the previous lectures into the full US launch deck covering the performance-blend fabric, Ridgeline Apparel Supply as the fabric supplier, the US state-by-state sales forecast and the margin-per-unit picture.

1. **Generate notes across the whole deck.** With the deck open, Paul opens the Copilot pane and uses the built-in prompt **"Add speaker notes"**. Copilot walks the deck and drops notes into the notes pane of every slide. He shows the result on the forecast slide — accurate, but far too long.
2. **Constrain it to the real meeting.** Paul re-prompts:

"I am Paul Ashun, Founder of Pashun Sports T-Shirts. Rewrite the speaker notes for this deck for a 10-minute internal pitch to Morgan Reyes, our Head of Finance, and Jamie Jordan, our Project Manager. Roughly 45 seconds of speech per slide. Use short bullet prompts I can glance at, not full sentences. Emphasise unit margin and launch timing on the forecast slides."

1. **Fix a single weak slide.** On the Ridgeline Apparel Supply slide, the generated notes simply restate the bullets on screen. Paul selects that slide and prompts: *"Rewrite these notes so they add

context the slide does not show — lead time, why we chose this supplier over the other two options, and the one risk I should flag honestly."* He shows how Copilot draws on the slide plus deck context, and how he then hand-edits to add the detail only he knows.

2. **Add a transition line.** Paul demonstrates a small but high-value prompt: *"Add a one-sentence transition at the end of each slide's notes that links to the next slide."* This is what makes a deck feel rehearsed rather than clicked through.
3. **Sanity-check the facts.** Paul reminds students of the fact-checking discipline from **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice** — he cross-reads the margin figures in the notes against **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** before trusting a single number he is about to say out loud.
4. **Rehearse with Speaker Coach.** Paul goes to **Slide Show → Rehearse with Coach**, enables the on-screen guidance, and presents the first four slides live. The report flags pace above 190 words per minute, repeated use of "obviously", and reading directly from the Ridgeline slide.
5. **Tighten and re-run.** He shortens the two slides that ran long, re-rehearses, and shows the improved report — demonstrating that the loop (generate → rehearse → tighten) is the actual workflow, not a one-shot output.
6. **Present properly.** Finally Paul opens **Presenter View** so students can see the notes on the laptop screen while the audience sees only the slide, and exports a notes-page PDF for anyone delivering the deck in his absence.

✅ Summary

- Copilot can write speaker notes for an entire deck in one action, but they will be long, neutral and untimed until you constrain them.
- Always give Copilot your role, your audience, your total time and your key message — timing is the single most valuable instruction you can add.
- Good notes add what the slide does *not* show; if the notes just read the bullets back, re-prompt that slide.
- Speaker Coach measures your delivery — pace, fillers, monotone, reading from slides — and is available even without a Copilot licence.
- The real workflow is a loop: generate notes, rehearse with Coach, cut the slides that overran, rehearse again.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open **Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx** (or your own deck of at least eight slides) and run the **"Add speaker notes"** prompt from the Copilot pane.
2. Re-prompt with a hard constraint, naming your real audience and a real time limit — for example: *"Rewrite these speaker notes for an 8-minute pitch to our Head of Finance. Short glanceable bullets, around 40 seconds per slide, emphasise margin per unit."*
3. Pick the weakest slide and prompt Copilot to add context the slide does not already display, then hand-edit it so it sounds like you.
4. Add transition sentences across the deck with a single prompt.
5. Run **Slide Show → Rehearse with Coach** for the full deck and read the report.
6. Cut or shorten the two slides where your pace or timing slipped, then rehearse once more and compare the two reports.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 41: How to Generate Speaker Notes and Rehearse Your Delivery** and use the **Speaker Notes Prompt Set (Pashun Pro Tee)** together with the **Speaker Coach Rehearsal Checklist** — and keep **Pashun_Pro_Tee_Pitch.pptx** from **Lecture 38: How to Build a Full Presentation From a Word Document With Copilot** open alongside it.

Lecture 42: How to Summarise a Long Deck Someone Else Sent You

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

You have just been sent a 22-slide deck by a supplier and you have eleven minutes before the call. In this lecture you will learn how to use Copilot in PowerPoint to summarise a deck you did not write — pulling out the key messages, the numbers, the asks and the risks — so you can walk into the meeting informed rather than bluffing.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Summarising is a reading task, not a building task.** Everything in Section 7 so far has been about Copilot *creating* slides. This lecture flips it: Copilot reads a deck you received and tells you what is in it.
- **Where to ask.** Open the deck in PowerPoint (desktop or web) and click the **Copilot** button on the Home ribbon. The side pane opens with a suggested prompt — usually *"Summarise this presentation"*. You can accept it or type your own.
- **What Copilot can actually see.** It reads slide text, titles, slide notes and, increasingly, text inside tables. It is far weaker on numbers embedded in images, screenshots of spreadsheets, and SmartArt with heavy formatting. If a key figure lives in a picture, Copilot will usually miss it — check manually.
- **Slide references are your fact-check.** Copilot's summary includes clickable slide numbers. Always click at least two before you trust a summary — this is the same discipline from **Lecture 17: How to Spot and Correct a Wrong Answer — Fact-Checking Copilot in Practice**, applied to decks.
- **Summary is only the first question.** The real value comes from the follow-ups: what are they asking me to approve, what has changed since the last version, what is missing.

Ask Copilot for	Prompt shape	Use it when
A quick overview	"Summarise this presentation in 8 bullet points."	You have minutes before a call
The decisions	"List every decision or approval this deck is asking for, with slide numbers."	You are the approver
The numbers	"Extract all prices, volumes, dates and percentages from this deck into a table with slide references."	Finance or commercial review
The gaps	"What questions does this deck leave unanswered for a buyer?"	Preparing challenge questions

The risks	"List any risks, caveats, assumptions or conditions mentioned."	Contract or supplier decks
A named section	"Summarise only slides 12 to 18."	Long decks, one relevant chapter

- **Copilot in PowerPoint vs Copilot Chat.** If you want to compare the deck against an email thread or a spreadsheet, do it in Copilot Chat in the Microsoft 365 app, where you can reference multiple files at once. In-app PowerPoint Copilot looks at the open deck only.
- **Notes matter.** If the sender wrote speaker notes, Copilot uses them — and they often contain the honest version of the story that the slide text softens.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works the realistic Pashun Sports scenario: **Ridgeline Apparel Supply** has sent through a 22-slide capability and pricing deck ahead of the **Pashun Pro Tee** US launch, and the Weekly Production Catch-Up starts shortly.

1. Paul opens the supplier deck in PowerPoint and clicks **Copilot** on the Home ribbon.
2. First prompt — the orientation pass: *"Summarise this presentation in 8 bullet points for someone who has never seen it. Include slide numbers."* Paul reads the result aloud and points out that Copilot has correctly picked up the fabric blend and MOQ story, but has flattened three slides of factory photos into one vague line — because there is almost no text on them.
3. Second prompt — the commercial pass: *"Extract every price, minimum order quantity, lead time and delivery date mentioned in this deck into a table, with the slide number for each."* Paul clicks two of the slide references to confirm the unit price and the 12-week lead time are real and not invented.
4. Third prompt — the decision pass: *"Act as a cautious buyer. List everything this deck is asking Pashun Sports to commit to, and every assumption Ridgeline has made about our volumes."* This is the RTCA framework from **Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim** applied to a received document.
5. Fourth prompt — the gap pass: *"What important information is missing from this deck that a first-time buyer would need before signing?"* Copilot surfaces the absence of any returns or defect-rate commitment — which becomes the first question Paul asks on the call.
6. Paul then shows the failure case deliberately: a slide where the margin figures exist only inside a pasted screenshot. Copilot does not report them. Paul explains that this is the single most common reason a deck summary looks thin, and that the fix is to ask the sender for the underlying numbers rather than assume the deck is empty.
7. Finally, Paul copies the Copilot output into a **Copilot Page** (see **Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document**) and shares it with **Jamie Jordan** in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team so the whole production group walks into the call with the same brief.

✅ Summary

- Copilot in PowerPoint reads decks as well as builds them — use it to get oriented on someone else's slides in under two minutes.
- One summary is never enough: follow up with prompts for numbers, decisions, assumptions, risks and gaps.

- Always click the slide references to verify; Copilot reads text and notes well, but misses figures locked inside images and screenshots.
- A "thin" summary usually means a picture-heavy deck, not an empty deck — go back to the sender for the source numbers.
- Share the summary as a Copilot Page so your colleagues arrive at the meeting with the same understanding you have.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Find a presentation of 15 slides or more that someone else sent you — a supplier deck, a board pack, a vendor pitch.
2. Open it in PowerPoint and click **Copilot** on the Home ribbon.
3. Run: *"Summarise this presentation in 8 bullet points with slide numbers."*
4. Run: *"Extract every number, date and commercial term in this deck into a table with slide references."*
5. Run: *"List everything this deck is asking me to approve or commit to, and every assumption it makes about my business."*
6. Click three slide references and confirm each claim is genuinely on that slide.
7. Write down one question the summary made you want to ask the sender — that question is your return on this lecture.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 42: How to Summarise a Long Deck Someone Else Sent You** and use the **Ridgeline Apparel Supply — Pashun Pro Tee Capability Deck (22 slides)** together with the **Received Deck Interrogation Prompt Card**, which lists the five follow-up prompts used in the demo in the order Paul runs them.

Lecture 43: How to Set Up Transcription and Recording So Copilot Can Do Its Job

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot in Teams can only summarise, answer questions about, or generate follow-ups from a meeting **if a transcript exists** — no transcript, no intelligence. In this lecture you will learn exactly how to turn on transcription and recording (as an attendee, as an organiser, and as an admin), how to set it as a default so you never forget, and what to do when you inherit a meeting where nobody pressed record.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Transcript ≠ recording.** A recording is the video/audio file. A transcript is the timestamped, speaker-attributed text. **Copilot reads the transcript, not the video.** If you record without transcribing, Copilot in that meeting has nothing to work with.
- **Copilot in Teams is transcript-grounded.** Every answer — "What did Morgan agree to?", "List the decisions", "What actions are assigned to Jamie?" — is generated from the transcript text plus the meeting metadata (title, attendees, chat).
- **Two Copilot retention modes.** The organiser chooses these in Meeting options:

Mode	What it means	Best for
During and after the meeting	Transcription is saved; Copilot is available in the meeting and afterwards in the meeting recap	Almost all business meetings — this is the setting you want for Pashun Sports
Only during the meeting	Copilot works live, but the transcript is discarded when the meeting ends	Sensitive HR, legal or commercially confidential calls

- **Who can start transcription.** The organiser, co-organisers, and presenters — depending on tenant policy. Attendees normally cannot. If the button is greyed out, it is a **policy** problem, not a bug.
- **Consent and notification.** Everyone in the meeting sees a banner when recording/transcription starts. In some jurisdictions (and for calls with external suppliers such as **Ridgeline Apparel Supply**) explicit verbal consent at the top of the call is the professional norm — and it is good practice regardless.
- **Where the artefacts land.** Recordings go to **OneDrive** (for ad-hoc meetings) or the **SharePoint site of the Team** (for channel meetings). Transcripts attach to the meeting itself and appear in the **Recap** tab of the calendar event. This matters: a channel meeting in the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team stores its recording on the team site, not on Paul's personal OneDrive.
- **Language matters.** Spoken language must be set correctly before or at the start of the meeting. If it is wrong, the transcript is garbled and Copilot's summary will be confidently wrong.

- **Admin layer.** Tenant admins control transcription and recording via **Teams admin centre → Meetings → Meeting policies** (`Allow transcription`, `Allow cloud recording`, `Meeting recording automatically starts`). Without these switched on, nothing you do in the client will help.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works inside the real **Pashun Consulting Ltd** tenant, using the **Pashun Pro Tee — US Launch** scenario.

1. **Admin view — check this first. Before touching anything in the meeting client, Paul opens the Teams admin centre → Meetings → Meeting policies and shows the two switches that gate everything else in this lecture: Allow transcription and Allow cloud recording. If either is off, nothing below is possible — so this is the first thing to check, not an afterthought at the end.**
2. **Setting the default before the call. Paul opens the recurring Weekly Production Catch-Up in Outlook calendar, clicks Meeting options, and shows the Copilot dropdown. He switches it from the tenant default to During and after the meeting, and ticks Record and transcribe automatically so the supplier catch-ups are always captured without anyone remembering.**
3. **Proving the dependency. Paul opens the Copilot pane mid-meeting and asks "What have we agreed about the Ridgeline fabric lead time so far?" — it answers. He then stops transcription, asks the same question again, and shows Copilot's refusal. This is the single most important moment in the lecture: no transcript, no Copilot.**
4. **Retrofitting a missed meeting. Paul shows the Monthly US Sales Review where transcription was never started — Recap shows attendance only, and Copilot has nothing. He demonstrates the only real fallback: reconstructing from the meeting chat and the follow-up email thread with Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance), and explains why this is a poor substitute.**

✅ Summary

- Copilot in Teams is powered by the **transcript** — recording alone is not enough.
- The organiser controls Copilot availability in **Meeting options**; choose **During and after the meeting** for normal business calls.
- Turn on **automatic record and transcribe** for recurring meetings so it never depends on human memory.
- Announce recording, get consent — especially on external supplier calls such as Ridgeline Apparel Supply.
- Channel-meeting artefacts live on the **team's SharePoint site**; ad-hoc ones live in **OneDrive** — know where to look before you go hunting.
- A meeting with no transcript cannot be recovered; the fallback is chat and email, and it is always worse.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a recurring meeting you organise in Outlook or Teams and click **Meeting options**.
2. Set the Copilot option to **During and after the meeting**.
3. Turn on **Record and transcribe automatically**, and confirm the spoken language is correct.

4. Run (or join) one real meeting with transcription on, and open the Copilot pane mid-call to ask *"What have we decided so far?"*
5. After the meeting, open the **Recap** tab and ask Copilot: *"List every action item, the owner, and any decision we left unresolved."*
6. Write down one meeting in your week that should **never** be transcribed, and note why — that is your sensitive-meeting policy starting point.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 43: How to Set Up Transcription and Recording So Copilot Can Do Its Job and use the Meeting Options & Transcription Setup Checklist together with the Recording Consent Wording Card; if your transcription buttons are greyed out, also read the admin-policy note before moving on to Lecture 44: How to Get Help During and After a Meeting, and in Busy Chats and Channels.

Situation in the call	Ask Copilot	What you get back
You joined ten minutes late	"What have I missed?"	A short recap of topics and who raised them
Someone quotes a number you doubt	"What did Morgan say the unit margin was?"	The line from the transcript, attributed
You need a figure from a file	"From the US Sales and Stock Forecast, what is the California forecast?"	The value, with a link to the workbook
A decision is made and you want it captured	"List the decisions made so far"	A bulleted decision list you can paste into chat
You are about to speak	"What questions are still unanswered?"	Open items so you do not repeat a point

What you want	Where you get it	Prompt to use
Quick "what happened"	Recap tab > AI Notes	Auto-generated, no prompt needed
A sendable email recap	Copilot in the meeting chat	"Summarise this meeting in six bullets for someone who missed it"
Decisions only	Copilot in the meeting chat	"List every decision that was agreed, and who agreed it"
Action items with owners	Copilot in the meeting chat	"List all action items as a table: Task, Owner, Due date, Stated by whom"
Open questions / risks	Copilot in the meeting chat	"What was raised but left unresolved?"
Catch-up after a late join	Recap tab > "Did I miss anything?"	"Summarise what was discussed before I joined at 14:12"

Scenario	Where you go	Best prompt style
Missed the meeting entirely	Teams → Calendar → open the past event → **Recap** tab	Broad: "Summarise the meeting in 10 bullets and list every decision."

Joined 20 minutes late	In-meeting **Copilot** pane (side panel)	Catch-up: "What have I missed?" / "Summarise the discussion so far."
Need only your bit	Recap → **Speakers** / **Mentions of you**	"What was said about me or assigned to me?"
Chasing actions after the fact	Meeting chat → Copilot	"List all action items with owner and due date."
No transcript exists	Meeting chat + shared files	Fall back to chat messages, notes and Loop components

Ask Copilot	Ask a person
"What were the main decisions in this thread?"	"Why did we actually go that way?"
"What action items are assigned to me?"	"Is that deadline realistic?"
"Summarise the last 7 days in the Production channel post about fabric samples."	Anything said on a call and never typed
"Catch me up — what did I miss while I was out?"	Tone, politics, and anything sensitive
"List every open question nobody has answered."	Final sign-off on money or contracts

Lecture 44: How to Get Help During and After a Meeting, and in Busy Chats and Channels

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This lecture covers three moments where you need Copilot's help with a conversation you're not fully across: while you're live on a call, after a meeting has ended, and inside a busy Teams chat or channel. We will do this on real Pashun Sports scenarios — the Weekly Production Catch-Up with Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance), the Monthly US Sales Review, and the Production channel of the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team.

💬 Core Concepts

Copilot in a meeting is a private side-panel, not a participant. Nothing you type, and nothing Copilot answers, is visible to anyone else on the call — unless you deliberately paste it into the meeting chat.
It reads the transcript, not the audio. Every live answer, and every after-the-fact recap, depends on transcription having been switched on (covered in Lecture 43). No transcript, no answers.
Recap is not the transcript. The transcript is the raw record. The AI Recap (Teams > Recap tab) is Copilot's structured interpretation of it — notes, chapters, speaker timeline, and mentions of you.
Decisions and action items must be asked for. Copilot generates a summary automatically, but for decisions and owned, dated action items you have to prompt explicitly — and force the wording to be checkable.

Owner attribution depends on real identities. Copilot links actions to people using Entra ID accounts. Real licensed users (like Jamie and Morgan) get named; an external guest with no tenant identity comes back as a generic speaker label and needs manual correction.
Copilot in Teams chats and channels works the same way — it reads what you already have permission to see, then compresses it. It cannot read a private channel you're not in, and it cannot see a Planner task that lives outside the conversation.
Time-scoping is the biggest lever on chat/channel summary quality. Copilot offers Last 1 day, Last 7 days, Last 30 days, or Since I last read — the same thread reads very differently at each range.
Every answer is cited. A citation links back to the exact line in the transcript or message it came from. Always click through before repeating a number, price or commitment.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Part 1 — Live, during the call

Paul deliberately joins the Weekly Production Catch-Up eight minutes late. Jamie has already run through the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote.

Fact-check something you heard. Jamie mentions a lead time. Paul asks Copilot: "What lead time did Jamie quote for the performance blend?" Copilot quotes the line back, attributed to Jamie — a cross-check against his own ears, not just a summary.
Ground a live question in a real file. Still on the call, Paul asks: "Using Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, what are the forecast units for Texas and California in Q2?" Copilot returns both figures with a link to the workbook — no screen-sharing, no tabbing away.
Ask what's still open. Paul prompts: "What questions have been asked that nobody has answered yet?" — a way to contribute usefully within seconds of joining.
Check your own exposure. Paul asks: "Has anything been assigned to me so far?" — so nothing lands on him unnoticed while he was out of the room.
Turn a private answer into a shared record. Paul asks: "List every decision made so far and who owns it," then copies the output, tidies the wording, and pastes it into the meeting chat so Jamie sees the agreed actions in real time.

Part 2 — After the meeting: recap, decisions and actions

Jump straight to a mention of you. In the Recap tab of a meeting Paul missed entirely, he clicks the mention of "Paul" at 00:14:32 and the recording jumps straight to Morgan asking whether he's signed off the revised fabric cost from Ridgeline Apparel Supply — instead of replaying the whole meeting.
Force traceable decisions. Paul prompts: "List every decision made in this meeting about the Pashun Pro Tee fabric and pricing. For each one, quote the sentence where it was agreed and name the speaker." The quoted-sentence requirement exposes any hallucinated "decision" instantly.
Flag the gaps in action items. Paul prompts: "Produce a markdown table of every action item with columns Task, Owner, Due date, Confidence. Mark Confidence as Low where the owner or date was not explicitly stated." This surfaces ambiguous items instead of letting Copilot guess.
Check a number before you trust it. Paul clicks the citation on a margin figure — it jumps to Morgan's exact words in the transcript. He points out the number is a verbal estimate, not the figure in Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx, and that he'd verify in Excel before quoting it to a wholesale buyer.
See where attribution breaks. One action item comes back owned by "Speaker 2" because the Ridgeline Apparel Supply contact joined as an external guest. Paul fixes the owner by hand and explains why: Copilot cannot attribute to someone with no identity in the tenant.

Part 3 — Busy chats and channels

Compare the same thread at different time ranges. In the Production channel's fabric-sample thread, Paul re-runs the Copilot summary at Last 1 day, Last 7 days and Last 30 days and shows how differently the same conversation reads at each range — explaining why "Since I last read" is the safest default after time away.
See the honest limitation. Paul opens a Planner task from Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch that was created outside the chat, and shows that Copilot's chat summary doesn't know it exists — chat Copilot summarises the conversation, not the whole project.

✅ Summary

Copilot in a live meeting is a private panel — use it to fact-check, ground answers in your files, and check what's still open or assigned to you, without interrupting anyone.
After a meeting, Copilot's summary is automatic, but decisions and action items need to be asked for explicitly — and forcing a quoted source sentence or a confidence flag keeps it honest.
"Mentions of you" turns a missed meeting into a 90-second catch-up instead of a full replay.
Always click the citation before repeating a number, price or commitment — Copilot reports what was said, not what is true.
In chats and channels, the time range you choose is the single biggest lever on summary quality, and Copilot only ever sees the conversation itself — not tasks or files that live outside it.

🎯 Your Turn

In your next live meeting, ask Copilot one grounding question that pulls from a real file, and one "what's still open" question before you speak.
Open the Recap tab of a meeting you missed this week. Use Mentions of you to jump to a moment that concerns you, then ask for decisions and action items with a quoted source and a confidence flag.
Open the busiest Teams chat or channel you've been avoiding. Compare the summary at Last 7 days versus Last 30 days, then ask what's been assigned to you and what's still outstanding.
Click at least two citations across the exercises above and confirm they match the original message or transcript line.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 44: How to Get Help During and After a Meeting, and in Busy Chats and Channels and use the Live Meeting Prompt Card, the Meeting Recap Prompt Set, and the Teams Catch-Up Prompt Card together; if you need a refresher on structuring these prompts, revisit Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim.

Lecture 48: How to Turn Meeting Actions Into Tasks, Emails and Follow-Ups

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

A meeting recap is worthless if the actions stay inside it. This lecture is not really about Teams — it's about what happens next, across Outlook, Planner and Teams chat together. You'll take the action list

Copilot already extracted in Lecture 44 and turn it into real, owned, dated work in minutes rather than the following afternoon.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot detects actions, it does not assign them.** In Teams, Copilot surfaces "Follow-up tasks" in the meeting recap, but they are suggestions with no owner, no due date and no home. Your job is the last mile: owner, date, destination.
- **The three destinations.** Every meeting action ends up in exactly one of three places — a **task** (tracked work with an owner and a date), an **email** (a request to someone outside the meeting or a supplier), or a **decision record** (something that just needs writing down where the team will see it).
- **Grounding beats retyping.** Copilot in Outlook, Word and Loop can read the meeting transcript directly. Prompting "Draft an email based on yesterday's Weekly Production Catch-Up" is faster and more accurate than copying and pasting the recap text.
- **Attribution is your quality check.** Copilot often writes "the team agreed" when the transcript actually says Morgan Reyes agreed. Always force named owners with a follow-up prompt before anything leaves your screen.
- **Copilot cannot create Planner tasks for you from the meeting recap.** You copy the action, you create the task. Copilot's contribution is the clean wording and the date extraction, not the write action.

Action type	Best destination	How Copilot helps
Internal work with an owner	Planner plan *Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch*	Rewrites the action as a single-verb task title and extracts the deadline
Request to a supplier or customer	Outlook email	Drafts the mail grounded in the meeting, in your house style
Decision that needs recording	OneNote *Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch Checklist* or a Loop page	Summarises decisions only, stripped of discussion
Quick nudge to one person	Teams chat	Drafts a two-line message with the relevant context
Status for someone who missed it	Email recap	Produces a "what you missed and what you owe" summary

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works from the recording of the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** with Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance), where the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote, the US state-level forecast and the Pashun Pro Tee launch date were all discussed.

1. **Start from the list you already have. Paul reuses the confidence-flagged action table Copilot produced in Lecture 44 — four rows with real owners, two marked "not stated" — rather than re-extracting it from scratch.**
2. **Fix the gaps in the meeting, not after it.** Paul shows the two "not stated" rows and explains the discipline: those get assigned by you before the recap is shared, because an unowned action is a dead action.

3. **Create the Planner tasks.** Paul asks Copilot: *"Rewrite each action as a task title of eight words or fewer, starting with a verb."* "Jamie to go back to Ridgeline about the 180gsm swatch timing" becomes **"Confirm 180gsm swatch delivery date with Ridgeline."** He adds it to the **Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch** plan, assigns Jamie, sets the date.
4. **Draft the supplier email.** In Outlook, Paul opens a new mail to Ridgeline Apparel Supply and uses Copilot's **Draft with Copilot**, prompting: *"Write a short email to our fabric supplier confirming the two points we agreed in this week's Weekly Production Catch-Up about swatch timing and minimum order quantity. Professional, direct, no more than 120 words, British English."* He then uses **Adjust → Make it shorter** and checks every claim against the transcript.
5. **Nudge Morgan in chat.** In the 1:1 Teams chat, Paul uses Copilot to draft: *"Morgan — the US Sales and Stock Forecast margin-per-unit column is the blocker on the pricing decision. Can you get that to me before Friday's Monthly US Sales Review?"*
6. **Record the decisions.** Paul prompts: *"From this meeting, list decisions only — not discussion, not actions. One line each."* Three lines go straight into the **Pashun Pro Tee – US Launch Checklist** OneNote page under this week's date.
7. **The catch-up email.** For anyone who missed it, Paul prompts Copilot: *"Write an email to a colleague who missed this meeting: three bullets on what was decided, then one line on what I need from them and by when."*

Total elapsed time: under eight minutes, all of it from a meeting Paul attended but took no notes in.

✅ Summary

- Copilot's meeting follow-ups are raw material — you supply owner, date and destination.
- Every action belongs in one of three places: a task, an email, or a decision record. Decide which before you start typing.
- Ground your drafts in the meeting itself rather than pasting recap text — it is faster and preserves detail.
- Always force named owners and real dates; challenge any "the team will" phrasing.
- Action conversion is a same-day habit. Done within an hour of the meeting, it takes minutes; done a week later, it takes an archaeology dig.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open the recap of a meeting you attended in the last seven days.
2. Prompt Copilot: *"List every action item as a table with columns Action, Owner (named person), Deadline. Do not invent owners or dates."*
3. Prompt again: *"Rewrite each action as a task title of eight words or fewer, starting with a verb."*
4. Create at least two of those as real Planner or To Do tasks with an owner and a due date.
5. Pick one action that requires contacting someone outside the meeting and draft that email with Copilot, grounded in the meeting, capped at 120 words.
6. Prompt: *"List decisions only from this meeting, one line each"* and paste the result into your project notebook under today's date.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 48: How to Turn Meeting Actions Into Tasks, Emails and Follow-Ups and use the Meeting Action Conversion Prompt Set together with the Action-to-

Destination Routing Card; if your meeting recaps are still summarising accurately but attributing poorly, revisit Lecture 44: How to Get Help During and After a Meeting, and in Busy Chats and Channels before running this exercise.

Lecture 54: What a Copilot Agent Is and When You Should Build One Instead of Prompting

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will learn exactly what a Copilot agent is, how it differs from an ordinary Copilot prompt, and — most importantly — the decision rule for knowing when a task is worth turning into an agent instead of simply asking Copilot again. By the end you will be able to look at any repeating task in your working week and say confidently "that's a prompt" or "that's an agent".

💬 Core Concepts

The one-line definition. A Copilot agent is a saved, named assistant that already knows three things before you type a single word: the **instructions** it must follow, the **knowledge sources** it is allowed to read, and the **tone and boundaries** it must stay inside. A prompt is something you write once. An agent is something you build once and then everyone uses many times.

What an agent is made of:

- **Name and description** — how people find it in the Copilot app, Teams or the Copilot Chat sidebar.
- **Instructions** — the standing brief. The equivalent of the Role, Task, Context and Aim you learned in Lecture 12: How to Write Powerful Prompts Using the RTCA Framework — Role, Task, Context, Aim, except you write it once and it applies to every conversation.
- **Knowledge** — specific SharePoint sites, Teams files, folders or documents the agent is grounded in. Not "everything you have access to" — a deliberate, narrow shortlist.
- **Starter prompts** — suggested questions that appear when someone opens the agent, so a colleague who has never been trained can still use it correctly.
- **Behaviour rules** — what it must never do. "Never quote a price that is not in the wholesale price list." "If the answer is not in the returns policy, say so and point to Morgan Reyes."

Prompt vs agent — the real decision.

Situation	Use a prompt	Build an agent
You need it once	✅	❌
You need it weekly or daily	⚠️ Use a saved prompt	✅
Only you do the task	✅	⚠️ Maybe
Several colleagues do the task	❌	✅
Answer must come from one fixed document set	⚠️ Re-attach files each time	✅ Knowledge is pre-wired
Consistency of wording and tone matters	❌ Drifts between people	✅ Enforced by instructions
Non-Copilot-trained staff need to use it	❌	✅ Starter prompts guide them
Task needs fresh judgement every time	✅	❌

The honest test — three questions. Build an agent only if you answer yes to at least two:

1. Will this task be repeated at least weekly for the next three months?
2. Will someone other than me need to run it?
3. Does the correct answer always come from the same small set of documents?

If it is a one-off strategic question — "should Pashun Sports launch the Pro Tee in California before Texas?" — that is a prompt, not an agent. Agents are for **repeatable, grounded, shared** work.

What an agent is *not*. It is not code. It is not a chatbot you train on your own data in the machine-learning sense. And it does not widen permissions: if Jamie Jordan cannot open a document, an agent will not read it out to him. Permissions are inherited, never granted — that is the governance point we return to in Section 11. On autonomy, be precise rather than absolute: a declarative agent like the ones we build in this section is reactive by default — it responds when a person asks it something, or when it is triggered inside a flow such as a Teams meeting or an approval. It does not wake up and act entirely on its own initiative. Microsoft 365 Copilot does also offer autonomous, event-triggered agents further up the stack — the next tier we cover below — so "no agent in Copilot is ever autonomous" is not accurate; what is accurate is that the declarative agents you are learning to build here are not those, and stay firmly in the "respond when asked" category.

The three tiers you will meet, from simplest to most powerful:

- **Declarative agents in Copilot Chat — built in minutes from a description, grounded in files you choose, and reactive: they answer when a person (or a scheduled/triggered flow) asks. This is where 90% of business value sits for a non-technical team, and where this section focuses.**
- **Copilot Studio agents — built with a low-code canvas, can call actions and connectors to touch external systems, and are billed as a separate metered product on top of Microsoft 365 Copilot.**
- **Autonomous agents — triggered by events (a new record, a schedule, an email arriving) rather than by a person typing a question, and able to carry out multi-step work unattended.**

Real and available in the Microsoft ecosystem, but well beyond what a non-technical user should deploy without a review process — we do not build these in this course.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant and scores four real tasks against the three-question test in front of you — these are scenarios to evaluate, not steps to follow in sequence.

1. **Task — the customer returns question. Customers keep emailing to ask whether a printed Pashun Pro Tee can be returned if it has been washed. The answer is always in the same returns policy and FAQ document sitting in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts Teams site. Several people answer these emails. Verdict: agent. Three out of three on the test.**

1. **Task — the US state sales question. Paul opens `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx` and asks Copilot to compare margin per unit across the top five US states. It is a one-off analysis he is doing because the owner asked a question in a meeting. Verdict: prompt. Fresh judgement, one person, one time.**

1. **Task — the weekly production summary. Every Monday after the Weekly Production Catch-Up, Jamie Jordan writes a short status note pulling from the Planner plan `Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch` and the Production channel in Teams. Same sources, same format, every week, and Morgan Reyes needs to produce it when Jamie is on leave. Verdict: agent.**

1. **Task — drafting the supplier negotiation email to Ridgeline Apparel Supply. High stakes, commercially sensitive, different every time, needs Paul's judgement on tone. Verdict: prompt — and a carefully reviewed one.**

Step 1 — Paul then opens the Copilot app, clicks Create agent, and shows the blank Agent Builder configuration screen — name, description, instructions, knowledge, starter prompts — without filling it in. The point of this lecture is the decision, not the build. You will build the returns agent end to end in the next lecture.

Step 2 — a forward-looking caution, not a live demo: no agent exists yet at this point in the course — you build the first one in Lecture 56. But here is the failure mode to watch for once you do. Imagine pointing a future agent at a folder that contains three conflicting versions of the wholesale price list: it will answer confidently — and wrongly. The lesson to bank now, before you build anything: an agent inherits the quality of its knowledge sources. Tidy the documents before you build the agent, never after.

✅ Summary

- A Copilot agent is a saved assistant with pre-set instructions, a fixed knowledge source and defined boundaries — a prompt you build once and everyone reuses.
- Use the three-question test: repeated weekly, used by others, answers from a fixed document set. Two yeses and it is worth building.
- One-off analysis and high-judgement writing stay as prompts — building an agent for them wastes effort and adds no consistency benefit.
- Agents never expand permissions; they inherit exactly what the person asking is already allowed to see.

- Clean up your source documents before you build. A confident agent grounded in three conflicting price lists is worse than no agent at all.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open your calendar and email for the last four weeks and list every task you repeated three or more times.
2. Against each one, answer the three questions: repeated weekly? Needed by others? Always from the same documents?
3. Circle the single task that scores highest — this is your first agent candidate.
4. Write down, in one sentence each, the **instructions** that task would need and the **exact documents or SharePoint location** it would read from.
5. Go and look at those documents now. If there are duplicates, out-of-date versions or contradictions, fix them before the next lecture — you will be building this agent for real.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 54: What a Copilot Agent Is and When You Should Build One Instead of Prompting** and use the **Agent vs Prompt Decision Worksheet**, which contains the three-question test as a printable scorecard plus the four worked Pashun Sports examples from the demo.

Lecture 55: How to Use the Ready-Made Agents Microsoft Gives You

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Before you ever build your own agent, Microsoft already hands you a set of ready-made ones that do specialist work far better than a plain Copilot chat prompt. In this lecture you will learn what each built-in agent is for, how to reach it, and you will put Researcher and Analyst to work on the Pashun Pro Tee US launch.

💬 Core Concepts

- **An agent is a specialist, not a chatbot.** Copilot Chat is a generalist that answers in seconds. An agent has a defined job, a longer reasoning budget, its own tools, and it will go away and *work* for several minutes before reporting back.
- **You do not build these.** They ship with the licence. You find them in the left-hand **Agents** rail of the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, in the Copilot side pane in Word/PowerPoint, or in Teams by typing the agent's name.
- **Licensing matters — and it can change, so verify it in your own admin center rather than trusting a fixed rule. As of this recording, the reasoning agents (Researcher and Analyst) require a Microsoft 365 Copilot licence; in our tenant that means Paul Ashun (Founder & Director) can run them, while Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes on Business Basic cannot. Lecture 6: How to Identify Which Copilot Version You Have and What Each Tier Unlocks covers how to check this for yourself.**

- **Agents are grounded the same way your chat is.** Researcher can see your mail, files, Teams and the open web. Everything you learned in Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See still applies — an agent cannot see a file you could not open yourself.
- **They take minutes, not seconds.** Researcher typically runs 3–8 minutes. Start it, go and do something else, come back to the report. This is normal, not a fault.

Ready-made agent	What it is for	Where you find it	Best Pashun Sports use
Researcher	Multi-step research producing a cited, structured report from web + your work data	Agents rail, Copilot app	US market sizing for performance-blend tees
Analyst	Writes and runs Python over your data; returns charts and working	Agents rail, Copilot app	Margin-per-unit analysis on the US Sales and Stock Forecast workbook
SharePoint agent	Answers questions over one specific site or document library	"Create an agent" button on any SharePoint site	Q&A over supplier contracts and spec documents
Prompt Coach	Rewrites and grades your prompts	Teams — type @Prompt Coach	Improving weak supplier-email prompts
Idea Coach	Structured brainstorming and framing	Teams / Copilot app	Next season's colourway range
Facilitator	Runs meeting notes and follow-ups live in a Teams meeting	Add to a Teams meeting chat	Weekly Production Catch-Up
Kanban Project Task Board (3rd-party)	Marketplace agent — drag-and-drop Kanban board for tracking tasks, free, by IE Ilia Pirozhenko (4.0★, 929 installs)	Agent Store — Agents rail → search "Kanban Project Task Board" → Add	Tracking the Pashun Pro Tee US launch's own task list across Outlook, Teams and Copilot

- **Researcher vs Analyst is the distinction most people get wrong.** Researcher gathers and synthesises *information*. Analyst computes over *numbers you already have*. Ask Researcher for a market estimate; ask Analyst for your margins.
- **Everything returns as a Copilot Page.** Agent output lands as an editable, shareable page — so the report is the start of your document, not a dead end. That is Lecture 10: How to Use Copilot Pages to Turn an AI Answer Into a Shared Working Document put to work.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works the Pashun Pro Tee US launch through the built-in agents end to end.

1. Researcher — sizing the US opportunity. From the Agents rail Paul opens Researcher and asks:

> *"I am the founder of Pashun Sports T-Shirts, a small UK brand launching a performance-blend t-shirt line called the Pashun Pro Tee into the US market. Research the US performance/athleisure t-shirt market: size, growth, the three or four states with the strongest demand, typical wholesale price points, and the main direct-to-consumer competitors under $40. Use my Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief for our positioning. Give me a report with sources, and end with three risks to our launch."*

Paul points out the live "thinking" trail — Researcher announces the searches it is running, checks the Range Brief in OneDrive, and revises its own plan mid-run. Five minutes later a cited report arrives. Paul checks two citations, finds one that is a vendor blog rather than an industry source, and demonstrates asking Researcher to *"replace the market-size figure with one from a named research firm and cite it"*.

2. Analyst — margin per unit. Paul uploads *Pashun Sports – US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx* to Analyst and asks it to calculate margin per unit by size and colourway, flag any SKU under 35% margin, and chart forecast units against contribution by US state. Paul expands **"Show the code"** so students see the Python — this is the reason Analyst can be trusted on arithmetic where a language model alone cannot.

3. The realistic snag. Paul deliberately asks Analyst a question the workbook cannot answer (freight cost per unit from Ridgeline Apparel Supply) and shows the agent correctly saying the data is not present — proving it computes rather than invents.

4. A SharePoint agent for suppliers. Paul opens the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site, clicks Create an agent, scopes it to the supplier documents, and asks *"what notice period do we owe Ridgeline?"* — a one-click agent with no configuration.

Add your most-used agents to quick access. Every agent — built-in or from the Agent Store — can be pinned so it is one click away instead of buried in a longer list. Open Agents in the left rail, find the agent, and choose Pin (or drag it into "Your agents"). Do this for Researcher, Analyst and any marketplace agent your team relies on daily, such as Kanban Project Task Board once it is added — it saves the several seconds of searching that otherwise happen every single time, and it is what makes a colleague actually adopt an agent rather than forgetting it exists.

✅ Summary

- Microsoft ships ready-made agents you can use today — Researcher, Analyst, SharePoint agents, Prompt Coach, Idea Coach, Facilitator and Visual Creator — with nothing to build. The Agent Store also lists third-party marketplace agents, such as the free Kanban Project Task Board (publisher: IE Ilia Pirozhenko), which adds a drag-and-drop Kanban board directly inside Outlook, Teams and Copilot.
- Researcher is for multi-source, cited research; Analyst runs real Python over your own data. Use the right one for the job.
- Reasoning agents need a full Microsoft 365 Copilot licence, so plan who in your team runs them.
- Agents take minutes, not seconds, and produce a Copilot Page you can edit, share and continue working in.
- Always spot-check citations and ask for better sources — agent output is a strong first draft, never a final answer.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app and click Agents in the left rail to see exactly which agents your licence gives you — write the list down, and pin the two or three you use most to your Copilot home so they're one click away next time.
2. Run **Researcher** on one real question you would otherwise have spent an hour on, naming your business, your market and the decision you are trying to make, and asking for sources plus three risks.
3. While it runs, open **Analyst**, upload one spreadsheet you actually use, and ask it for a per-unit or per-customer profitability breakdown with a chart.
4. Open the code Analyst used and check one calculation against the workbook yourself.
5. Check two citations in the Researcher report. If either is weak, ask the agent to replace it with a named, authoritative source.
6. Save the better of the two outputs as a Copilot Page and share it with one colleague.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 55: How to Use the Ready-Made Agents Microsoft Gives You** and use the **Built-In Agents Reference Card** together with the **Researcher & Analyst Starter Prompts** file, which contains the exact Pashun Pro Tee prompts used in this demo.

Lecture 56: How to Build Your First Agent With No Code Using Agent Builder

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you build your first working Copilot agent — a returns-and-FAQ assistant for Pashun Sports T-Shirts — using the no-code agent builder inside Microsoft 365 Copilot. Its official Microsoft name is **Agent Builder in Microsoft 365 Copilot** (you will sometimes see it called "Copilot Studio Lite" online — that is a community nickname, not Microsoft's own product name, so we use "Agent Builder" throughout). By the end you will have a named, instructed, file-grounded agent that your colleagues can open from the Copilot app and ask questions of, with no coding, no licences to buy and no IT ticket.

💬 Core Concepts

- **What an agent actually is.** An agent is Copilot with a job description. Instead of a blank chat box that knows everything and specialises in nothing, an agent has a fixed name, a fixed set of instructions, a fixed set of source files, and a fixed personality. It is a reusable prompt with a front door.
- **Agent Builder vs full Copilot Studio. Agent Builder lives inside the Microsoft 365 Copilot app under Create agent (or Agents → New agent). It is designed for business users, and its Configure screen already includes a Copilot connectors toggle alongside Cloud files, Outlook, Teams, web search and attachments — so line-of-business data reachable through a Copilot connector is not exclusive to full Copilot Studio, it is just off by default and one toggle away. Full Copilot Studio is a separate, metered product for makers who need custom Power Platform actions, Power Automate flows, authentication and publishing to external**

websites or Teams-wide channels — capability Agent Builder genuinely does not have, rather than a blanket "no connectors" limitation.

- **The four things every Agent Builder agent needs.**

Element	What it is	Pashun Sports example
Name	What people see in the Copilot app	Pashun Sports Returns Assistant
Description	One line telling users what it's for	Answers customer returns, sizing and delivery questions for the US Pashun Pro Tee line
Instructions	The agent's standing prompt — tone, rules, boundaries	Answer only from the attached policy documents; never invent a refund window; if unsure, say "Please escalate to Morgan Reyes in Finance"
Knowledge	The files or SharePoint sites it is grounded in	Pashun Sports – US Returns and FAQ Policy.docx, Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx

- **Grounding beats cleverness. An Agent Builder agent is only as good as the documents you point it at. One accurate, current policy document will outperform a beautifully written instruction set attached to nothing.**
- **Instructions are written for a person, not a machine.** Write them as you would brief a new starter: what you do, what you never do, what to say when you don't know, and who to escalate to.
- **Permissions are inherited, not created.** An agent cannot show a colleague anything they could not already open themselves. If Jamie Jordan has no access to the finance folder, the agent will not reveal it to Jamie — but it *will* reveal it to Paul. Sharing an agent is not the same as sharing its sources. We cover the oversharing risk properly in Lecture 62 in Section 11 on governance.
- **Conversation starters.** These are the three or four suggested questions that appear when someone opens the agent. They are the single fastest way to make a non-technical colleague actually use the thing.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul builds the **Pashun Sports Returns Assistant** live, start to finish, in roughly ten minutes.

1. **The business problem.** Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) is fielding the same six customer questions every week about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch — sizing between the performance blend and the old cotton tee, the returns window, whether US customers pay return postage, and how long refunds take. Jamie is on a Business Basic licence and does not have Copilot, but Jamie *can* be given access to an agent Paul publishes.
2. **Prepare the knowledge first.** Paul opens SharePoint and shows the two grounding documents sitting in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site: *Pashun Sports – US Returns and FAQ Policy.docx* and *Pashun Pro Tee – US Range Brief.docx*. He makes the point deliberately: **build the document before you build the agent.** A rushed policy doc produces a confidently wrong agent.
3. **Open the builder.** In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, Paul selects **Create agent**, then switches from the guided **Describe** tab to the **Configure** tab so every field is visible.
4. **Describe it in plain English first.** Paul types into the Describe box: *"An assistant for Pashun Sports T-Shirts that answers US customer questions about returns, sizing and delivery for the

Pashun Pro Tee, using only our published policy."* Copilot auto-fills the name, description, instructions and a starter icon. Paul shows that this first draft is usable but generic — which is exactly why we go to Configure next.

5. **Rewrite the instructions properly — and give it real substance, not one line. Paul replaces the auto-generated text with a full briefing in four blocks: **Role & tone** (customer-service assistant for a US sports apparel brand; friendly, plain English, no jargon, US spelling and US date format). **Knowledge rules** — what the agent may say and, just as importantly, what it must never reveal: never quote or estimate a wholesale price, unit cost or supplier margin, whatever the source; never comment on the relationship with supplier Ridgeline Apparel Supply; answer only from the attached returns and range documents and say so when a question falls outside them. **Escalation rules** — a full routing table, not a single line: a refund enquiry over $100, any damaged bulk order, or any question about wholesale pricing or supplier terms goes to Morgan Reyes, Head of Finance; a sizing or product-fit question the documents do not answer goes to Jamie Jordan, Project Manager; anything else outside scope gets a plain "I don't have that information — here's who can help" rather than a guess. Paul shows this laid out as three short, clearly labelled instruction fields rather than one dense paragraph, because Agent Builder — like a person reading a brief — follows a well-structured instruction far more reliably than a wall of text.**
6. **Attach the knowledge.** Under **Knowledge**, Paul adds the SharePoint site for the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team, then narrows to the two specific documents. He shows the difference between pointing at a whole site (broad, risky) and pointing at named files (precise, safe).
7. **Add conversation starters.** Four are added: *"What is the US returns window for the Pashun Pro Tee?"*, *"How does Pro Tee sizing compare to the classic cotton tee?"*, *"Who pays return postage in the US?"*, *"How long does a refund take?"*
8. **Test in the preview pane.** Paul asks a question the policy answers, and the agent responds with a citation back to the source document. He then asks a deliberately out-of-scope question — *"What margin do we make per Pro Tee unit?"* — and shows the agent correctly declining and escalating rather than reaching into the *Pashun Sports – US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx* workbook.
9. **Fix a bad answer in real time.** When the agent gives a vague answer on exchanges, Paul does not rewrite the document — he adds one line to the instructions: *"If the customer asks about exchanges rather than refunds, explain the exchange process step by step before mentioning refunds."* Re-test. Better answer. This iteration loop is the real skill.
10. **Create and share.** Paul clicks **Create**, then shares the agent with Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes, and shows it appearing in the left-hand Copilot rail as a named agent — its own front door, permanently available.

✅ Summary

- An Agent Builder agent is four things: a name, a description, instructions and knowledge — no code, no separate licence, built inside the Microsoft 365 Copilot app.
- **Build the source document before the agent.** Grounding quality determines answer quality far more than clever instruction writing does.
- Write instructions as a **briefing for a new starter**: role, tone, hard rules, and who to escalate to when the agent doesn't know.
- **Point at named files, not entire sites**, wherever you can — precision reduces both wrong answers and oversharing risk.
- Agents **inherit permissions**; sharing an agent never grants a colleague access to content they couldn't already open.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one question you personally answer more than twice a week — a policy question, a process question, a "where do I find…" question.
2. Find or write the single document that contains the correct answer. If it doesn't exist, write one page. This step is the exercise.
3. In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, choose **Create agent**, describe your agent in one sentence, then switch to the **Configure** tab.
4. Rewrite the instructions using four blocks: **role**, **tone**, **two hard rules ("never…")**, and **one escalation line naming a real person**.
5. Attach your document under **Knowledge**, and add three conversation starters phrased exactly as your colleagues would ask them.
6. Test with one in-scope question and one deliberately out-of-scope question. If the out-of-scope answer isn't declined cleanly, add an instruction line and re-test.
7. Share it with one colleague and ask them to break it.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for Lecture 56: How to Build Your First Agent With No Code Using Agent Builder and use the Agent Instruction Template (Role / Tone / Knowledge Rules / Escalation) together with the sample grounding file Pashun Sports – US Returns and FAQ Policy.docx, so you can build the exact agent from the demo before adapting it to your own business.

Lecture 57: How to Ground an Agent in Your Own Files, Site or Knowledge Base

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

An agent is only as good as the knowledge you point it at — an ungrounded agent is just a chatbot with a nice name. In this lecture you will attach real Pashun Sports knowledge sources (SharePoint sites, specific files, and a Teams channel) to a Copilot agent so it answers from *your* documents rather than guessing from the open web.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Grounding** means telling an agent exactly which content it is allowed to read when it answers. Without it, Copilot falls back on general model knowledge and web results — fine for "write me a poem", useless for "what is our US returns window?"
- **Agents inherit your permissions, they do not extend them.** If a colleague cannot open the Pashun Sports SharePoint site, the agent will not surface that content to them either. Grounding does not create a security hole — but oversharing on the underlying site absolutely does (we return to this in Lecture 62: How to Avoid Oversharing and Fix Permission Problems Before They Bite).
- **Narrow beats broad.** Pointing an agent at an entire tenant produces vague, averaged answers. Pointing it at three specific documents produces crisp, citable answers.

Knowledge source	Best used for	Pashun Sports example	Watch out for

SharePoint site or folder	A living body of policy/ process content	The Production document library on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site	Indexes everything in scope — including old drafts
Individual files	Tightly controlled, high-accuracy answers	`Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`, the wholesale price list	Version drift — the agent reads whatever is current
Teams channel / chat	Decisions and rationale not written up anywhere	The Production channel thread on fabric weight	Informal language, unresolved arguments
SharePoint list	Structured lookups	`Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts` (3 supplier rows)	Lists live on the team site, **not** your personal OneDrive
Public website	Customer-facing facts	The Pashun Sports product pages	Only public URLs; no login-protected pages

- **Citations are your quality control.** Every grounded answer should carry a source link. If an answer has no citation, treat it as unverified — the model has stepped outside your knowledge set.
- **Indexing is not instant.** Newly uploaded or newly permissioned content can take time to appear. If an agent says "I couldn't find that", wait and retest before rebuilding the agent.
- **Scope the agent's instructions to match its sources.** Add a line like *"Answer only from the attached Pashun Sports documents. If the answer is not in them, say so and suggest who to ask."* This single sentence kills most hallucination in practice.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul builds the **Pashun Sports Product & Policy Assistant** — an agent Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) can both query instead of interrupting Paul.

1. In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, Paul opens **Copilot Studio (lite) / Create an agent** and names it, with a description: *"Answers questions about the Pashun Pro Tee US launch — product spec, pricing, suppliers and returns policy."*
2. Under **Knowledge**, he adds the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts SharePoint site**, then narrows it to the Production document library rather than the whole site.
3. He adds three specific files: `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`, the wholesale price list, and the returns policy/FAQ document.
4. He adds the **SharePoint list `Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts`**, showing that the list sits on the *team's* site — a common place people get lost when they go hunting in personal OneDrive.
5. He writes the scoping instruction: *"Use only the attached Pashun Sports knowledge. Quote figures exactly. If the answer is not present, reply 'Not in the launch documents' and suggest contacting Paul Ashun."*
6. **Test one:** "What fabric blend is specified for the Pashun Pro Tee and what GSM weight?" — answer returns with a citation back to the range brief.
7. **Test two:** "Who is our Georgia-based fabric supplier and what is the contact email?" — answer pulls from the supplier contacts list, citing the list item.
8. **Test three — the deliberate failure:** "What is our shipping cost to Canada?" — the agent correctly replies that this is not in the launch documents. Paul makes the point that a *good* no is worth more than a confident wrong answer.
9. Finally, Paul removes the price list from the knowledge set, re-asks a pricing question, and shows the answer degrade — proving grounding, not the model, was doing the work.

✅ Summary

- Grounding is what turns a generic chatbot into a Pashun Sports specialist — it defines exactly which content the agent may answer from.
- Fewer, more relevant sources beat broad site-wide scopes every time; three good documents outperform an entire tenant.
- Agents respect existing permissions, so review what is shared on the underlying site *before* you point an agent at it.
- Always pair knowledge sources with an instruction that forces the agent to admit when something isn't there.
- Check citations on every test answer; an uncited answer means the agent has drifted off your knowledge base.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one real question colleagues ask you repeatedly (pricing, policy, process, supplier details).
2. Identify the two or three documents that actually contain the answer — no more.
3. Create a new agent, add those files as knowledge, and add the instruction: *"Answer only from the attached documents. If the answer is not there, say so."*
4. Ask your chosen question and confirm the answer carries a citation you can click.
5. Now ask a question you know is **not** covered, and verify the agent declines instead of inventing an answer.
6. Share the agent with one colleague and ask them to test it — confirm they see the same answers, or find out why their permissions differ.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 57: How to Ground an Agent in Your Own Files, Site or Knowledge Base** and use the **Agent Grounding Checklist** together with the **Pashun Sports Sample Knowledge Set** (range brief, wholesale price list and returns policy/FAQ) so you can build and test the demo agent exactly as shown.

Lecture 58: How to Build a Customer Service Agent for Pashun Sports

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you build your first working agent: a **Pashun Sports Customer Service Agent** that answers customer-facing questions about the Pashun Pro Tee using only your own approved documents — returns policy, sizing guide and FAQ — so nobody on the team has to write the same reply twice. You will create it in the Copilot Studio agent builder inside the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, ground it, test it, correct it and share it with Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes.

💬 Core Concepts

- **What an agent actually is.** An agent is Copilot with a fixed job description. Instead of a blank chat box that will answer anything about anything, you give it a name, a purpose, a tone, a set of source files and a set of rules — and it behaves the same way for every person who uses it.
- **Declarative agent (no code).** The agents you build in this section are *declarative*: you describe what you want in plain English and point it at content. There is no flow builder, no connector configuration, no publishing pipeline. If you can write a good RTCA prompt, you can build one of these.
- **Grounding is the whole game.** An ungrounded agent is a chatbot with opinions. A grounded agent answers from **your** returns policy, not from a general web notion of what a returns policy usually says. For Pashun Sports that difference is the difference between "30 days" and "14 days plus original packaging".
- **Instructions vs. knowledge.** Two separate boxes, two separate jobs:

Element	What it controls	Pashun Sports example
Name	How it appears in the Copilot app and Teams	Pashun Sports Customer Service Agent
Description	One-line purpose, shown to users	Answers customer questions about Pashun Pro Tee orders, sizing, returns and delivery
Instructions	Behaviour, tone, boundaries, refusal rules	"Always reply in British English, warm and plain. Never quote a discount. If the answer is not in the source files, say so and tell the customer to email hello@pashunsports.com."
Knowledge	The only files it may answer from	Returns & Exchanges Policy.docx, Pashun Pro Tee — Sizing and Fabric FAQ.docx, US Delivery Timescales.docx
Starter prompts	Four example questions on the welcome screen	"What's our returns window?" "Does the Pro Tee shrink?"

- **Scope discipline.** A narrow agent is a good agent. This one handles orders, sizing, returns, fabric care and delivery. It does **not** handle wholesale pricing (that is Morgan's margin data) or supplier negotiation (that is Jamie's fabric quote thread). Keeping those out is a design decision, not an oversight.
- **Permissions travel with the user.** Sharing the agent does not share the files. If you ground it on a SharePoint folder that Jamie cannot open, Jamie's copy of the agent will return nothing from it. Fix the file permissions first, then share the agent.
- **Agents are not deployed software.** You can edit instructions, swap a knowledge file and re-share in under two minutes. Treat version one as a draft you will improve after five real questions, not a system you must specify perfectly up front.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul builds the agent live on the Pashun Sports tenant.

1. **Prepare the knowledge source first.** In SharePoint, inside the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team site, Paul opens the folder holding *Pashun Sports — Returns and Exchanges Policy.docx* and *Pashun Pro Tee — Sizing and Fabric FAQ.docx*. He checks both are final, dated, and free of internal notes — anything in a source file is something the agent may repeat to a customer.
2. **Open the agent builder.** From the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, Paul selects **Create agent** in the right-hand rail, which opens the Copilot Studio agent builder in a two-pane view: conversational configuration on the left, live test agent on the right.
3. **Describe it in plain English.** Paul types: *"Build a customer service agent for Pashun Sports, a US sports t-shirt brand. It answers customer questions about orders, sizing, fabric care, returns and delivery for the Pashun Pro Tee."* The builder auto-generates a name, description, first-draft instructions and an icon.
4. **Switch to the Configure tab and tighten the instructions.** The generated instructions are too vague, so Paul rewrites them: tone (warm, plain British English, no jargon), boundaries (never quote a discount, never estimate a delivery date not in the source file), and the refusal rule (if the answer isn't in the knowledge files, say so and direct the customer to the support inbox).
5. **Add knowledge.** Paul adds the two SharePoint documents as knowledge sources and turns **web search off** — deliberately. He demonstrates why: with web search on, a question about "cotton blend shrinkage" pulls a generic internet answer that contradicts the Pashun Pro Tee's actual performance-blend spec.
6. **Write four starter prompts.** "How long do I have to return an item?", "Does the Pashun Pro Tee shrink in the wash?", "When will my US order arrive?", "How do I exchange for a different size?"
7. **Test in the right-hand pane.** Paul asks *"I bought a Pro Tee three weeks ago and it doesn't fit — can I swap it?"* and checks three things: the answer matches the policy document word-for-meaning, the citation links back to the correct file, and the tone sounds like Pashun Sports rather than a call centre.
8. **Break it on purpose.** Paul asks *"What's your wholesale price per unit?"* — out of scope. If the agent invents a number or waffles, the instructions aren't tight enough. He strengthens the refusal rule, re-tests, and gets the correct behaviour: a polite decline plus the support email.
9. **Share it.** Paul shares the agent with Jamie Jordan and Morgan Reyes. Jamie's first test returns nothing from the FAQ — because Jamie's access to that SharePoint folder had never been granted. Paul fixes the file permission, Jamie retries, and the answer appears. This is the single most common "the agent is broken" call, and it is almost never the agent.

✅ Summary

- An agent is Copilot with a fixed job: a name, instructions, grounded knowledge and boundaries — built in plain English, no code.
- **Instructions control behaviour; knowledge controls facts.** Get both right or the agent will be confidently wrong in a pleasant tone.
- Turn web search **off** for policy agents so the answer can only come from your own approved documents.
- Always test the out-of-scope question, not just the easy one — the refusal behaviour is what makes an agent safe to share.
- Sharing an agent never shares the underlying files; if a colleague gets empty answers, check their SharePoint permissions first.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Choose two documents from your own organisation that a colleague asks you about repeatedly — a policy, a process guide, an FAQ. Confirm both are current and contain nothing you would not want quoted back to you.
2. In the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, select **Create agent** and describe your agent in one sentence, naming the audience and the topics it covers.
3. On the **Configure** tab, rewrite the generated instructions to include tone, one hard boundary ("never quote prices"), and an explicit refusal rule for anything not in the source files.
4. Add your two documents as knowledge sources and switch web search off.
5. Test with three questions: one easy, one phrased the way a frustrated customer would phrase it, and one clearly out of scope. Note which of the three fails.
6. Fix the failure by editing the instructions — not by adding more files — then re-test and share the agent with one colleague.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 58: How to Build a Customer Service Agent for Pashun Sports** and use the **Pashun Sports Customer Service Agent Build Sheet** (the full instruction text, starter prompts and the out-of-scope test questions used in the demo), together with the sample **Pashun Sports — Returns and Exchanges Policy** and **Pashun Pro Tee — Sizing and Fabric FAQ** documents so you can build along even if you have no suitable files of your own; if you need to revisit how grounding works before you start, go back to **Lecture 13: How to Ground Your Prompts in Your Own Files, Emails and Meetings for Accurate Results**.

Lecture 59: How to Build a Sales Reporting Agent That Answers Questions About Your Numbers

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will build a **sales reporting agent** — a custom Copilot agent that sits on top of the Pashun Sports US sales data and answers plain-English questions like *"Which US state sold the most Pashun Pro Tees in Q1?"* without anyone opening a spreadsheet. By the end you will have a working, shareable agent that Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) and Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) can query themselves.

💬 Core Concepts

- **What a reporting agent actually is.** It is a *declarative* agent: Copilot's normal intelligence, plus three things you supply — instructions (how it should behave), knowledge (which files or sites it may read), and starter prompts (the questions you expect). No code, no Power Platform licence required for this build.
- **Why you build one instead of just asking Copilot Chat.** Copilot Chat searches everything you have access to and may pull last year's draft forecast by mistake. An agent is *scoped* — you point it at one workbook and one SharePoint folder, so every answer comes from the numbers you have actually signed off.

- **Clean data is the whole job.** An agent is only as good as the grounding source. Before you build, the workbook must have real headers on row 1, one row per record, no merged cells, no blank spacer rows, and no colour-coding that carries meaning (Copilot cannot read a fill colour).
- **Where the file lives matters.** Agents ground on **SharePoint and OneDrive** locations, not on a file sitting on your laptop. For Pashun Sports the workbook must live in the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team site so Morgan and Jamie can use the agent too.
- **Instructions are the personality and the guardrails.** This is where you tell it to answer in GBP, to state the reporting period in every answer, and — critically — to say *"that figure isn't in the source data"* rather than estimating.

Build element	What it does	Pashun Sports example
Name	How it appears in the Copilot agent list	Pashun Sports US Sales Reporter
Description	Helps colleagues pick the right agent	Answers questions on Pashun Pro Tee US sales, stock and margin
Instructions	Rules, tone, refusal behaviour	"Always cite the tab and month. Never estimate missing figures."
Knowledge	The grounded sources	Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx; Production channel files
Starter prompts	One-click common questions	"Top 5 US states by units sold"; "Margin per unit by colourway"

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul builds the agent live on the real Pashun Consulting tenant:

1. **Prepares the data.** Opens **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** in the Pashun Sports T-Shirts team site and checks both tabs — **US Forecast** and **Sales Summary** — for clean headers (State, Month, Units Sold, Unit Price, Unit Cost, Margin Per Unit). He deletes a merged title row that was breaking grounding.
2. **Opens the agent builder.** From the Microsoft 365 Copilot app, selects **Create agent**, and starts in the conversational builder rather than the configure tab.
3. **Names and describes it** — *Pashun Sports US Sales Reporter* — so it is distinguishable from the returns-policy agent built in the previous lecture.
4. **Writes the instructions**, dictating them into the builder: *"You are the sales reporting assistant for Pashun Sports T-Shirts. Answer only from the US Sales and Stock Forecast workbook. Report all currency in GBP and state the month or quarter the figure covers. If a question cannot be answered from the data, say so and name the column that is missing. Keep answers under 120 words unless a table is requested."*
5. **Adds knowledge** — points the agent at the workbook and at the **Production** channel files folder, deliberately leaving out Paul's personal OneDrive so the agent cannot surface unapproved draft numbers.
6. **Adds four starter prompts**: top-selling US states; units sold by month; margin per unit by size; stock cover against forecast.
7. **Tests it in the preview pane** with Morgan's real question from the Monthly US Sales Review: *"Which three states drove most of the Pro Tee revenue last quarter, and what was the average margin per unit?"* Paul cross-checks the answer against the Sales Summary tab on screen.

8. **Deliberately breaks it.** He asks *"What were our Canadian sales?"* — data that does not exist — and shows the agent correctly refusing rather than inventing a number. That refusal behaviour is the instruction earning its keep.
9. **Publishes and shares** the agent to Jamie and Morgan, noting that they see only the data their own permissions already allow — the agent never elevates access.

✅ Summary

- A reporting agent is Copilot scoped to your numbers — instructions, knowledge sources and starter prompts, no code.
- Grounding quality is decided before you build: clean headers, one row per record, no merged cells, file stored in SharePoint or OneDrive.
- Explicit instructions on currency, reporting period and refusal behaviour are what turn a demo into something Finance will trust.
- Always test with a question you already know the answer to, and one you know the data *cannot* answer.
- Sharing an agent shares the interface, not the permissions — colleagues still only see what they are entitled to see.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one clean reporting workbook you already own and move it into a SharePoint or Teams location if it is not there already.
2. Open the Microsoft 365 Copilot app and choose **Create agent**.
3. Give it a name and a one-line description a colleague would understand without asking you.
4. Write instructions covering three things: the source it may use, the currency and period format, and what to do when the data is missing.
5. Add the workbook as knowledge, then add three starter prompts based on questions your manager actually asks each month.
6. Test with one question you know the answer to and one you know is unanswerable — then adjust the instructions until both behave correctly.
7. Share it with one colleague and ask them to try a question you did not anticipate.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 59: How to Build a Sales Reporting Agent That Answers Questions About Your Numbers** and use the **Sales Reporting Agent Instruction Template** together with the sample **Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx** workbook; if your data needs cleaning first, revisit **Lecture 31: How to Clean Up a Messy Spreadsheet So Copilot Can Actually Work With It**.

Lecture 60: How to Share, Test, Monitor and Improve an Agent Over Time

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

You have built an agent — now you need other people to use it without it embarrassing you. This lecture covers the full post-build lifecycle: how to share a Copilot agent safely, how to test it before anyone else sees it, how to monitor what it is actually being asked, and how to improve it on a regular cycle so it does not quietly rot.

💬 Core Concepts

An agent is not a one-off build. It is a small internal product with users, a support burden and a maintenance schedule. Four disciplines keep it healthy.

1. Sharing — who gets it, and what they inherit

- Agents built in **Copilot Studio agent builder** (the lightweight builder inside the Microsoft 365 Copilot app) are shared the same way a file is shared — **Share** button, then named people, a group, or your whole organisation.
- **Critical rule:** sharing an agent does **not** share its knowledge sources. Copilot always enforces the *viewer's* permissions. If Morgan Reyes can't open the returns policy document in SharePoint, the agent will simply fail to answer her questions from it.
- Practical consequence: before you share an agent, check the permissions on every file, site, library and list it is grounded in — and fix the file permissions, never by copying the file somewhere looser.
- Prefer sharing with a **group** (e.g. a security group or the Pashun Sports T-Shirts Team's members) rather than a list of individuals. Individuals leave; groups get maintained.

2. Testing — prove it before you promote it

- Test in the **test pane** while building, then do a second round *as a real user* after sharing, because the test pane runs under your permissions, not theirs.
- Test four categories of question, not just the easy one:

Test type	Example for the Pashun Returns Assistant	What you're checking
Happy path	"What's the returns window on a Pashun Pro Tee?"	Correct answer, correct source cited
Edge case	"Customer in Texas washed it once, wants a refund"	Does it follow the worn-item rule?
Out of scope	"What's Jamie's salary?"	Does it refuse and redirect, not guess?
Hallucination bait	"What's the returns policy for our EU customers?"	Does it say "not covered" or invent a policy?

- Log every failed test with the exact prompt and the exact wrong answer. You cannot fix "it went a bit weird sometimes".

3. Monitoring — find out what people actually ask

- Lightweight agents don't give you a full analytics dashboard, so build a feedback loop deliberately: a short **Microsoft Form**, a dedicated Teams channel post, or a Loop page where users paste bad answers.
- If the agent is published through **Copilot Studio (full)**, use the **Analytics** area for session volume, engagement rate and escalation/abandon rate.
- Watch the three numbers that matter: **usage** (is anyone using it?), **resolution** (did it answer or deflect?), **corrections** (how often did a human have to step in?).

4. Improving — a maintenance cadence

- **Weekly for the first month:** review reported bad answers, tighten instructions.
- **Monthly thereafter:** re-run the test set, check knowledge sources still exist and are current.
- **Triggered:** any time the underlying policy, price list or product range changes.
- Improve in this order: **instructions first** (cheapest fix), **knowledge sources second**, **rebuild last**. Most bad answers are an instruction problem, not a knowledge problem.
- Keep a **version note** in the agent's description: "v1.3 — updated 14-day window to 30 days, Nov 2026." Users trust an agent that is visibly maintained.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul takes the **Pashun Returns Assistant** — the agent built earlier in this section from the Pashun Sports returns policy and FAQ document — and takes it from "works on my machine" to "trusted by the team".

1. Paul opens the agent in the **Microsoft 365 Copilot app**, clicks **Share**, and shares it with **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** and **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)** rather than the whole tenant, so the first rollout is controlled.
2. Before confirming, he opens the SharePoint location of the returns policy document on the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** team site and checks Jamie and Morgan both have read access — demonstrating live that an agent shared without underlying file access returns "I couldn't find that information."
3. He runs the four-part test set in the test pane, including the deliberate hallucination bait: *"What is our returns policy for customers in Portugal?"* Pashun Sports currently ships only to the US, so the correct behaviour is a clean refusal. Paul shows the first version guessing — then tightens the instruction to *"If the question concerns a country outside the United States, state that Pashun Sports currently ships to US customers only and do not speculate"* — and re-runs the same prompt to show the corrected answer.
4. Jamie then tests from her own account and reports a real-world failure: she asks *"Can a wholesale customer return a full carton?"* and the agent applies the consumer rule. Paul shows this being triaged as an **instructions** fix, not a rebuild — adding a line separating retail from wholesale returns.
5. Finally, Paul sets up the monitoring loop: a short Form linked in the agent description, a review reminder in the **Weekly Production Catch-Up** meeting, and a version note added to the description so the team can see it is being maintained.

✅ Summary

- Sharing an agent shares the *agent*, never the *permissions* — Copilot always answers using the viewer's own access rights, so check knowledge-source permissions first.

- Test four ways every time: happy path, edge case, out of scope, and hallucination bait — and log failures with the exact prompt and exact wrong answer.
- Build a deliberate feedback loop (Form, Teams channel or Loop page) because small agents do not hand you analytics automatically.
- Fix in order of cost: instructions, then knowledge sources, then rebuild — most bad answers are an instruction problem.
- Agents decay. Weekly reviews for month one, monthly after that, plus a triggered review whenever the underlying policy or data changes.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Take the agent you built earlier in this section and write a **test set of eight prompts** — two happy path, two edge case, two out of scope, two hallucination bait.
2. Run all eight in the test pane and record the answers in a simple table with a pass/fail column.
3. Share the agent with **one** trusted colleague only, and ask them to run the same eight prompts from their own account. Note any answer that differs from yours — that difference is a permissions issue.
4. Pick the single worst failure and fix it by editing the agent's **instructions** only. Re-run that prompt to confirm.
5. Add a version note to the agent description (e.g. "v1.1 — tightened out-of-scope handling") and put a 30-minute agent review in your calendar for four weeks' time.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 60: How to Share, Test, Monitor and Improve an Agent Over Time** and use the **Agent Test Set Template** and the **Agent Maintenance Log** — and if you need to revisit how the Pashun Returns Assistant was originally created, go back to **Lecture 57: How to Build Your First Copilot Agent Without Writing Any Code**.

Lecture 61: How Copilot Handles Your Data, Permissions and Privacy — Explained Simply

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

This lecture explains, in plain English, exactly what Microsoft 365 Copilot can see, where your data goes when you type a prompt, and why Copilot never magically hands you files you were not already allowed to open. By the end you will be able to answer the three questions every manager, client and IT team asks before they let Copilot near real business content.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot inherits your permissions — it does not grant new ones.** When Paul Ashun (Founder & Director at Pashun Sports T-Shirts) asks Copilot to summarise the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote thread, Copilot only reaches content Paul could already open by hand. If Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) has a margin workbook stored in a private folder Paul has no access to, Copilot will not surface it for Paul — no matter how the prompt is worded.
- **The flip side, and the real governance risk:** Copilot also inherits *over*-permissioning. If a SharePoint site or a "Anyone with the link" file was shared too widely months ago, Copilot makes that mistake far more visible, far faster. Copilot is not the leak — it is the torch that finds it.
- **The two Copilots are not the same product.** Knowing which one you are in determines where the data goes.
- **Grounding** is the step where Copilot retrieves relevant content from your Microsoft 365 tenant (mail, files, chats, meetings) and adds it to your prompt before generating an answer. Nothing is "uploaded" anywhere new — the retrieval happens inside the Microsoft 365 service boundary.
- **Your prompts and responses are not used to train the foundation models.** In Microsoft 365 Copilot, prompt and response data stays within your tenant's compliance boundary and is covered by the same commitments as your Exchange and SharePoint data.
- **Copilot respects sensitivity labels and encryption.** A Word document labelled Confidential carries that label into any Copilot-generated summary or derived file. Labels do not get stripped by the AI.
- **Audit and retention still apply.** Copilot interactions are stored in the user's mailbox as hidden items and are discoverable through eDiscovery, Purview Audit and retention policies — the same as a Teams message.
- **What Copilot cannot see:** other users' private mailboxes and OneDrive you lack rights to, items you have deleted, content on local drives not synced to OneDrive, and — a practical one for this course — records that have not yet been indexed by Microsoft Search.

Question	Microsoft 365 Copilot (licensed)	Copilot Chat (free / consumer sign-in)
Can it read your work files, mail and meetings?	Yes, within your permissions	No

Where does your data sit?	Inside your Microsoft 365 tenant boundary	Web-grounded chat only
Enterprise Data Protection applies?	Yes	Yes when signed in with a work account, but no work-data grounding
Prompts used to train foundation models?	No	No, when signed in with a work account
Covered by eDiscovery, Purview and retention?	Yes	Limited
Sensitivity labels respected?	Yes	Not applicable — no file access

- **Indexing is not instant.** As the Pashun Sports tenant build showed, a newly created mailbox, a new Teams channel and a newly uploaded Word file can all become groundable at different times. A missing answer is more often an indexing delay than a permissions block — check both before you panic.
- **People are not just names in a contact list.** Copilot's people-grounding relies on real Entra ID identities. Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) and Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance) work as "people" in prompts because they are licensed accounts in the tenant; a contact typed manually into Outlook is just text and will not resolve.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul demonstrates the permission boundary live on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant rather than describing it in theory:

1. **Prove inheritance.** Signed in as Paul, he opens Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat and asks: *"Summarise everything I have on the Ridgeline Apparel Supply fabric quote, including the email thread with Jamie Jordan and the US Range Brief."* Copilot returns a grounded answer with clickable citations back to the original Outlook thread and `Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx`.
2. **Prove the limit.** He then asks for a file stored in an area he has deliberately not been given access to. Copilot returns nothing and cites nothing — no error, no leak, no workaround. The point is made: no prompt phrasing defeats a permission.
3. **Show the citations panel.** Every claim in the answer traces to a source. Paul clicks through from the summary to the actual message in the Paul/Jamie thread, showing students how to verify provenance instead of trusting prose.
4. **Show sensitivity labels travelling.** A labelled version of the wholesale price list is summarised; the resulting Copilot Page/Word output carries the label forward automatically.
5. **Show the oversharing scenario.** Paul deliberately over-shares a document in the `Pashun Pro Tee - US Supplier Contacts` area, then queries as a second user to show the file appearing in results it should never appear in — then fixes the sharing link and re-runs the query. This is the single most important five minutes in the section: the problem was the share, not the AI.
6. **Show the indexing lag honestly.** A file uploaded minutes earlier is not yet groundable. Paul waits, re-runs, and it appears — teaching students to distinguish "Copilot can't" from "Copilot hasn't yet."
7. **Show the audit trail.** A quick look at where Copilot interactions surface for compliance purposes, so students can answer their IT team's inevitable question.

✅ Summary

- Copilot works strictly inside your existing permissions — it never grants access you did not already have.
- The genuine risk is historic oversharing, which Copilot exposes quickly; fix the sharing, not the AI.
- Your prompts, responses and grounded work data stay inside your Microsoft 365 tenant boundary and are not used to train the foundation models.
- Sensitivity labels, retention, audit and eDiscovery all continue to apply to Copilot content.
- A missing answer is usually an indexing delay or a non-indexed identity — check timing and permissions before concluding Copilot "can't do it."

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open Microsoft 365 Copilot Chat and ask it to summarise a document you know you have access to. Click at least two citations and confirm they open the real source.
2. Now ask it about a document you know you do **not** have access to. Note what happens — an empty or unsourced answer, never the content.
3. In OneDrive or SharePoint, open **Manage access** on one business-critical file and check for any "Anyone with the link" sharing. Tighten anything that should not be there.
4. Ask Copilot: *"What files have been shared with me recently that I would not expect to have access to?"* and review the result honestly.
5. Write three sentences you could send to your own IT or compliance lead explaining where Copilot data goes. If you cannot write them clearly, re-read the Core Concepts table above.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 61: How Copilot Handles Your Data, Permissions and Privacy — Explained Simply** and use the **Copilot Data & Permissions One-Page Explainer** together with the **Oversharing Self-Audit Checklist**; then carry them forward into **Lecture 62: How to Keep Confidential Information Safe When Using Copilot at Work**.

Lecture 62: How to Avoid Oversharing and Fix Permission Problems Before They Bite

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot does not break your permissions — it exposes them. In this lecture you will learn how oversharing happens inside a Microsoft 365 tenant, how to spot it using Copilot itself, and how to fix the three most common permission problems before a colleague, a supplier or an auditor finds them for you.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Copilot inherits, it does not grant.** Copilot only ever returns content the signed-in user already has permission to open. If Copilot surfaces something surprising, the permission was already wrong — Copilot just made it findable in three seconds instead of never.
- **Oversharing is a search problem, not a hacking problem.** Before Copilot, a badly-permissioned file sat unnoticed in a SharePoint library nobody browsed. Copilot indexes it and answers questions from it. The risk profile of an old mistake changes overnight.
- **The four classic oversharing patterns** you will find in almost every small business tenant:

Pattern	What it looks like at Pashun Sports	Why it bites
"Anyone with the link" sharing	The wholesale price list shared by link so Ridgeline Apparel Supply could read it, never revoked	Link is forwardable outside the tenant; Copilot can summarise it for anyone who holds it
Broad group on a sensitive library	Margin-per-unit workbook saved to a Team that every staff member joined	Jamie Jordan (Project Manager) can ask Copilot "what's our margin on the Pashun Pro Tee?" and get an exact answer
Inherited site permissions	A "US Launch" SharePoint folder created inside the main Pashun Sports site, inheriting all-company access	Nobody chose to share it — it was never un-shared
Personal OneDrive as a shared drive	Morgan Reyes keeps the supplier agreement in OneDrive and shares it individually, repeatedly	Leavers, forwarded links and orphaned files; no site-level governance

- **Sensitivity labels are the strongest control.** A label such as **Confidential – Finance** applied to the margin workbook encrypts the file and travels with it. Copilot respects labels: it will not surface encrypted content to a user without rights, and Copilot outputs that draw on a labelled file inherit the label.
- **Restricted SharePoint Search (RSS)** is the emergency brake. It limits Copilot's tenant-wide search to an allow-list of curated sites while you clean up the rest. Use it as a temporary measure, not a permanent strategy — it also shrinks Copilot's usefulness.
- **The three questions to ask of any file** before you trust it in a Copilot tenant: Who can open it? Who *should* be able to open it? Is there a label that would enforce that automatically?

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through a live oversharing incident on the Pashun Sports T-Shirts tenant.

1. **Plant the problem.** Paul opens the Excel workbook *Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx*, adds a margin-per-unit column, and shares it with **Anyone in Pashun Sports with the link — can edit**. This is the mistake most people make on a Friday afternoon.
2. **Find it as an ordinary user.** Paul signs in as **Jamie Jordan (Project Manager)** — a Business Basic user with no reason to see margin — opens Copilot Chat and asks: *"What is our margin per unit on the Pashun Pro Tee and which US states are most profitable?"* Copilot answers, with a citation straight to the workbook. Nothing was hacked. The permission was simply wrong.
3. **Diagnose it.** Back as **Paul Ashun (Founder)**, Paul opens the file in SharePoint, uses **Manage access** to show the difference between *Direct access*, *Links giving access* and *inherited site permissions*, and identifies which of the three actually caused the leak.

4. **Fix it three ways.**

- Delete the offending sharing link.
- Move the workbook into a **Finance** channel of the *Pashun Sports T-Shirts* Team with membership limited to Paul and **Morgan Reyes (Head of Finance)**.
- Apply the **Confidential – Finance** sensitivity label so the control survives the next re-share.

1. **Prove the fix.** Paul re-runs Jamie's exact prompt. Copilot now responds that it cannot find margin information in files Jamie has access to — and the earlier answer's citation no longer resolves.
2. **Audit for the next one.** Paul runs a self-audit prompt as the Founder: *"List the files I own that are shared with people outside my organisation, and any shared with everyone in the organisation, grouped by site."* He then demonstrates the **OneDrive and SharePoint "Shared with" / Data access governance** reports for a tenant-wide view.
3. **Note the delay.** Paul flags a real behaviour students will hit: after a permission change, Copilot's index can take time to catch up. A removed answer may linger briefly in chat history — history is not a permission boundary, so never treat a cached answer as proof the fix failed or succeeded.

✅ Summary

- Copilot never grants access — it reveals permissions that were already too broad, and it reveals them fast.
- The four usual culprits are stale "anyone with the link" shares, sensitive files in broad Teams, inherited site permissions, and OneDrive used as a shared drive.
- Fix the permission at the source (Manage access), then enforce it with a **sensitivity label** so the fix survives future sharing.
- **Restricted SharePoint Search** is a temporary brake while you clean up, not a governance strategy.
- Use Copilot as your own audit tool — ask it what you are sharing, then verify in SharePoint's access reports rather than trusting the chat answer alone.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one genuinely sensitive file you own — pricing, margins, salary, a signed supplier agreement.
2. Open it in SharePoint or OneDrive and select **Manage access**. Write down every person, group and link that currently has access.
3. Remove anything you cannot justify in one sentence, starting with any "Anyone with the link" entries.
4. Apply the most appropriate sensitivity label your organisation offers (ask IT which one if you are unsure).
5. In Copilot Chat, run: *"Which of my files are shared with everyone in my organisation or with people outside it? Group them by site and show the last modified date."* Pick the top three results and repeat steps 2–4 on each.
6. If you have access to a second test account, sign in as that user and try to make Copilot surface the file. If it can, you have not finished.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 62: How to Avoid Oversharing and Fix Permission Problems Before They Bite** and use the **Oversharing Audit Checklist** and the

Permission Triage Prompt Set — then pair them with the labelling walkthrough in **Lecture 61: How to Use Sensitivity Labels and Data Protection With Copilot**.

Lecture 63: How to Write a Simple AI Usage Policy for a Small Team

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

In this lecture you will write a one-page AI Usage Policy that a small team can actually read, understand and follow — no legal department required. We will draft it live for Pashun Sports T-Shirts, covering what staff may put into Copilot, what they must never paste in, and who signs off before AI-generated work leaves the business.

💬 Core Concepts

A small-team AI policy fails for one of two reasons: it is twelve pages of legal boilerplate nobody reads, or it is a vague "use AI responsibly" line that gives no one a decision rule. What works is a single page built around a small number of concrete, testable statements.

The six sections every usable small-team AI policy needs:

- **Scope** — which tools this policy covers. Be explicit: Microsoft 365 Copilot (work account), Copilot Chat in the browser, Copilot agents in Teams. State clearly whether personal ChatGPT/Gemini accounts are in or out of scope.
- **The green list** — what staff are actively encouraged to do. Summarising Teams meetings, drafting supplier emails, cleaning up spreadsheet formulas, building first-draft decks.
- **The red list** — what must never be entered into any AI tool. This is the section people actually remember, so keep it to five or six named items.
- **The human check rule** — a named class of output that must be reviewed by a human before it leaves the business.
- **Ownership and questions** — one named person who owns the policy and answers queries. In a ten-person business that is usually the founder or the ops lead.
- **Review date** — a fixed date, not "periodically". Copilot's capabilities change quarterly; so should the policy.

The critical distinction most small teams miss:

Concept	What it means	Why it matters for your policy
Work Copilot (signed in with your M365 account)	Prompts and data stay inside your tenant's compliance boundary; nothing trains the public model	This is the tool you want people using
Consumer AI (personal accounts, free web tools)	Data leaves your tenant entirely; you lose all control and audit trail	This is what your policy must steer people away from

Copilot respects existing permissions	Copilot only surfaces files the user already had access to	Your policy is about *behaviour*; oversharing is a *permissions* problem — fix both

- **Policy does not replace permissions.** As we saw in Lecture 62: How to Avoid Oversharing and Fix Permission Problems Before They Bite, if a SharePoint site is open to everyone, no policy sentence will stop Copilot summarising it. Policy governs what people *choose* to do; permissions govern what they *can* do.
- **Write it in plain English at a reading level your least technical staff member is comfortable with.** "Do not paste customer payment card details into any AI tool" beats "personally identifiable financial data must not be processed via generative systems."
- **Make it one page.** If it does not fit on one side of A4, it will not be read.

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul opens Word, starts from a blank document, and uses Copilot to draft the Pashun Sports T-Shirts AI Usage Policy — then edits it down hard, because the first draft will always be too long and too corporate.

Step 1 — The grounded prompt. In Word, Paul opens the Copilot draft pane and enters an RTCA-structured prompt:

> *"You are an operations lead at a ten-person US sports apparel brand. Write a one-page AI Usage Policy covering Microsoft 365 Copilot. Reference /Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx for our tone of voice. Include: scope, encouraged uses, prohibited data, a human review rule, an owner, and a review date. Plain English, short sentences, no legal jargon. Aim: every staff member should understand it in under three minutes."*

Step 2 — Cut the draft. Copilot returns roughly a page and a half with some corporate padding. Paul highlights the waffle and uses **Rewrite with Copilot** → **Shorten**, then manually deletes anything that does not give someone a decision rule.

Step 3 — Make the red list specific to Pashun Sports. Generic drafts say "confidential information". Paul replaces that with named, recognisable items:

- The Ridgeline Apparel Supply pricing schedule and unit cost breakdown
- Customer names, shipping addresses or payment details from Shopify orders
- Anything from Morgan Reyes' finance folder — payroll, bank details, unfiled accounts
- Unsigned contracts or draft supplier agreements
- Login credentials, API keys or tenant admin details

Step 4 — Write the human check rule. Paul adds a single sentence the team can quote back: *"Any AI-drafted content that goes to a customer, a supplier or the public website is read end-to-end by a human before it is sent. Jamie Jordan signs off supplier communications; Paul Ashun signs off anything customer- or press-facing."*

Step 5 — Add the tooling line. Paul adds: *"Use Copilot signed in with your @pashunconsulting work account. Do not paste Pashun Sports work into personal AI accounts."* He shows the difference live — the work Copilot banner versus the consumer view — so the team can see which one they are in.

Step 6 — Publish where people will find it. Paul saves the policy into the **Pashun Sports T-Shirts** Team, pins it as a tab in the **Production** channel, and adds a link to it in the **Pashun Pro Tee - US Launch Checklist** OneNote so new starters meet it on day one. He notes that because it lives on the Team's SharePoint site and not his personal OneDrive, Copilot can surface it for Jamie and Morgan when they ask *"what's our AI policy?"* — the policy becomes self-serving.

Step 7 — Test it. Paul asks Copilot Chat: *"According to our AI Usage Policy, can I paste the Ridgeline cost breakdown into Copilot?"* Copilot grounds on the pinned document and answers correctly. A policy Copilot can read is a policy the team will actually get answers from.

✅ Summary

- A small-team AI policy must fit on one page and be built from six sections: scope, encouraged uses, prohibited data, human review rule, named owner, and a fixed review date.
- Name real things in your red list — the Ridgeline pricing schedule, customer payment details, Morgan's finance folder — not abstract categories like "confidential information".
- Steer staff to work-account Copilot, where data stays inside your tenant, and explicitly rule personal AI accounts in or out.
- Policy governs behaviour; permissions govern access. You need both — a policy will never fix an overshared SharePoint site.
- Publish the policy where Copilot can read it (a Teams channel tab or SharePoint site) so the team can simply ask Copilot what the rules are.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Open a blank Word document and run the RTCA prompt from this lecture, swapping Pashun Sports for your own organisation, team size and industry.
2. Rewrite the prohibited-data section by hand. List five to six items using the actual names of your systems, folders and data — if a colleague could not point at the thing you named, it is too vague.
3. Write one human review sentence that names a real person for customer-facing output and a real person for supplier or partner output.
4. Cut the whole document until it fits on one side of A4. Delete any sentence that does not help someone make a decision.
5. Save it to a SharePoint or Teams location your whole team can reach, pin it as a channel tab, and set a calendar reminder for the review date you put in the document.
6. Test it: ask Copilot Chat a question about your own policy — for example *"According to our AI Usage Policy, can I paste our supplier price list into Copilot?"* — and confirm it answers from your document.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 63: How to Write a Simple AI Usage Policy for a Small Team** and use the **Pashun Sports One-Page AI Usage Policy Template (.docx)** together with the **AI Policy Drafting Prompt Card**, then compare your draft against the **Red List Starter Checklist** before you publish it to your team.

Lecture 64: How to Stay Compliant, Ethical and Accurate When AI Writes on Your Behalf

🧠 Intro — What We're Doing Today

Copilot can draft a supplier agreement, a customer refund email or a sales claim in seconds — but you, not Copilot, are legally and professionally accountable for every word that leaves your name. In this lecture you will build a practical compliance, ethics and accuracy routine you can apply to every AI-assisted output at Pashun Sports before it is sent, signed or published.

💬 Core Concepts

- **Accountability never transfers.** Microsoft's Copilot Copyright Commitment covers certain commercial IP claims, but it does not cover an inaccurate price you sent a customer, a promise you made to Ridgeline Apparel Supply, or a discrimination risk in a recruitment email. The sender owns the content.
- **The three risk families.** Every AI-written output carries some mix of **accuracy risk** (wrong facts, invented figures), **compliance risk** (regulated claims, contractual wording, personal data) and **ethical risk** (misleading tone, undisclosed automation, bias).
- **Grounded ≠ correct.** A grounded answer from `Pashun Sports - US Sales and Stock Forecast.xlsx` is only as correct as that workbook. Copilot will faithfully summarise a stale tab. Always check the *source*, not just the citation.
- **Hallucination hotspots.** Numbers, dates, names, legal clauses, regulatory claims and anything Copilot could not have seen. If Copilot writes "our tees are OEKO-TEX certified" and no source file says so, that is a fabricated claim with real consequences.
- **Personal data discipline.** Do not paste customer names, addresses, card details or Jamie Jordan's or Morgan Reyes' HR information into a prompt when a reference to the file would do. Copilot Chat with work data protection keeps prompts inside the tenant — consumer Copilot and web-mode chat do not carry the same guarantees.
- **Disclosure ethics.** Internal drafts rarely need a disclaimer. Public-facing content that claims human judgement — a testimonial, an endorsement, a "personal note from the founder" — should not be wholly AI-written and presented otherwise.
- **Regulated claims.** US marketing copy for the Pashun Pro Tee touches FTC advertising rules: performance claims ("keeps you 3°C cooler"), country-of-origin, sustainability language and comparative claims all need evidence on file before publication.

Output type	Main risk	Required check before sending
Customer complaint reply	Commitment you cannot honour	Verify refund/returns terms against the returns policy doc
Supplier agreement clause	Contractual/legal exposure	Human legal review — never send AI wording unchecked
US sales figures for Morgan Reyes	Wrong or stale numbers	Open the cited Excel tab and re-check the figure

Launch marketing copy	Unsubstantiated performance claim	Evidence file for every factual claim
Meeting recap to the team	Misattributed decision or action	Compare against the recording/ transcript
Anything containing personal data	Privacy/GDPR & US state privacy laws	Minimise data, check recipients, check sharing links

🎯 Demo — Hands-On

Paul works through four real Pashun Sports outputs and applies the check routine live.

1. **The dangerous refund email.** Paul asks Copilot in Outlook to reply to the customer complaint email about a misprinted Pashun Pro Tee. The draft offers "a full refund and free replacement within 48 hours." Paul opens the returns policy document and shows the promise does not match policy — then re-prompts: *"Rewrite this reply using only the terms stated in the Pashun Sports returns policy document. Do not offer anything the policy does not allow."*
2. **The invented certification.** Paul generates US launch copy for the Pashun Pro Tee and highlights a fabricated sustainability claim that appears in no source file. He demonstrates the fix prompt: *"Rewrite this copy using only claims that appear in 'Pashun Pro Tee - US Range Brief.docx'. Mark any claim you cannot source with [UNVERIFIED]."*
3. **The stale number.** Paul asks Copilot to summarise US sales by state for Morgan Reyes' Monthly US Sales Review. He clicks the citation, opens the US Forecast tab, and shows how to confirm which tab and date range Copilot actually used before the figure lands in a board-level report.
4. **The clause you must not accept.** Paul has Copilot draft a payment-terms clause for the Ridgeline Apparel Supply agreement, then marks it clearly as a **drafting aid for legal review**, adding a tracked comment in Word rather than sending it as agreed wording.

He closes by writing a four-line "pre-send checklist" into OneNote so the whole team uses the same standard.

✅ Summary

- You are accountable for AI-written content — Copilot is a drafting tool, not a signatory.
- Check accuracy at the source: open the cited file, confirm the tab, the date and the figure.
- Numbers, names, dates, legal clauses and regulated claims are the highest-risk elements in any Copilot output.
- Never let AI invent a commitment, a certification or a performance claim; re-prompt to restrict it to sourced facts.
- Minimise personal data in prompts, and keep legal wording under human review before it becomes binding.

🎯 Your Turn

1. Pick one real email or document you would genuinely send this week and draft it with Copilot.
2. Highlight every fact in it: numbers, dates, names, promises and claims.
3. Verify each highlighted item against a real source file or system — not against Copilot.

4. Re-prompt to remove or correct anything you could not verify, using: *"Rewrite this using only facts from [named file]. Flag anything you cannot source as [UNVERIFIED]."*
5. Write your own four-point pre-send checklist and save it where your team can see it.

📂 Resources For This Lesson

In your handout pack, open the folder for **Lecture 64: How to Stay Compliant, Ethical and Accurate When AI Writes on Your Behalf** and use the **AI Output Pre-Send Compliance Checklist** together with the **Fact-Restriction Prompt Card**; pair it with the oversharing walkthrough from **Lecture 11: How to Protect Your Data by Understanding What Copilot Can and Cannot See**.